VK7SPORTS — Website Demo Prototype

Project Lead Operating Handbook — Pre-Discovery Phase

AASIOM Pvt Ltd · Issued to Pradnya Gaikwad, Project Lead / Product Strategist / UX Planning Lead

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How To Use This Handbook

This is not reading material. It is a working manual.

You are expected to keep this document open while you work. Every section is written so that when you hit a specific situation — a scope argument, a design review, an owner question you cannot answer — you can go to the relevant section, follow the steps, and act without waiting for me.

Reading order for your first day:

Order	Sections	Why
1	1 – 9	Understand the mission, the boundaries, and exactly what you can decide alone.
2	19 – 26	Governance and registers. Set these up before any design work starts.
3	13 – 18	The planning artefacts you produce in Week 1.
4	10 – 12	Your operating rhythm.
5	Everything else	Reference. Read the section when the situation arrives.

Notation used throughout:

Marker	Meaning
FOUNDER TO CONFIRM	A business fact I have not yet given you. Do not guess. Log it, batch it, ask me.
`[SQUARE BRACKETS]`	A placeholder to be filled with real information before the artefact is used.
WARNING	A failure mode that has killed projects like this one. Treat as a hard rule.
FOUNDER TIP	Judgement I would apply in your position. Not a rule; guidance.
REVIEW GATE	Work cannot proceed past this point without the stated sign-off.

Every open item flagged in this handbook is consolidated in **Appendix F — Open Items for Founder**. Bring that appendix to our first working session.

1. Founder Message

Pradnya,

You are being given a project that is small in size and large in consequence.

VK7SPORTS is a real business with real revenue, run today on offline relationships and WhatsApp threads. The owner is not asking us to fix that. He has not asked us to build software. He has not signed up for a digital transformation. What he has agreed to is a conversation — and our job in this phase is to make that conversation compelling enough that he funds the next one.

That is the entire mission. A clickable Figma prototype that earns us the Discovery Phase.

I want to be direct with you about why this matters more than the deliverable suggests. In consulting and product work, the phase you are running now is where most engagements die. Not because the design was ugly — because the team over-promised, under-scoped, or confused motion with progress. Teams build beautiful homepages and neglect the quotation workflow. They add a 3D jersey configurator because it demos well, and then spend the next six months explaining why it cannot be built. They say "yes" in the room and create obligations nobody costed.

You are being made Project Lead precisely so that does not happen. Your authority in this project is not primarily creative. It is **the authority to say no, and to say it with a reason.** Everything else in this handbook exists to support that.

Three things I will hold you to.

First, honesty in the artefact. Nothing in this prototype may claim something VK7SPORTS has not earned. No invented testimonials. No borrowed client logos. No fabricated numbers presented as fact. If a number appears on screen, it carries the label "Illustrative". This is not caution. A premium brand is a trust product, and the fastest way to destroy trust with a business owner is for him to discover, three weeks later, that something we showed him was theatre.

Second, discipline on scope. The list of exclusions in Section 6 is not a starting position for negotiation. It is a boundary. If the owner asks for something on that list during the walkthrough, you do not agree, and you do not refuse. You log it, you name the phase it belongs to, and you move on. I will back you every time you do this. I will not back you if you commit us to work we have not scoped.

Third, ownership of the unknown. You will not have every answer. That is expected — this is a pre-discovery phase, which by definition means we know less than we will. What is not acceptable is bluffing. When you do not know, the answer is: "I don't know yet. I will confirm by

[date].” Say it to me, say it to the team, say it to the owner. Confident uncertainty reads as competence. Fabricated certainty reads as amateurism the moment it is tested.

You will notice this handbook is heavier on process than on design. That is deliberate. The design work in this project is genuinely not the hard part. The hard part is holding a small student-led team to professional standards, keeping a paying stakeholder calibrated, and delivering a demo that is persuasive without being dishonest. Those are leadership problems, not Figma problems.

One last thing. You are going to be tempted, at some point in the next few weeks, to solve a problem by working harder — longer hours, more screens, more polish. Resist it. This project is won by deciding well, not by producing more. The single most valuable hour you spend will be the hour you spend deciding what not to build.

I am available. Use the batched-question protocol in Section 35 and I will turn things around quickly. Do not sit blocked.

— **[FOUNDER NAME] FOUNDER TO CONFIRM:** signature name and title to appear on the issued copy. AASIOM Pvt Ltd

2. Project Vision

2.1 Purpose of this section

To give you the one-paragraph answer you will need to repeat perhaps fifty times over the coming weeks: to your team, to the owner, to yourself when a decision is unclear.

2.2 The vision statement

> VK7SPORTS is a premium sportswear business whose commercial strength — deep offline relationships with schools, colleges, academies, clubs and corporates — is currently trapped inside WhatsApp threads and phone calls. The prototype we are building demonstrates what it would look like if that strength were given a professional digital surface: one where an institutional buyer can specify a bulk requirement, a team manager can submit a custom teamwear brief, and the VK7SPORTS team can respond with structure instead of scrambling — without abandoning the human relationships and WhatsApp habits that already work.

2.3 What this vision explicitly is not

It is not	Because
A plan to replace WhatsApp	WhatsApp is working. We are giving it structure, not competing with it.
A plan to automate the owner's judgement	Quotations involve fabric, margin, relationship and timing. The system routes; humans decide.
An e-commerce launch	Retail is the third priority and is present mainly to establish visual trust.
A commitment to build anything	This phase produces a prototype and a proposal. Nothing more.

2.4 Why it matters

Every scope argument you will have traces back to a disagreement about the vision. When a team member proposes a feature, the test is not "is this a good idea" — it is "does this demonstrate the vision above." Almost everything fails that test. That is the point.

2.5 How you use this operationally

Put the vision statement at the top of the Demo PRD, at the top of the single source-of-truth document, and on the first slide of every internal review. When someone proposes work, read the statement aloud and ask them to connect their proposal to it in one sentence. If they cannot, the proposal goes to the Phase 2/3 backlog.

2.6 Definition of success for this section

Every member of the team can state the project vision in their own words, unprompted, by the end of Week 1. Test this in a standup. If they cannot, you have a communication problem, not a design problem.

FOUNDER TIP: The owner's version of the vision matters more than ours. During the first conversation, listen for the phrase *he* uses to describe his pain — "I'm on WhatsApp till 11 at night", "I lose track of who I quoted what". Write it down verbatim. That sentence becomes the opening line of your demo (Section 37).

3. Business Background

3.1 Purpose

You cannot design a workflow you do not understand. This section captures what is confirmed about VK7SPORTS, what is assumed, and what you must go and find out.

3.2 Confirmed business profile

Attribute	Detail
Category	Premium sportswear
Customer types	Retail consumers; bulk institutional buyers
Institutional segments	Schools, colleges, academies, sports clubs, corporates
Product lines	Custom jerseys, teamwear, corporate uniforms, retail sportswear
Current operating mode	Primarily offline relationships
Current enquiry channel	WhatsApp-based workflows, phone, walk-ins, referrals
Current digital presence	**FOUNDER TO CONFIRM**

3.3 Business scale

Research supplied to this project cites a monthly revenue figure of approximately ₹1 crore.

WARNING: Do not use this figure — or any derived figure — anywhere in the prototype, in the deck, or in conversation with the owner unless I confirm it in writing. Unverified financial claims about a client's business, repeated back to that client, are a credibility risk with no upside. Treat the figure as *internal context for sizing your thinking*, not as a fact you may state.

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: verified revenue scale, order volume per month, average bulk order size, peak season months.

3.4 Why the business works today

This is the part inexperienced teams skip, and it is the part that determines whether the owner trusts you.

VK7SPORTS wins business through **relationship, responsiveness, and physical trust** — a coach knows the owner, sends a WhatsApp voice note, gets a reply in twenty minutes, sees a physical

sample, and places an order. Nothing digital in our prototype is better than that at winning the *first* order.

What digital can improve is what happens **after** the relationship exists:

Current friction (hypothesis)	Digital opportunity
Enquiries arrive across four channels and are held in memory	One place where every enquiry lands with structure
Quotation variables are re-explained on every call	A structured brief captured once
Artwork approval happens over forwarded images	A visible approval step with a record of who approved what, when
Roster data (names, numbers, sizes) arrives as photos of paper	A structured roster capture
Follow-up depends on the owner remembering	Visible status of every open enquiry

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: which of the five frictions above the owner actually feels most acutely. Ask him. Do not assume. The one he names becomes the emotional centre of the demo.

3.5 Competitive and reference context

The reference site supplied for structural analysis is **wildshark-b2b.com**. Your task with this reference is narrow and specific:

Step-by-step: how to audit the reference site

1. Open the site on mobile first, then desktop. Note which experience feels primary.
2. Map its sitemap in a spreadsheet — every top-level and second-level page.
3. For each B2B interaction, record: what information it asks for, in what order, and what it promises in return.
4. Identify how it separates browsing from enquiry. This is the single most important structural question for us.
5. Record three things it does well and three things that would fail for an Indian institutional buyer.
6. Write a one-page memo. Do not write ten pages.

WARNING: Auditing a reference site is research, not a design brief. You are extracting *structural logic*, not visual direction. If a screen in our prototype looks like a copy of Wildshark, that is a review failure, not a shortcut.

3.6 Common mistakes

Mistake	Consequence	Correct behaviour
Assuming the owner wants to “go digital”	You design a replacement, he wanted an assistant	Design for augmentation; see Section 6 exclusions and Section 43
Treating retail as the main journey	You optimise the least commercially important flow	Follow the priority order in Section 5
Repeating the ₹1 crore figure	Credibility damage if wrong	Treat as internal only until confirmed
Designing for a national audience	The business is relationship-local	Design for the buyer types actually named above

3.7 Definition of success

You can describe, in three minutes and without notes, how a bulk order currently travels from first WhatsApp message to delivery — including every point where the owner personally intervenes. Until you can do this, you are not ready to design the flow.

4. Demo Objective

4.1 Purpose

To state, in unambiguous terms, what this phase is being measured on — so that no effort is spent on things that do not move that measure.

4.2 The objective

Secure the owner's approval and funding for the Discovery Phase.

That is the objective. It is binary. The prototype is a means; the approval is the outcome.

4.3 The eight things the prototype must demonstrate

These are the demonstration requirements. Every screen in the prototype must serve at least one of them; any screen that serves none is out of scope.

#	Demonstration requirement	Primary evidence in prototype
D1	Owner confidence — that this team can execute	Overall polish, coherence, absence of gaps
D2	Premium branding	Visual system, restraint, typography, whitespace
D3	Retail journey	Home → category → PDP → cart (illustrative)
D4	Institutional bulk journey	Entry → requirement capture → enquiry → quotation view
D5	Custom teamwear workflow	Brief capture → roster upload → artwork upload
D6	Quotation workflow	Quote presentation, tiering, human review indication
D7	Mock-up approval workflow	Mockup preview → approve / request changes → audit trail
D8	Internal enquiry handling	Internal worklist / status view showing how the team responds

WARNING: D8 is the one most teams under-build because it is the least glamorous. It is also, for a business owner drowning in follow-ups, frequently the most persuasive screen in the entire prototype. Give it real attention.

4.4 Why it matters

Defining success as “approval” rather than “a good prototype” changes your prioritisation constantly and correctly. A slightly rougher screen that answers the owner’s real worry beats a beautiful screen that answers nobody’s.

4.5 Secondary measures

These do not replace the primary objective but tell you whether the phase was run well:

Measure	Target
Workflow corrections the owner identifies during walkthrough	3–8 is healthy — it means he engaged and we learned
Prohibited-scope items appearing in the final prototype	Zero
Fake trust elements (fake logos, testimonials, invented metrics)	Zero
Sprints delivered on schedule	3 of 3
Owner questions you could not answer or defer cleanly	Zero

FOUNDER TIP: If the owner asks *zero* questions during the walkthrough, that is a bad sign, not a good one. It usually means he has disengaged or is being polite. Section 39 covers how to provoke real reaction.

4.6 Definition of success

Written approval from the owner, referencing a specific prototype version, to proceed to Discovery — captured using the approval record template in Section 47.

4.7 Checklist

- ☐ Every screen in the screen inventory maps to at least one of D1–D8
- ☐ D8 (internal enquiry handling) has been given equal design attention to D4
- ☐ The demo script (Section 37) explicitly lands each of D1–D8
- ☐ Success is defined in writing and agreed with the founder before Sprint 1 ends

5. Project Scope

5.1 Purpose

To define exactly what is being built, in what order, at what fidelity — so that "done" is not a matter of opinion.

5.2 What is in scope

Deliverable 1 — Demo PRD (Section 13) A short written decision document: objective, stakeholder, journeys, exclusions, assumptions, approval criteria.

Deliverable 2 — Clickable Figma prototype Mobile-first, with desktop views for key screens. Covering the three journeys below.

Deliverable 3 — Exclusions document (Section 6) One page. Presented *before* the demo begins.

Deliverable 4 — Owner walkthrough deck and script (Sections 36–37)

Deliverable 5 — Phase 2/3 backlog Every deferred idea, with the phase it belongs to and a one-line rationale.

Deliverable 6 — Supporting registers Assumption, Decision, Risk, Dependency (Sections 20–23).

5.3 Journey priority — locked

This order is a founder decision. It is not open to re-litigation by the team.

Priority	Journey	Rationale
P1	Institutional bulk enquiry	Highest commercial value; demonstrates the operational upgrade the owner actually feels
P2	Custom teamwear brief and approval	Proves digital brief collection and approval without any 3D technology
P3	Retail	Industry baseline; establishes B2C visual trust and premium perception

Operational consequence: if the schedule slips, retail fidelity is reduced first. Never the other way round.

5.4 Fidelity ladder per module

Use this table to settle "how finished does this need to be" arguments in seconds.

Module	Must show (fully designed, clickable)	Can simulate (static or single-state)	Excluded
Homepage	Premium value proposition, three journey entry points	Secondary marketing sections	Blog, careers, press
Retail category + PDP	One category, one PDP with size/variant selection	Other categories as static tiles	Real inventory, live stock
Retail cart/checkout	Cart summary, illustrative order confirmation	Address and shipping steps as single static screen	Payment gateway, real tax logic
Bulk enquiry entry	Full requirement capture form, mobile-first	Secondary field variants	Login, account management
Bulk quotation view	Quote presentation with two tiers	Quote history list	Real pricing engine, GST calculation
Custom teamwear brief	Brief capture, roster upload, artwork upload	Alternate upload states	3D configurator, live rendering
Mockup approval	Mockup preview, approve / request-changes, audit strip	Rejection reason variants	Real file versioning
Internal worklist	Enquiry list with status, one detail view, action-items card	Filter and search states	Role-based access, permissions, real admin

WARNING: “Can simulate” does not mean “can be sloppy”. It means one well-designed state instead of a full interactive set. A simulated screen with placeholder text is a defect; a simulated screen with realistic content and no interactivity is correct.

5.5 Platform scope

Platform	Requirement
Mobile	**Primary.** Every in-scope screen designed mobile-first and reviewed on a physical phone.
Desktop	Required for: homepage, PDP, quotation view, internal worklist. Optional elsewhere.

Tablet	Out of scope.
Native app	Out of scope — see Section 6.

5.6 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Designing all three journeys to equal depth	Follow P1 > P2 > P3. Depth follows priority.
Building every state of every screen	Use the fidelity ladder. Two states well-built beat six half-built.
Treating desktop as the design surface and shrinking it	Mobile first, always. See Section 42.
Adding a screen because a flow “felt incomplete”	Every screen enters via the Screen Inventory (Section 17). No screen is created ad hoc.

5.7 Definition of success

The screen inventory is complete, every screen maps to the fidelity ladder, and no screen exists in the Figma file that is not on the inventory.

5.8 Checklist

- ☐ Demo PRD written and approved before high-fidelity design begins
- ☐ Journey priority communicated to every team member in writing
- ☐ Fidelity ladder pinned in the source-of-truth document
- ☐ Screen inventory reconciled against the Figma file weekly

6. Project Exclusions

6.1 Purpose

This is the most operationally important section in the handbook. It is the list you will point at, calmly and repeatedly, for the next several weeks.

6.2 The exclusion list — absolute

Nothing on this list may appear in the prototype, be designed, be prototyped as a “quick mock”, or be verbally promised.

#	Excluded	Category
X1	Production backend of any kind	Engineering
X2	APIs	Engineering
X3	Databases	Engineering
X4	Payment gateway integration	Engineering
X5	ERP integration	Engineering
X6	Tally integration	Engineering
X7	Dealer portal	Product
X8	Admin dashboard (production-grade, role-based)	Product
X9	Mobile application	Product
X10	3D configurator	Product
X11	International checkout	Product
X12	Fake claims	Integrity
X13	Fake testimonials	Integrity
X14	Fake client logos	Integrity

6.3 The distinction that will confuse your team

Two items need careful reading, because the boundary is fine and your team will get it wrong.

X8 — Admin dashboard vs. the in-scope internal worklist. D8 in Section 4 requires us to demonstrate internal enquiry handling. That is *one illustrative internal view*: a list of enquiries with status, one detail view, and an action-items card. It is a demonstration of a concept.

An **admin dashboard** — user roles, permissions, settings, configuration, analytics, bulk actions, exports — is excluded. If a designer starts adding a settings gear icon or a "Users" nav item, that is X8 creeping in. Stop it.

X10 — 3D configurator vs. the in-scope mockup preview. We show *static, well-rendered mockup images* of a jersey with a placeholder logo and player name (Section 5.4). We do not build, prototype, or promise any interactive rotation, live colour change, or real-time rendering.

FOUNDER TIP: The phrase to use with the owner is: *"In the prototype we're showing you what an approved mockup looks like. Producing those mockups from your artwork is a Discovery-phase question — it affects cost and timeline significantly, so we don't want to guess at it today."* That is honest, it defers cleanly, and it signals we take his money seriously.

6.4 Handling the marked-content rule

Any information in the prototype that is not a confirmed VK7SPORTS fact must be visibly marked. Approved labels:

Label	Use for
Illustrative	Data, metrics, timelines shown for demonstration
Sample	Example institutions, orders, names, quantities
Prototype Only	Functionality shown but not built

Additionally, every screen carries the persistent footer: **"Prototype — Not Yet Live"**, and every screen carries a discreet "PROTOTYPE" watermark (Section 19).

WARNING: The marking rule is not satisfied by mentioning it verbally during the demo. The owner will forward screenshots. The label must live in the pixels.

6.5 The exclusions document

A one-page artefact, presented **before** the walkthrough starts — not at the end.

Template — Exclusions One-Pager

```
VK7SPORTS — WEBSITE DEMO PROTOTYPE
WHAT THIS PROTOTYPE IS, AND WHAT IT IS NOT
Version [v] · [DATE]


WHAT YOU ARE ABOUT TO SEE
A clickable design prototype covering three journeys:
bulk institutional enquiry, custom teamwear, and retail browsing.
```

```
Its purpose is to agree the direction before anything is built.

WHAT IT DOES
· Shows the screens, the flow, and the visual direction
· Lets you click through complete journeys
· Shows how enquiries would reach your team

WHAT IT DOES NOT DO — AND WHY
· It does not calculate real prices        (pricing rules are a Discovery question)
· It does not process payments             (requires backend + gateway decisions)
· It does not connect to Tally or any ERP  (integration scope is not yet defined)
· It does not store or send real data      (no database exists)
· It is not a mobile app                   (out of scope for this phase)
· All data shown is illustrative           (labelled on every screen)

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT
On your approval, Phase 2 — Discovery — begins on [DATE].
Discovery covers: [5–7 specific activities, see Section 18/Exclusions presentation]

Prepared by: Pradnya Gaikwad, Project Lead
AASIOM Pvt Ltd
```

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: Discovery Phase duration, start date, activity list, and investment figure.

6.6 The standard deflection script

Memorise this. You will use it more than any other sentence in this project.

> *"That's a strong idea, and I want to make sure it gets done properly rather than sketched. Let me log it for the Discovery phase with a clear priority — that way we cost it and scope it rather than assume it."*

Then, visibly, write it down. The act of writing it down in front of the person is what makes the deferral feel like respect rather than refusal.

6.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Why it is fatal
Designing an excluded feature "just to see"	It will end up in the file, then in a review, then in the owner's expectations
Agreeing to an exclusion request in the demo room	You have just created an uncosted obligation
Presenting exclusions at the end of the demo	Too late — expectations have already formed
Marking data as illustrative only in the deck	The screenshot travels without the deck

6.8 Definition of success

Zero excluded items present in the final prototype file. Zero unmarked illustrative data. The owner can state, unprompted, at least three things the prototype does not do.

6.9 Checklist

- ☐ Exclusion list read aloud to the whole team at kickoff
- ☐ Exclusions one-pager produced and reviewed by founder before demo
- ☐ Every screen carries footer disclaimer and watermark
- ☐ Every data point labelled Illustrative / Sample / Prototype Only
- ☐ Deflection script rehearsed out loud at least three times before demo day

7. Pradnya's Mission

7.1 Mission statement

> Deliver a clickable, premium, honest prototype that earns funding for the Discovery Phase — on schedule, within the locked scope, with every assumption visible and every decision recorded.

7.2 The four jobs inside that mission

Everything you do reduces to one of these. When you are unsure how to spend an hour, ask which of the four it serves.

Job 1 — Document owner. There is one source of truth and you own it. The Demo PRD, the registers, the screen inventory. If information exists only in a conversation, it does not exist.

Job 2 — Scope gatekeeper. You are the only person authorised to add work to this project. Not the designer, not the owner in a meeting, not enthusiasm. See Section 9.

Job 3 — Critique facilitator. You run the reviews. You set the question, you keep feedback structured, you triage every note within 24 hours. See Sections 27–28.

Job 4 — Acceptance coordinator. You define what "done" means, you verify it, and you capture approval in writing against a specific version. See Sections 25, 46, 47.

7.3 What is explicitly not your job

Not your job	Whose it is
Producing the visual design	UI Designer
Writing all the copy	UX Writer / Content Strategist
Deciding commercial terms and pricing	Founder
Deciding what VK7SPORTS' business rules are	Owner, via founder
Being the most creative person in the room	Nobody — creativity is distributed

WARNING: The most common failure mode for a first-time Project Lead is doing the team's work instead of leading it. If you are pushing pixels at 11pm, you are not leading — you are absorbing. Escalate instead.

7.4 Your success is measured by

Measure	Not measured by
The owner funds Discovery	How many screens exist
Zero excluded scope in the file	How beautiful the homepage is
Every assumption visible and dated	How many hours you worked
The team knows what to do without asking you daily	How busy you appear

7.5 Definition of success

At the end of this phase, another person could pick up your source-of-truth document and continue the project without speaking to you.

8. Roles and Responsibilities

8.1 Purpose

To eliminate the dozens of “who does this?” questions that otherwise consume a small team.

8.2 The team

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: final team composition, names, and availability per week.

Role	Core responsibility	Reports to
Founder	Commercial terms, business facts, final strategic direction, owner relationship	—
Pradnya Gaikwad — Project Lead / Product Strategist / UX Planning Lead	Scope, documentation, journeys, IA, reviews, acceptance, demo	Founder
UX Lead / UX support	Flow mapping, wireframes, journey detail, usability testing	Pradnya
UI Designer	Visual system, high-fidelity screens, Figma prototype wiring	Pradnya
UX Writer / Content Strategist	All on-screen copy, sample data, labels, empty states	Pradnya
QA / Reviewer	Prototype click-through testing, inventory reconciliation, defect log	Pradnya

Where one person holds several of these roles, the *responsibilities* still apply separately. Do not let role-merging collapse the review structure — the person who designed a screen does not sign off on that screen.

8.3 RACI — by workstream

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one person, owns the outcome) · **C** = Consulted · **I** = Informed

Workstream	Founder	Pradnya	UX	UI	Content	QA
Business facts and constraints	A/R	C	I	I	I	I
Demo PRD	A	R	C	C	C	I

Journey mapping	I	A	R	C	C	I
Information architecture	I	A/R	C	C	C	I
Screen inventory	I	A/R	C	C	I	C
Wireframes	I	A	R	C	C	I
Visual system	I	A	C	R	I	I
High-fidelity screens	I	A	C	R	C	C
On-screen copy and sample data	C	A	C	C	R	C
Figma prototype wiring	I	A	C	R	I	C
Prototype QA	I	A	C	C	I	R
Registers (assumption/decision/risk/dependency)	C	A/R	C	C	I	C
Exclusions document	A	R	C	C	C	I
Demo deck and script	C	A/R	C	C	C	I
Owner walkthrough	C	A/R	C	C	I	I
Commercial proposal	A/R	C	I	I	I	I

WARNING: Note that "Accountable" is a single letter in every row. If two people are accountable, nobody is. Where you see A on your row, you cannot delegate the outcome — only the work.

8.4 Step-by-step: publishing the RACI

1. Fill in the actual names against roles.
2. Circulate it in the project channel on Day 1 with the message: *"This is who owns what. If you disagree with a row, tell me today, not in Week 3."*
3. Pin it in the source-of-truth document.
4. Re-read it at the start of every sprint review. Adjust if reality has drifted.

8.5 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Assuming role clarity because the team is small	Small teams have *more* role confusion, not less — everyone assumes someone else is handling it

Letting the designer own acceptance of their own work	Separate maker from approver, always
Leaving the founder as “C” on business facts	Business facts are founder-owned. Never invent them.

8.6 Checklist

- ☐ RACI published with real names by end of Day 1
- ☐ Every team member has confirmed they understand their rows
- ☐ No workstream has two Accountables
- ☐ No person is Accountable for approving their own output

9. Authority and Decision Boundaries

9.1 Purpose

To tell you precisely what you can decide alone, what you must consult on, and what you must never decide. This section exists so you can move fast without checking in — and so you know exactly where the line is.

9.2 The three-tier decision model

Tier 1 — Decide alone, announce within 24 hours

You have full authority. Decide, log it in the Decision Register, announce it in the project channel. Do not wait for me.

- Screen inventory additions and removals *within* the approved fidelity ladder
- Layout, hierarchy, and interaction patterns
- Copy tone and specific wording
- Sample data content (names, quantities, timestamps) within the rules in Section 43
- Sprint task allocation and sequencing
- Meeting cadence and format
- Which critique notes are accepted, rejected, or deferred
- Design system decisions: type scale, spacing, icon set, colour usage
- Naming conventions, folder structure, file versioning
- Whether a screen has passed internal acceptance
- Whether an assumption is Confirmed, Pending, or Risky

FOUNDER TIP: Speed matters more than perfection at this tier. A decided-and-announced Tier 1 decision that turns out to be 80% right is worth more than a perfect decision made four days late. Reversibility is high here; treat it accordingly.

Tier 2 — Consult the founder, then decide

Prepare a Decision Brief (template below), send it, get input, then you decide and record.

- Changes to journey priority order
- Changes to the fidelity ladder for any module
- Adding a screen that does not fit any existing module
- Anything that will push a sprint milestone
- Introducing a new tool the team must adopt
- Bringing an external person into a review
- How to phrase an exclusion or limitation to the owner

- Whether to run usability testing with outsiders, and with whom
- Any change to the demo narrative structure

Tier 3 — Founder decides. You do not.

You may recommend. You may not commit.

- **Any change to the exclusion list in Section 6**
- Commercial terms, pricing, investment figures, payment schedules
- Discovery Phase scope, duration, and dates
- Contractual commitments of any kind
- Statements of fact about VK7SPORTS' business (revenue, client names, volumes)
- Anything said in a meeting that begins "yes, we can build…"
- Team composition and compensation
- Public or client-facing communication outside the agreed artefacts

WARNING: The single most damaging thing you can do in this project is make a Tier 3 decision in a room because it felt awkward to defer. It is never awkward to say "that's a founder decision and I'll get you an answer by Friday." It is extremely awkward to walk back a commitment.

9.3 The decision-boundary decision tree

```
A decision is needed.
│
├─ Does it change what we promise, cost, or commit to?
│    └─ YES → TIER 3. Founder decides. Log the recommendation, stop.
│
├─ Does it change scope, priority, fidelity, schedule, or tooling?
│    └─ YES → TIER 2. Write a Decision Brief. Consult. Then decide and log.
│
├─ Does it state a fact about VK7SPORTS' business?
│    └─ YES → TIER 3 (or FOUNDER TO CONFIRM). Never invent. Log to Open Questions.
│
└─ Otherwise
     └─ TIER 1. Decide within 24 hours. Log it. Announce it.
```

9.4 Template — Decision Brief (Tier 2)

Keep it to one page. If it needs two, the decision is not yet clear enough to make.

```
DECISION BRIEF · [DB-###]
Date: [DATE]        Requested by: Pradnya Gaikwad
Decision needed by: [DATE — be specific]


THE DECISION
[One sentence. What must be decided.]


WHY IT MATTERS NOW
[Two to three sentences. What is blocked, what is at risk.]


OPTIONS
Option A — [name]
```

```
  What it means:
  Cost / time impact:
  Risk:
Option B — [name]
  What it means:
  Cost / time impact:
  Risk:
Option C — Do nothing / defer
  Consequence:

MY RECOMMENDATION
[Option X], because [one sentence].

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU
[A yes/no, or a choice between A and B. Make it easy to answer.]
```

FOUNDER TIP: Never bring me a problem. Bring me a decision with a recommendation. A brief I can answer with one word is worth ten times a brief that requires a meeting.

9.5 Template — Decision Register entry

Every decision at every tier gets an entry. Two minutes each.

```
DEC-###  |  [DATE]
Decision:      [What was decided, in one sentence]
Tier:          1 / 2 / 3
Decided by:    [Name]
Rationale:     [Why. One or two sentences.]
Alternatives:  [What was considered and rejected]
Impacts:       [Screens / documents / people affected]
Status:        Active / Superseded by DEC-###
```

9.6 Common mistakes

Mistake	Consequence	Correction
Escalating Tier 1 decisions	You become a bottleneck and appear indecisive	Decide, log, announce
Deciding Tier 3 in a live meeting	Uncosted obligation, founder overruled in front of client	Use the deflection script (6.6)
Deciding without logging	Decision is re-litigated in Week 4	Two-minute register entry, every time
Recording the decision but not the rationale	You cannot defend it later	Rationale is the most valuable field

9.7 Definition of success

Over the project, you make dozens of Tier 1 decisions quickly and none of them surprise me; you send me a small number of clean Tier 2 briefs; and you make exactly zero Tier 3 decisions.

9.8 Checklist

- ☐ Decision tiers understood and pinned in your working notes
- ☐ Decision Register created before Sprint 1
- ☐ Deflection script rehearsed
- ☐ Every Tier 1 decision announced in the project channel within 24 hours
- ☐ Zero Tier 3 commitments made outside the founder

10. Daily Responsibilities

10.1 Purpose

To give you a repeatable daily loop, so that no day is spent reacting.

10.2 Why it matters

In a short project run by a part-time student team, the failure mode is not laziness — it is drift. Three days pass, everyone is busy, and nothing has moved through the board. A fixed daily loop makes drift visible within 24 hours instead of within a week.

10.3 The daily loop

Time	Activity	Duration
Start of day	Review the board. Identify what moved and what did not.	10 min
Start of day	Check the Blocker Board. Any blocker older than 24h gets a named owner and an action today.	5 min
Mid-morning	Standup — 15 minutes, hard stop (Section 33).	15 min
Through the day	Unblock. This is your highest-value activity.	Variable
Late afternoon	Reconcile Figma against the Screen Inventory. Any new frame not on the inventory is investigated.	10 min
End of day	Log any decisions made today. Update assumption statuses if anything was confirmed.	10 min
End of day	Post a two-line update in the project channel: what moved, what is blocked.	5 min

Total structured time: roughly one hour. Everything else is judgement and unblocking.

10.4 Step-by-step: the daily Figma reconciliation

This is the single habit that prevents scope creep from becoming invisible.

1. Open the Figma file's version history.
2. Compare the frames present against the Screen Inventory spreadsheet.
3. For any frame not on the inventory, ask: was this authorised?
    - If yes but unlogged → add to inventory, note who created it.

- If no → speak to the creator the same day. Do not let it sit.

4. For any inventory item with no frame, check it is not silently blocked.
5. Note the reconciliation in your daily log.

WARNING: An unauthorised frame is not a design problem. It is a signal that someone on the team does not understand the scope boundary, and that will express itself again in a worse way later. Address the cause, not the frame.

10.5 The unblocking discipline

Your job is to make sure nobody on the team is stuck for more than half a day.

Blocker type	Your action
Missing content	Write it yourself or assign it now; do not wait for perfect copy
Missing asset (photo, logo)	Check the Dependency Register; provide an approved substitute today
Unclear requirement	Decide it (Tier 1) or brief it (Tier 2). Do not leave it open.
Missing business fact	Add to the Owner Question List. Give the team an explicit interim assumption so they can proceed.
Interpersonal / capacity	Handle privately, same day

FOUNDER TIP: When you cannot remove a blocker, give the team a *documented assumption to work against*. "Assume bulk discount tiers exist at 25/50/100 units — logged as ASM-014, Pending" is infinitely more useful than "waiting on the owner". Work continues; the assumption is visible; nothing is invented silently.

10.6 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Spending the day designing instead of unblocking	Your throughput is the team's throughput, not your own output
Letting standup run 40 minutes	Hard stop at 15. Take detail offline.
Skipping the daily log because "nothing happened"	Days where nothing happened are exactly the days worth logging
Reconciling Figma weekly instead of daily	A week of drift takes a week to unwind

10.7 Definition of success

No team member is blocked for more than half a working day. No unauthorised frame survives more than 24 hours. Every decision made today is written down today.

10.8 Daily checklist

- ☐ Board reviewed
- ☐ Blockers aged and owned
- ☐ Standup held, 15 minutes, ended on time
- ☐ Figma reconciled against Screen Inventory
- ☐ Decisions logged
- ☐ Assumption statuses updated
- ☐ Two-line channel update posted

11. Weekly Responsibilities

11.1 Purpose

The weekly loop is where you manage risk, communicate outward, and protect the schedule. Daily is about flow; weekly is about direction.

11.2 The weekly rhythm

Day	Activity	Section reference
Monday	Scope review — reconcile the week's plan against the PRD and priority order	5, 13
Tuesday	Design critique — structured, three hats, top three issues only	27
Wednesday	Dependency check — every dependency aged, chased, or escalated	23
Thursday	Register maintenance — assumptions, risks, decisions reviewed and updated	20–22
Friday	Internal demo (30 min) + weekly update sent + reflection note	45, 13.6

11.3 Step-by-step: the Friday update

Fixed format. Same five sections, same order, every week. Predictability is the point — it makes the update readable in ninety seconds.

Template — Friday Update

```
VK7SPORTS PROTOTYPE — WEEK [N] UPDATE
[DATE] · Prototype version: v0.[x]


1. DONE THIS WEEK
   · [Item] — [one line of outcome, not activity]
   · [Item]
   · [Item]


2. IN PROGRESS
   · [Item] — [% or state] — [owner] — [expected complete]


3. BLOCKED
   · [Item] — blocked by [what] — owner [who] — age [N days]
   (If nothing is blocked, write "Nothing blocked." Do not omit the section.)


4. NEXT WEEK
   · [Three to five items maximum]
```

```
5. DECISIONS THIS WEEK
   · DEC-### [decision] — [one-line rationale]

TOP 3 RISKS + MITIGATION
   · [Risk] → [what we are doing about it]

OPEN QUESTION FOR YOU
   · [One question, if any. Make it answerable.]

WALKTHROUGH: [3-minute recorded walkthrough link of current state]
```

FOUNDER TIP: The “Done this week” bullets should describe outcomes, not activity. “Worked on the bulk flow” tells me nothing. “Bulk enquiry flow now clickable end-to-end on mobile; roster upload state still static” tells me exactly where we are.

11.4 The recorded walkthrough

Every Friday, record a three-minute screen walkthrough of the prototype’s current state and attach it to the update.

Why: People absorb motion faster than text. A three-minute video removes an entire round of clarifying questions. It also creates a dated visual record of progress that is invaluable if anyone later disputes what was delivered when.

How: 1. Open the prototype in presentation mode. 2. Say what changed since last week, in one sentence. 3. Click through the changed flow at natural speed. 4. Name what is still incomplete and when it will be done. 5. Stop at three minutes. Do not re-record for perfection.

11.5 The weekly reflection note

Three to five sentences, sent to the team every Friday. What went well, what did not, what to remember.

This is not a wellness exercise. It is how a team learns inside a six-week project — there is no time for lessons to emerge naturally, so you surface them deliberately.

Example:

> *This week we lost a day because the artwork upload screen was designed before the flow was agreed. That is on me — I approved design start without a mapped flow. From Monday, no screen enters design without a flow in the source-of-truth doc. Good work on the roster screen; it was the first thing this week I would put in front of the owner without changes.*

11.6 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction

Sending a weekly update with no risks section	Silence on risk reads as “not paying attention”, not “no risk”
Hiding a slipped item	Report it the week it slips. Slippage reported late is a trust problem, not a schedule problem.
Making the format different every week	Fixed format saves you prep time and saves me reading time
Reflection notes that are only positive	Nobody believes them, and nothing improves

11.7 Definition of success

I can read your Friday update in ninety seconds and know exactly where the project stands, what is at risk, and what you need from me.

11.8 Weekly checklist

- ☐ Scope reviewed against PRD
- ☐ Design critique held with a stated objective and three priority issues
- ☐ Every dependency aged and actioned
- ☐ All four registers updated
- ☐ Internal Friday demo held
- ☐ Weekly update sent in the fixed format
- ☐ Three-minute walkthrough recorded and linked
- ☐ Reflection note sent to team

12. Sprint Responsibilities

12.1 Purpose

Three sprints. Each has a distinct character, a distinct risk, and a distinct exit gate.

12.2 Sprint structure

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: sprint length (assume two weeks unless I confirm otherwise), start date, and demo date.

Sprint	Theme	Primary output	Exit gate
Sprint 1	Architecture and definition	Demo PRD, IA, journeys, screen inventory, wireframes, content map	Founder sign-off on PRD + wireframes. No high-fidelity work starts before this.
Sprint 2	Visual and content	High-fidelity screens for P1 and P2, visual system, real sample content, assets integrated	Internal acceptance of all P1 screens; P2 at least 80%
Sprint 3	Prototype, QA, and preparation	Full wiring, QA passes, outsider testing, deck, script, exclusions doc, rehearsal	Demo readiness gate (Section 44)

12.3 Sprint 1 in detail

Objective: make every subsequent decision cheap by making the structure explicit now.

Week	Focus
Days 1–2	Reference audit, business background write-up, kickoff, RACI, registers created, tooling set up
Days 3–5	Journeys mapped (P1, P2, P3), Information Architecture drafted
Days 6–8	Screen inventory built; Demo PRD written; content map started
Days 9–10	Wireframes for P1 and P2; internal review; founder sign-off

The dominant Sprint 1 risk: starting visual design early because wireframing feels slow. Do not allow it. Every hour of unclear structure costs three hours of rework in Sprint 2.

REVIEW GATE — end of Sprint 1 Design does not proceed until: PRD approved; every P1 and P2 screen on the inventory; every screen has a mapped flow; content map exists with no lorem ipsum planned.

12.4 Sprint 2 in detail

Objective: make it real, make it premium, make it honest.

Week	Focus
Days 1–3	Visual system locked: type scale, colour, spacing, icon set (Section 41)
Days 4–7	P1 (bulk) screens at high fidelity, mobile first
Days 8–10	P2 (custom teamwear) screens; sample data populated; asset integration

The dominant Sprint 2 risk: the Polish Trap — spending disproportionate time on the homepage while the bulk quotation workflow stays rough. Measure time spent per journey and correct visibly if it skews.

REVIEW GATE — end of Sprint 2 All P1 screens internally accepted. All sample data realistic and marked. No lorem ipsum anywhere. Mobile review passed on a physical device.

12.5 Sprint 3 in detail

Objective: turn screens into a persuasive, tested, well-governed demonstration.

Week	Focus
Days 1–3	Prototype wiring; Figma Flows separated by journey; no dead ends
Days 4–5	Internal QA pass; defect log; fixes
Days 6–7	Outsider comprehension testing (Section 40.6); confusion log; fixes
Days 8–9	Deck, script, exclusions one-pager, proposal inputs; rehearsal
Day 10	Final freeze, lock screens, dry run, demo readiness gate

The dominant Sprint 3 risk: running out of time for testing and rehearsal because design continued too long. Protect Days 6–9 absolutely. If something is not designed by Day 5 of Sprint 3, it does not ship.

REVIEW GATE — Demo readiness See Section 44. All items must be green. This gate is not negotiable and not partially passable.

12.6 Step-by-step: running a sprint review

1. **Before the meeting** — reconcile the inventory, update registers, prepare a one-page state summary.
2. **Open with the gate criteria**, not the work. Read them aloud.
3. **Walk the prototype**, not the file. Show what a user would see.
4. **Assess each gate criterion**: met / not met. No "mostly".
5. **For any unmet criterion**, decide: fix now, descope, or slip — and log the decision.
6. **Close with next sprint's gate criteria** read aloud.
7. **Publish the outcome** in writing within two hours.

WARNING: A sprint review that ends without a written pass/fail on each gate criterion has not happened. The whole value is the explicit judgement.

12.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Starting high-fidelity design in Sprint 1	Gate it. Wireframe first.
Treating sprint reviews as progress demos	They are gates. Judge against criteria.
Letting Sprint 3 design work eat testing time	Hard cutoff at Day 5 of Sprint 3
Carrying unfinished P1 work into Sprint 3	Descope P3 instead. Never compromise P1.

12.8 Definition of success

Three sprints, three gates, three written pass/fail records. No sprint ends with ambiguity about what was achieved.

12.9 Sprint checklist (use at every sprint boundary)

- ☐ Gate criteria read aloud and assessed individually
- ☐ Screen inventory reconciled
- ☐ All registers current
- ☐ Written outcome published within two hours
- ☐ Next sprint's criteria stated and understood
- ☐ Any slippage reported to founder the same day

13. Demo PRD Guide

13.1 Purpose

The Demo PRD is the single written source of truth for this phase. It is not a production specification. It is a short decision document whose job is to protect strategic clarity and give the project an approval path.

13.2 Why it matters

Without a written PRD, a prototype project becomes “design exploration” — activity without a destination. The PRD is what lets you say, three weeks in, “that is not what we agreed” and point at a sentence rather than a memory.

13.3 What a Demo PRD is not

Not	Why
A technical specification	No schemas, no data models, no API definitions — those are Discovery outputs
A long document	If it exceeds six pages, it has stopped being useful
A design brief	It defines outcomes and boundaries, not layouts
A living wish list	Scope is locked once approved. Changes go through Section 9 Tier 2.

13.4 The structure

Six sections, in this order. The order matters: exclusions appear early, not buried.

Template — VK7SPORTS Demo PRD

```
VK7SPORTS — WEBSITE DEMO PROTOTYPE
DEMO PRD v[X.Y] · [DATE] · Owner: Pradnya Gaikwad


_____________________________________________

1. BUSINESS OBJECTIVE
Secure owner approval and funding for the Discovery Phase.
Success is binary: approved, or not approved.


Secondary measures:
  · Workflow corrections identified by owner: target 3–8
  · Prohibited scope in final prototype: zero
  · Fake trust elements: zero


_____________________________________________

2. WHO WE ARE CONVINCING
Primary stakeholder: [OWNER NAME], Owner, VK7SPORTS
What he cares about:  [3 bullets, in his words where possible]
```

```
What he fears:        [2 bullets — e.g. cost, disruption to what works]
What will convince him: [2 bullets]

_____________________________________________

3. WHAT IS OUT OF SCOPE  (read this before section 4)
[Full list from Section 6 of the handbook, verbatim]
Marking rule: all non-confirmed information labelled
Illustrative / Sample / Prototype Only.

_____________________________________________

4. JOURNEYS COVERED
P1 — Institutional bulk enquiry
     Persona:   [who]
     Trigger:   [what starts it]
     Steps:     [entry → … → end state]
     End state: [what the user has achieved]
     Screens:   [inventory IDs]
     What must be clickable: [explicit]


P2 — Custom teamwear brief and approval
     [same structure]


P3 — Retail
     [same structure]


Internal — Enquiry handling (D8)
     [same structure]

_____________________________________________

5. ASSUMPTIONS AND OPEN QUESTIONS
Assumptions: [reference Assumption Register; list the ones
              that materially affect the prototype]
Open questions for owner: [batched list, see Section 35]

_____________________________________________

6. APPROVAL CRITERIA
This prototype is complete when:
  · [criterion]
  · [criterion]
Approval is captured against version v[X] using the
Approval Record in Section 47 of the operating handbook.

_____________________________________________

CHANGE LOG
v0.1  [date]  [what changed]  [who approved]
```

13.5 Step-by-step: writing it

1. **Write Section 1 and 2 first.** If you cannot describe who you are convincing and what he fears, stop and go find out. Do not proceed to journeys.
2. **Write Section 3 next.** Copy the exclusion list verbatim. Do not paraphrase it — paraphrasing softens it.
3. **Map journeys in the source-of-truth doc first**, then transcribe the agreed version here. The PRD records decisions; it is not where you think.
4. **Pull assumptions from the register**, do not invent them here. The register is the master.

5. **Write approval criteria last**, and make each one objectively testable. “Looks premium” is not a criterion. “Every screen passes the type-scale and whitespace rules in Section 41” is.
6. **Circulate for review.** Founder approves. Team reads and confirms.
7. **Version and freeze.** Changes after freeze require a Tier 2 Decision Brief.

13.6 Example — a good vs. bad journey entry

Bad: > *P1 — Bulk enquiry. User fills a form and submits an enquiry. Includes quantity and product details.*

Why it fails: no persona, no trigger, no end state, no screen mapping, no clickable definition. Nothing here can be tested or accepted.

Good: > *P1 — Institutional bulk enquiry > Persona: Sports coordinator at a school or academy, 30–50, mobile-first, WhatsApp-native, not the final budget approver. > Trigger: Needs teamwear for an upcoming season or event; has been referred to VK7SPORTS or found it while comparing. > Steps: Home → Bulk/Institutional entry point → requirement capture (product type, quantity, timeline, institution, role) → contact capture (WhatsApp primary) → submission confirmation → indicative quotation view with two fabric tiers → hand-off notice explaining a human will follow up. > End state: The user has submitted a structured requirement and understands what happens next and when. > Screens: BULK-01 through BULK-07 (mobile), BULK-Q1 (desktop + mobile). > Must be clickable: entry point, every form step, submit, quotation view, return to home. No dead ends.*

13.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Writing the PRD after design starts	Then it is documentation, not direction. Write it first.
Making it long	Six pages maximum. Length is not rigour.
Vague approval criteria	Every criterion must be objectively verifiable
Treating it as immutable	It can change — through Tier 2, versioned, with rationale
Burying exclusions at the end	Exclusions go in Section 3, before journeys

13.8 Definition of success

Any team member, reading only the PRD, can state what we are building, what we are not building, who we are convincing, and how we will know we are done.

13.9 Checklist

- ☐ Written before any design work
- ☐ Under six pages
- ☐ Exclusions verbatim, positioned before journeys
- ☐ Every journey has persona, trigger, steps, end state, screens, clickable definition
- ☐ Approval criteria are objectively testable
- ☐ Founder-approved and version-frozen
- ☐ Change log maintained

14. Requirement Gathering Guide

14.1 Purpose

To convert business reality into design requirements without inventing anything.

14.2 The core principle

> **Business constraints become UI features. Business unknowns become logged assumptions. Neither becomes a guess.**

The clearest example: VK7SPORTS runs on WhatsApp. That is a constraint. The design requirement it produces is *not* "replace WhatsApp with a form" — it is "make WhatsApp the primary contact field, make a prominent WhatsApp handoff visible in the bulk journey, and show a channel-handoff screen so the flow does not pretend to be fully automated."

14.3 Sources of requirements, in order of authority

Rank	Source	How to treat it
1	Founder-confirmed business facts	Authoritative. Build to them.
2	Owner's own words from discovery conversations	Authoritative for pain and language; verify anything factual
3	Reference site structural audit	Structural inspiration only, never a specification
4	Team inference and industry pattern	Becomes a logged assumption, never a silent fact

14.4 Step-by-step: the requirement gathering process

Step 1 — Harvest what exists. Read every note, message and document you have been given. Extract every statement about how the business works into a single list. Mark each: *Confirmed* / *Reported* / *Inferred*.

Step 2 — Map the current process. For each of the three journeys, write the current, offline version end to end. Where does an enquiry arrive? Who touches it? What decisions do they make? What information do they need that they routinely have to chase?

Step 3 — Identify the friction points. At each step, mark where time is lost, information is re-requested, or the owner personally has to intervene. These are your design opportunities.

Step 4 — Convert to requirements. Use this format. Every requirement traces to a business reality.

```
REQ-###
Business reality:   [what is true today]
Source:             Confirmed / Reported / Inferred (→ ASM-###)
Friction:           [what goes wrong]
Design requirement: [what the prototype must show]
Journey:            P1 / P2 / P3 / Internal
Demonstrates:       D1–D8
Screens:            [inventory IDs]
```

Step 5 — Log every unknown. Anything you needed and did not have becomes an entry in the Assumption Register and, if the owner can answer it, the Owner Question List.

Step 6 — Batch and ask. Never ask the owner or founder questions one at a time. Batch five to seven, ask once, get answers, proceed. See Section 35.

14.5 Worked example

```
REQ-007
Business reality:   Roster data (player names, numbers, sizes) currently
                    arrives as photographs of handwritten sheets.
Source:             Reported (→ ASM-011, status Pending)
Friction:           Manual transcription; errors in names and sizes;
                    re-confirmation cycles before production.
Design requirement: Roster capture screen supporting (a) structured
                    table entry and (b) CSV/sheet upload, with a visible
                    "our team will verify" human-in-the-loop badge.
Journey:            P2
Demonstrates:       D5
Screens:            TEAM-04, TEAM-04b (upload state), TEAM-04c (verified state)
```

14.6 The Owner Question List

Maintain one running list, organised by phase, batched before every owner contact.

Template

```
OWNER QUESTION LIST · updated [DATE]

FOR NEXT CONVERSATION (batch of 5–7, priority order)
Q1. [Question]  — blocks: [what]  — why we need it: [one line]
Q2. ...

ANSWERED
Q0. [Question] → [Answer] → [date] → updated ASM-###

DEFERRED TO DISCOVERY
Q. [Question] — reason: [not needed for prototype fidelity]
```

FOUNDER TIP: Owners judge you by the quality of your questions more than by your screens. A batch of seven sharp, specific questions — “when a school changes its order quantity after you’ve quoted, what do you have to redo?” — signals that you have thought about their business. Scattered ad-hoc questions signal the opposite.

14.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Designing around what would be ideal	Design around what is true, and log what is unknown
Asking questions one at a time	Batch. Always.
Treating inference as fact	Every inference becomes a logged assumption
Skipping the current-process map	You cannot improve a process you have not written down
Requirements with no traceable source	Every REQ names its source

14.8 Definition of success

Every design requirement in the project traces to a business reality or a logged assumption. There are no orphan requirements.

14.9 Checklist

- ☐ Current process mapped for all three journeys
- ☐ Every requirement in REQ format with a named source
- ☐ Every inference logged as an assumption
- ☐ Owner Question List maintained and batched
- ☐ No requirement exists without a journey and a D-mapping

15. Information Architecture Guide

15.1 Purpose

To build the structure of the prototype from user tasks, not from a marketing sitemap.

15.2 The governing principle

> **IA emerges from top tasks, not from page ambitions.**

If you start by listing pages, you will produce a website. If you start by listing what people are trying to do, you will produce a system that demonstrates the vision.

15.3 The top tasks

Task	Who	Journey
Explore what VK7SPORTS makes and judge quality	All	P1, P2, P3
Specify a bulk requirement and get a response	Institutional buyer	P1
Understand indicative options and pricing tiers	Institutional buyer	P1
Submit a custom teamwear brief	Team manager / coach	P2
Upload roster and artwork	Team manager / coach	P2
Review and approve a mock-up	Team manager / coach	P2
Buy a single item	Retail consumer	P3
See every open enquiry and what it needs today	VK7SPORTS internal team	D8

15.4 The sitemap — locked

Keep it small. A small, confident sitemap reads premium; a sprawling one reads unfinished.

```
HOME
│
├── RETAIL
│   ├── Category (one category built; others static tiles)
│   ├── Product Display Page (PDP)
│   └── Cart → Order confirmation (illustrative)
│
├── BULK / INSTITUTIONAL
│   ├── Landing — who it's for, how it works
│   ├── Requirement capture (multi-step, mobile-first)
│   ├── Submission confirmation
│   ├── Indicative quotation view (two tiers)
│   └── Channel handoff notice
│
```

```
├── CUSTOM TEAMWEAR
│   ├── Landing — what's possible
│   ├── Brief capture
│   ├── Roster upload
│   ├── Artwork upload
│   ├── Mock-up preview
│   └── Approval / request-changes + audit strip
│
├── ABOUT  (single page — credibility, no fake claims)
│
└── [INTERNAL — DEMONSTRATION ONLY]
    ├── Enquiry worklist (status per enquiry)
    ├── Enquiry detail
    └── Today's action items (mixed digital + call tasks)
```

WARNING: The internal section is explicitly labelled as a demonstration, sits behind a clearly marked entry point, and never presents itself as a production admin system. See exclusion X8.

15.5 The critical structural decision

The single most important IA decision in this project:

> **How the site separates browsing from enquiring.**

A retail visitor and an institutional buyer arrive at the same homepage with completely different intents. If the homepage forces the institutional buyer through a retail funnel, the prototype fails its primary demonstration.

The rule: the bulk/institutional entry point must be visible above the fold on mobile, and must be visually distinct from retail actions — not a nav item buried in a hamburger menu.

On the PDP, the same principle applies: "Add to Cart" (B2C) and "Request Quote / Bulk Enquiry" (B2B) must be visually separated and unambiguous. A buyer must never wonder which button applies to them.

15.6 Step-by-step: building the IA

1. List the top tasks (15.3). Confirm nothing is missing.
2. For each task, write the *minimum* set of screens required. Minimum, not comfortable.
3. Group screens into sections. Name sections in the user's language, not internal jargon.
4. Decide the navigation model — what appears in primary nav on mobile (maximum four items) and on desktop.
5. Test the structure against each journey: can a user complete it without backtracking more than once?
6. Test the "two doors" rule: from the homepage, can a retail buyer and an institutional buyer each find their path within one interaction?
7. Review with the team, log the decision, freeze.

15.7 Naming rules

Rule	Example
Use the buyer's word, not the industry's	"Bulk Orders", not "B2B Procurement"
Never make the user guess a category	"Custom Teamwear", not "Configure"
Avoid abstraction	"Get a Quote", not "Enquire"
Consistency beats cleverness	Same label everywhere for the same destination

FOUNDER TIP: Test labels by reading them aloud to someone outside the project (Section 40.6). If they hesitate before answering "what would you find there?", the label is wrong.

15.8 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Designing a marketing sitemap first	Start from tasks
Burying the bulk entry point	It is the P1 journey. Give it prominence.
More than four primary nav items on mobile	Cut. Ruthlessly.
Different labels for the same destination	Audit labels weekly
Making the internal view look like a real admin panel	Exclusion X8. Mark and constrain it.

15.9 Definition of success

Every top task can be completed from the homepage in the minimum number of steps, and an outsider can correctly predict what sits behind every navigation label.

15.10 Checklist

- ☐ IA derived from tasks, not pages
- ☐ Sitemap frozen and logged as a decision
- ☐ Bulk entry point visible above the fold on mobile
- ☐ B2C and B2B actions visually separated on the PDP
- ☐ Maximum four primary nav items on mobile
- ☐ Labels tested aloud with an outsider
- ☐ Internal section clearly marked as demonstration only

16. User Journey Planning

16.1 Purpose

To define, before any screen is drawn, exactly how each user gets from intent to outcome.

16.2 Why journeys precede screens

Screens designed without a mapped journey produce two predictable defects: dead ends, and steps that exist because they looked good rather than because they were needed. Both are visible to a business owner within thirty seconds of clicking.

16.3 The journey specification format

Every journey is documented in this format before design begins. This is the artefact the UX and UI work from.

```
JOURNEY [P1 / P2 / P3 / INTERNAL] — [NAME]

PERSONA
  Who:            [role, context]
  Device:         [mobile / desktop, and why]
  Digital comfort:[level]
  Decision power: [final approver / recommender / gatekeeper]

TRIGGER
  [What causes this person to start]

INTENT
  [What they are actually trying to achieve — not what they click]

STEPS
  1. [Step] → screen [ID] → key decision the user makes here
  2. ...

INFORMATION REQUIRED
  [What we ask for, at which step, and why it is needed there]

FRICTION POINTS
  [Where this could go wrong; how the design mitigates it]

HUMAN-IN-THE-LOOP POINTS
  [Where a VK7SPORTS person intervenes; how this is shown]

END STATE
  [What the user has achieved and what they now expect]

MUST BE CLICKABLE
  [Explicit list — this becomes the acceptance criterion]
```

16.4 The four journeys to map

P1 — Institutional bulk enquiry (highest priority)

Three institutional scenarios must be represented in sample data so the system does not look like it handles only one type of buyer:

Scenario	Sample institution	Quantity	Product
School	**Sample** — e.g. a named school, marked Sample	~120	Jerseys
Academy	**Sample** — e.g. a named cricket academy	~40	Training kits
Corporate	**Sample** — e.g. a corporate league team	~60	Polos

WARNING: Use realistic Indian institution names, clearly marked **Sample**. Never use a real institution's name without permission, and never imply they are a client. See Sections 43 and 6.

Design elements to include in P1:

- Role capture field: *"Your role: Coach / Manager / Principal / Committee / Other"* — this signals we understand committee-based institutional buying
- Quantity input with indicative pricing bands (marked Illustrative)
- Two-tier quote comparison: standard vs. premium fabric, with delivery time difference
- Bulk lead status timeline: **Enquiry → Quote → Sample → Order → Delivery**
- WhatsApp as primary contact field; email optional
- Channel-handoff screen acknowledging that follow-up moves to WhatsApp
- Human-in-the-loop badge at the quotation step

P2 — Custom teamwear brief and approval

Step	Screen concept
Brief capture	Product, sport, colours, timeline, quantity
Roster upload	Structured table + CSV/sheet upload; player name, number, size
Artwork upload	File upload **and** a prominent "Take photo of logo" option
Mock-up preview	Static, well-rendered jersey mockup with placeholder logo and name
Approval	Approve / Request Changes, with reason options (logo quality, colour, spelling)
Audit strip	"Approved by [Sample name] on [Sample date, IST]"

Why the camera option matters: coaches in the field have the logo on a jersey, not as a vector file. A camera-first upload demonstrates that we understand the reality, not just the ideal.

P3 — Retail

Kept deliberately conventional. Home → category → PDP → cart → illustrative confirmation. The purpose is visual trust and B2C baseline credibility, not innovation. Do not spend disproportionate effort here.

Internal — Enquiry handling (D8)

Screen	Content
Worklist	Every enquiry with status, institution, quantity, age, and next action
Detail	One enquiry expanded, showing the captured brief and history
Today's action items	Mixed card: *"3 enquiries need a phone call today"*, *"1 awaiting logo from client"*

FOUNDER TIP: Include at least one enquiry in the sample list with a visible blocker — *"Awaiting logo from client"*. Systems that only show happy paths feel theoretical. One visible edge case makes the whole thing feel battle-tested.

16.5 The hybrid honesty rule

This is a design requirement that runs through every journey.

> **Digital steps and human steps must be visually distinguishable.**

Step type	Visual treatment
System-handled	Solid fill, primary colour
Team-coordinated (human)	Dashed or outlined treatment

Include a small legend explaining the distinction, and place "Reviewed by your team" badges at the key transitions — particularly quotation and mock-up approval.

Why this is non-negotiable: the owner knows his business still involves phone calls. A prototype that implies full automation is either dishonest or naive, and he will identify it as one or the other within minutes. Showing the human steps deliberately is what makes the digital steps believable.

Additionally, produce a **Process Boundary Map** — a horizontal swimlane diagram showing where digital ends and human begins:

```
Enquiry        Quote          Sample        Order         Delivery
[DIGITAL]  →  [HYBRID]   →   [MANUAL]  →  [HYBRID]  →   [MANUAL]
```

This single diagram is one of the most valuable slides in the demo. It proves diagnosis before prescription.

16.6 Step-by-step: mapping a journey

1. Write the persona from what you actually know. Mark inferences as assumptions.
2. Write the trigger and intent before any steps.
3. Draft the steps as a linear happy path. Do not branch yet.
4. Identify every point where information is requested. Ask: is this needed *here*, or are we asking early out of convenience?
5. Identify human-in-the-loop points. Mark them.
6. Identify friction points and the mitigation for each.
7. Define the end state and what the user now expects to happen.
8. Write the "must be clickable" list — this becomes your acceptance criterion.
9. Review with the team. Log as a decision. Then design may begin.

16.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Branching logic everywhere	Minimise branching. One clear happy path per journey.
Asking for information too early	Every field must justify its position in the sequence
Hiding the human steps	Show them deliberately — see 16.5
One institutional scenario only	Three scenarios; the business serves varied buyers
Journey mapped after screens drawn	Journey first. No exceptions.

16.8 Definition of success

Every journey has a written specification with a "must be clickable" list, and the prototype satisfies that list with no dead ends.

16.9 Checklist

- ☐ All four journeys specified in the standard format
- ☐ Three institutional scenarios represented
- ☐ Human-in-the-loop points marked visually and in the legend
- ☐ Process Boundary Map produced
- ☐ WhatsApp primary, email optional, on all contact capture

- ☐ Camera option present on artwork upload
- ☐ At least one edge-case enquiry in the internal worklist
- ☐ Every journey ends in a defined end state; no dead ends

17. Screen Inventory Guide

17.1 Purpose

The screen inventory is the control document that makes scope creep visible. It is a spreadsheet, it is boring, and it is the reason unauthorised work cannot hide.

17.2 Why it matters

Figma files grow silently. A designer adds a frame at 11pm because a flow felt incomplete. Three weeks later that frame is in a review, the owner sees it, and it becomes an expectation. The inventory is what makes that frame visible on day one.

17.3 The inventory structure

One row per frame. Every frame in the Figma file must have a row; every row must have a frame or a documented reason it does not yet exist.

Column	Content
Screen ID	`[JOURNEY]-[NN][state]` e.g. `BULK-04b`
Screen name	Human-readable, e.g. “Bulk requirement capture — step 2”
Journey	P1 / P2 / P3 / Internal / Global
Platform	Mobile / Desktop / Both
State	Default / Empty / Error / Loading / Success / Modal-open
Fidelity	Must show / Can simulate (per Section 5.4)
Demonstrates	D1–D8
Flow position	Preceding screen → this screen → next screen
Clickable elements	Which elements must be wired
Content status	Not started / Draft / Final
Design status	Not started / Wireframe / Hi-fi / Accepted
QA status	Not tested / Failed / Passed
Owner	Name

Notes	Assumptions, dependencies, decisions affecting this screen

17.4 Naming convention

```
[JOURNEY]-[NUMBER][state letter]_[PLATFORM]

Examples:
  BULK-04_M          Bulk journey, screen 4, mobile, default state
  BULK-04b_M         Same screen, second state (e.g. validation error)
  TEAM-06_M          Custom teamwear, screen 6, mobile
  PDP-01c_D          Product display page, third state, desktop
  INT-02_D           Internal worklist detail, desktop
  GLB-NAV_M          Global navigation component, mobile
```

Rules: - Uppercase journey prefix, always - Two-digit screen number, always (`04`, not `4`) - Lowercase letter for states, sequential - Platform suffix `_M` or `_D` - No spaces. No dates in frame names — Figma version history handles that.

17.5 Estimated inventory size

This is a planning guide, not a target. A tighter inventory is better than a larger one.

Journey	Mobile screens	Desktop screens	Approximate total
Global (nav, footer, watermark, components)	4–6	2–4	6–10
P1 — Bulk	10–14	4–6	14–20
P2 — Custom teamwear	10–14	3–5	13–19
P3 — Retail	6–8	4–6	10–14
Internal (D8)	3–4	3–4	6–8
Demo framing (opening, boundary map, closing gate)	—	3–5	3–5
Total			**~52–76**

WARNING: If your inventory exceeds roughly eighty screens, you have a scope problem, not an ambition. Come to me before adding more.

17.6 Step-by-step: building and maintaining it

1. Build the inventory directly from the journey specifications (Section 16). Every “must be clickable” element implies screens.

2. Assign IDs following the naming convention. Do this once, properly; renaming later is painful.
3. Set fidelity per Section 5.4 for every row.
4. Assign owners.
5. **Reconcile daily** (Section 10.4).
6. Update design and QA status as work progresses — this is your live progress measure, more honest than any percentage.
7. At each sprint gate, produce a summary: rows accepted / in progress / not started, by journey.

17.7 The reconciliation rule

> **A frame that is not on the inventory does not exist. An inventory row with no frame is either blocked or abandoned — find out which.**

When you find an unauthorised frame:

1. Do not delete it silently. Screenshot it and note who created it.
2. Speak to the creator the same day. Ask what problem they were solving.
3. Decide (Tier 1): does it belong on the inventory, or in the Phase 2/3 backlog?
4. Log the decision. Move the frame to an "Explorations" page or the backlog.
5. If this happens twice with the same person, the scope boundary has not been communicated — fix that, not the frame.

17.8 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Building the inventory after design starts	Then it documents rather than controls
Vague screen names	"Screen 3" tells nobody anything
Not tracking states as separate rows	States are where the work actually is
Weekly reconciliation	Daily. Drift compounds.
Deleting unauthorised frames without conversation	You fix the symptom and keep the cause

17.9 Definition of success

At any moment, you can answer "how much is left?" with a number, not a feeling. And the Figma file and the inventory match exactly.

17.10 Checklist

- ☐ Inventory built from journey specs before design begins
- ☐ Naming convention applied consistently
- ☐ Every state is its own row
- ☐ Fidelity assigned per row
- ☐ Reconciled daily
- ☐ Sprint-gate summary produced
- ☐ Zero unreconciled frames at demo freeze

18. Content Planning

18.1 Purpose

Content is not decoration on top of design. In a premium prototype, content *is* the credibility. This section defines how every word in the prototype gets written, reviewed, and marked.

18.2 The absolute rule

> **No lorem ipsum. Anywhere. At any stage. Including wireframes.**

Lorem ipsum in a wireframe produces layouts sized for text that does not exist. It also trains the team to defer content decisions, and content decisions deferred are content decisions made badly at 2am the night before the demo.

18.3 The content map

Built in Sprint 1, alongside the screen inventory. One row per content block.

Column	Content
Screen ID	Matches inventory
Block	Hero headline / body / CTA label / field label / helper text / empty state / error / confirmation
Purpose	What this text must accomplish
Draft copy	The actual words
Marking required	Illustrative / Sample / Prototype Only / none
Status	Not started / Draft / Reviewed / Final
Owner	Name

18.4 Content types and their rules

Headlines

Two to eight words. State the benefit or the action, not the feature. Read aloud — if the reader hesitates, rewrite.

Body copy

Short. Indian business English, professional register, no marketing inflation. Avoid superlatives that cannot be substantiated (“India’s leading”, “world-class”) — these are fake claims under exclusion X12.

CTA labels

Verb-first, specific. “Request a Bulk Quote” beats “Submit”. “Upload Team Roster” beats “Continue”.

Field labels and helper text

Every field that could confuse gets one line of helper text. Institutional buyers abandon forms that make them guess.

Empty states

Three required: zero enquiries, zero quotes, zero mockups. Write them with warmth, not apology.

> *Example: “No enquiries yet. When a school or club sends you a requirement, it will land here.”*

Error and validation messages

Say what happened and what to do. Never blame the user.

> *Not: “Invalid input.” — Instead: “That doesn’t look like a 10-digit number. Please check and try again.”*

Loading states

Optional personality, used sparingly. Approve a maximum of three custom messages for the whole prototype. Restraint reads premium; whimsy everywhere reads amateur.

Confirmation and handoff copy

The most important copy in the prototype. After submitting a bulk enquiry, the user must know: what happens next, who does it, and roughly when.

> *Example: “Thanks — we’ve got your requirement. Someone from the VK7SPORTS team will review it and get back to you on WhatsApp, usually within [X] working hours.”* **FOUNDER TO CONFIRM:** actual response-time commitment. Do not invent it.

18.5 The marking rules — applied to content

Content	Marking

Any price, price band, or discount	**Illustrative**
Any institution name	**Sample**
Any person's name	**Sample**
Any quantity, date, or timestamp in sample data	**Sample**
Any metric ("4.2 hours saved")	**Illustrative**
Any functionality described but not built	**Prototype Only**
Trust bar showing client *categories*	Permitted, labelled illustrative — "Schools · Academies · Corporate Teams · Sports Clubs"
Trust bar showing named clients or logos	**FORBIDDEN** — exclusion X13, X14

Plus, on every screen: the persistent footer **"Prototype — Not Yet Live"** and a discreet PROTOTYPE watermark.

WARNING on the trust bar: showing believable client *categories* is honest and useful. Showing invented client *names or logos* is an integrity violation that would end this engagement. The line is absolute and there is no clever middle ground.

18.6 Step-by-step: the content process

1. Build the content map from the screen inventory in Sprint 1.
2. Draft every block before high-fidelity design begins. Designers work from real copy.
3. Apply the marking rules at draft stage, not as a pass at the end.
4. Review copy aloud — the read-aloud test in Section 40.
5. Check every claim: can VK7SPORTS substantiate this? If not, cut it or mark it.
6. Freeze content at the Sprint 3 Day 5 cutoff along with design.

18.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Lorem ipsum "for now"	Never. Write real copy or write a placeholder sentence that says something.
Writing copy after layout	Layout should be sized for real content

Marketing superlatives	Unsubstantiated claims are exclusion X12
Forgetting empty and error states	They are where the prototype feels real or fake
Marking data only in the deck	The label lives in the pixels

18.8 Definition of success

Every word in the prototype is deliberate, every unverified fact is marked, and there is no text on any screen that a VK7SPORTS employee would not be comfortable saying out loud to a customer.

18.9 Checklist

- ☐ Content map built in Sprint 1
- ☐ Zero lorem ipsum in any file at any time
- ☐ All copy drafted before high-fidelity design
- ☐ Marking rules applied at draft stage
- ☐ Empty, error, loading, and confirmation states written
- ☐ Every claim substantiable or marked
- ☐ No named clients, logos, or testimonials
- ☐ Footer disclaimer and watermark on every screen
- ☐ Read-aloud test passed on every headline

19. Prototype Governance

19.1 Purpose

Governance is what stops a prototype from silently becoming an assumed production commitment. It is the highest-consequence risk in a paid-discovery sales demo, and it is managed by mechanism, not by good intentions.

19.2 The governance principle

> **Every artefact must carry its own limitations. Verbal disclaimers do not travel; pixels do.**

The owner will screenshot the prototype. He will forward it to a partner, a family member, possibly a competitor's contact. That screenshot must be self-describing.

19.3 The five governance mechanisms

Mechanism 1 — Persistent watermark

A diagonal, low-opacity "PROTOTYPE" watermark on every screen. Discreet enough not to destroy the premium impression; visible enough to survive a screenshot.

Mechanism 2 — Persistent footer

A small, elegant line on every screen: **"Prototype — Not Yet Live"**.

Mechanism 3 — Inline data marking

Every data point labelled Illustrative / Sample / Prototype Only, per Sections 6.4 and 18.5. Data-heavy screens carry a footer line: *"Illustrative sample data for prototype demonstration."*

Mechanism 4 — The "Not Included Yet" screen

A dedicated screen inside the prototype listing what is out of scope, tagged "coming next" or similar. This pre-empts the "but you already showed it" objection by making exclusions part of the artefact rather than an external document.

Mechanism 5 — The Phase 2 Gate frame

The final frame in the prototype flow. It reads, in effect: *"Phase 1 ends here. Phase 2 — Discovery — begins on approval."* Include the owner's name and the proposed start date.

This frame does three things: it closes the narrative cleanly, it frames the prototype as milestone one rather than deliverable one, and it makes the next step feel like a scheduled event rather than a sales ask.

19.4 Figma annotations

Add five to ten contextual comments on key screens — particularly at real-world dependency points. Examples:

- *"Manual step today — your team would handle this"*
- *"Pricing shown is illustrative; real logic is a Discovery question"*
- *"Assumes roster arrives as a sheet — to be confirmed"*

Why: the owner will explore the prototype alone, after the demo, without you narrating. Annotations keep his expectations calibrated when you are not in the room.

19.5 Verbal boundary statements

Three verbal disclaimers, placed deliberately in the demo script (Section 37):

When	Statement
Opening, before first click	*"What you're about to see is a clickable concept, not a working system. Nothing behind it is built yet — that's deliberate, because we don't want to build the wrong thing."*
Mid-demo, at the quotation screen	*"These numbers are illustrative. Real pricing logic is one of the things Discovery would define, because it affects everything downstream."*
Closing, at the gate frame	*"Everything you've seen is design and flow. Nothing is engineered. Phase 2 is where we work out what it actually takes to build."*

WARNING: Do not cluster all three at the start. Spaced disclaimers are heard; front-loaded disclaimers are experienced as throat-clearing and forgotten.

19.6 The recorded walkthrough as reference point

After the demo, send a clean five-minute recorded walkthrough. This becomes the shared reference for all subsequent conversation — "as you saw at minute three" is a far stronger position than competing memories of a meeting.

19.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Consequence
Relying on verbal disclaimers only	Screenshots travel without you
Watermark so heavy it destroys the premium impression	Undermines D2; find the balance and get it reviewed

Exclusions communicated only in the deck	The prototype outlives the deck
No closing gate frame	The prototype feels like a product, not a milestone
Annotations that read as apologies	Frame them as clarity, not as excuses

19.8 Definition of success

Any single screenshot from the prototype, viewed by a stranger with no context, is unmistakably identifiable as a prototype with illustrative data.

19.9 Checklist

- ☐ Watermark on every screen, reviewed for balance
- ☐ Footer disclaimer on every screen
- ☐ All data marked inline
- ☐ “Not Included Yet” screen built
- ☐ Phase 2 Gate frame built with owner name and date
- ☐ 5–10 Figma annotations placed at dependency points
- ☐ Three verbal disclaimers written into the demo script and rehearsed
- ☐ Recorded walkthrough produced and sent post-demo

20. Assumption Register

20.1 Purpose

Pre-discovery work is, by definition, work done without complete information. The assumption register is how unknowns stay visible instead of becoming invisible risks embedded in design decisions.

20.2 The rule for what belongs here

> **If an unresolved item changes scope, fidelity, stakeholder expectation, or future cost — it is an assumption and it gets logged.**

Everything else is a detail, and details do not need a register.

20.3 Register format

```
ASM-###
Assumption:      [What we are assuming to be true]
Made on:         [DATE]
Owner:           [Who is responsible for resolving it]
Why we need it:  [What is blocked without it]
Impact if wrong: [Screens / journeys / cost affected]
Status:          Confirmed / Pending / Risky
Validation:      [How we will confirm — ask owner / test / defer to Discovery]
Blocks fidelity? Yes / No
Visible in UI?   [Screen IDs where an "Illustrative" label is required]
Resolved:        [DATE] → [outcome] → [DEC-### if it produced a decision]
```

20.4 The three-state model

Status	Meaning	Your action
Confirmed	Verified by founder or owner	Remove the illustrative marking if appropriate; close
Pending	Not yet asked or awaiting answer	On the Owner Question List; interim assumption communicated to team
Risky	Material impact if wrong, and unlikely to be resolved before demo	Escalate explicitly. Surface to the owner in the demo.

Risky assumptions must be named out loud during the walkthrough. Section 39 covers this. Owners respect a consultant who says “here is what we do not yet know” and distrust one who is discovered not to have known.

20.5 Likely assumptions for this project

Start your register with these. They are not exhaustive.

Likely assumption area	Why it matters
Bulk discount tiers and thresholds	Drives the quantity slider and pricing band UI
Standard vs. premium fabric tiering	Drives the two-tier quote comparison screen
Artwork turnaround time	Drives timeline copy and the status timeline
Roster data format currently received	Drives the roster upload design
Typical bulk order quantities per segment	Drives realistic sample data
Response-time commitment after enquiry	Drives confirmation copy
Who at VK7SPORTS handles enquiries	Drives the internal worklist design and sample staff names
Whether mock-ups are produced in-house	Drives the approval flow and Discovery scoping
Peak season timing	Drives sample data realism
Existing digital presence and assets	Drives the Dependency Register

20.6 Assumption cards in Figma

Place five to ten small annotation cards on the relevant prototype screens, each linking to its ASM-###. When the team reviews a screen, they see both the design and the assumption it rests on.

This is a small habit with a disproportionate effect: it prevents the team from treating a designed thing as a settled thing.

20.7 Step-by-step: the weekly assumption review

1. Read every Pending assumption. Has it been asked? If not, why not — add to the Owner Question List now.
2. Read every Risky assumption. Has anything changed? Does it need escalating to the founder this week?
3. Read every Confirmed assumption logged in the last week. Have the affected screens been updated? Have illustrative labels been removed where appropriate?

4. Check: is any Pending assumption now blocking work? If yes, issue an interim working assumption in writing so work continues.
5. Update the register. Note the review date.

20.8 The hypothesis-to-test discipline

Every assumption logged must also record *how it will be resolved*. “We’ll find out eventually” is not a validation method.

Validation method	Use when
Ask the owner (batched)	It is a business fact he holds
Ask the founder	It is a commercial or strategic matter
Test with an outsider	It is a comprehension or usability question
Defer to Discovery	It does not affect prototype fidelity and can wait

20.9 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Logging assumptions but never reviewing them	Weekly review, non-negotiable
Assumptions with no owner	Every assumption has a name against it
Not distinguishing Risky from Pending	Risky requires escalation, Pending requires asking
Building on an unlogged assumption	If it changes design, it gets logged
Never surfacing assumptions to the owner	Hidden assumptions become disputes

20.10 Definition of success

Zero design decisions rest on an unlogged assumption. Every Risky assumption is known to the founder and named in the demo.

20.11 Checklist

- ☐ Register created before Sprint 1 design work
- ☐ Every assumption has owner, impact, status, and validation method

- ☐ Reviewed every Thursday
- ☐ Assumption cards placed in Figma
- ☐ Risky assumptions escalated to founder
- ☐ “Things we’re still learning” slide prepared for the demo

21. Decision Register

21.1 Purpose

To prevent decisions from being re-litigated, and to preserve the *rationale* — which is the part that gets lost first and matters most.

21.2 Why it matters

Six weeks is long enough for a team to forget why it chose something, and short enough that re-deciding costs real time. More importantly: when the owner asks in the demo “why is it done this way?”, the difference between a confident one-sentence rationale and a hesitation is the difference between authority and improvisation.

21.3 What gets logged

Everything at Tier 1, 2, and 3 (Section 9). Also:

- Any decision made in a call or a synchronous conversation — record the outcome back into the register the same day
- Any decision that reverses a previous decision (mark the old one Superseded)
- Any decision to *not* do something

That last one is the most valuable and the most commonly skipped. “We decided not to build a quantity slider on desktop because it added no demonstrative value beyond the mobile version” is exactly the entry you will need in Week 5.

21.4 Register format

```
DEC-###  |  [DATE]
Decision:      [One sentence]
Tier:          1 / 2 / 3
Decided by:    [Name]
Rationale:     [Why — one or two sentences]
Alternatives:  [What was considered and rejected, and why]
Impacts:       [Screens / documents / people]
Related:       [ASM-### / RISK-### / DEP-###]
Status:        Active / Superseded by DEC-###
```

21.5 Worked example

```
DEC-014  |  [DATE]
Decision:      Custom teamwear will use a static mock-up preview with
               a 2D artwork upload, not an interactive configurator.
Tier:          3 (founder-locked exclusion X10)
Decided by:    Founder
Rationale:     A 3D configurator is a significant engineering commitment,
               over-promises technical capability, and adds no evidence
               for D5 beyond what a well-rendered static mock-up provides.
Alternatives:  (a) Interactive 2D colour-change — rejected: still implies
               live rendering capability we have not scoped.
               (b) No mock-up at all — rejected: approval workflow (D7)
```

```
              requires something to approve.
Impacts:      TEAM-05, TEAM-06, TEAM-07; demo script section 4;
              Phase 2/3 backlog item B-009
Related:      ASM-008 (mock-ups produced in-house?)
Status:       Active
```

21.6 The synchronous-decision rule

> **Any decision made in a meeting or call must be written into the register within the same working day.**

Decisions made verbally and never recorded are the single largest source of "we agreed on this but I thought it meant…" disputes. Two minutes of typing prevents an hour of argument.

21.7 The weekly decision highlight

Each Friday update includes a "Decisions this week" section listing one or two significant entries with their rationale. This keeps stakeholders aligned without requiring them to read the full register, and it builds trust through visible transparency.

21.8 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Logging the decision but not the rationale	Rationale is the field that has future value
Not logging "we decided not to"	Negative decisions are the ones that get re-raised
Verbal decisions never recorded	Same-day rule
Editing an old entry instead of superseding it	Never rewrite history; supersede and cross-reference
A register only Pradnya reads	Highlight two decisions weekly in the update

21.9 Definition of success

Nobody in this project asks "why did we do it this way?" and gets an uncertain answer.

21.10 Checklist

- ☐ Register created before Sprint 1
- ☐ Every Tier 1/2/3 decision logged with rationale
- ☐ Negative decisions logged
- ☐ Synchronous decisions recorded same day
- ☐ Superseding used instead of editing

- ☐ Two decisions highlighted in every Friday update

22. Risk Register

22.1 Purpose

To surface what could go wrong early enough to do something about it — and to be seen doing so.

22.2 Why it matters operationally

Surfacing risk before it is asked about is one of the clearest leadership signals available to you. Founders and owners do not expect zero risk; they expect risk to be known, owned, and mitigated. Discovering an unmentioned risk after it has materialised is what damages trust.

22.3 Register format

```
RISK-###
Risk:         [What could go wrong — a statement, not a topic]
Category:     Scope / Content / Schedule / Stakeholder / Integrity / Team
Likelihood:   High / Medium / Low
Impact:       High / Medium / Low
Trigger:      [The observable event that means this is now happening]
Mitigation:   [What we are doing to reduce likelihood]
Contingency:  [What we do if it happens anyway]
Owner:        [Name]
Status:       Open / Mitigated / Materialised / Closed
Review date:  [DATE]
```

The Trigger field is what makes a register useful rather than decorative. A risk without a defined trigger is never noticed until it is a problem.

22.4 The known risk set for this project

Start your register with these. They are drawn from the specific structure of this engagement.

ID	Risk	L	I	Trigger	Mitigation
R-01	Missing high-resolution product photography forces stock imagery, undermining premium perception	H	H	Sprint 1 ends without confirmed image assets	Log as dependency Day 1; source licensed alternatives in parallel; agree fallback with founder
R-02	Team designs an excluded feature (dealer portal, admin, 3D)	M	H	An unauthorised frame appears in reconciliation	Read exclusions at kickoff; daily reconciliation; address cause not frame
R-03	Owner asks for a feature during the walkthrough and	M	H	Any “yes, we can” said aloud in the	Rehearse the deflection script; founder present or

	it is agreed in the room			demo	briefed; no Tier 3 authority delegated
R-04	Quotation logic is misunderstood, making the bulk flow feel wrong to the owner	M	H	Owner corrects the quotation screen substantially	Batch owner questions early; mark all pricing Illustrative; treat corrections as success signal
R-05	The Polish Trap — homepage over-worked, bulk quotation under-worked	M	H	Time-per-journey skews toward P3/homepage	Track effort per journey; correct visibly at sprint review
R-06	Sprint 3 design overrun eliminates testing and rehearsal time	M	H	Design work continues past Sprint 3 Day 5	Hard cutoff; descope P3 fidelity first
R-07	Prototype is misread as a working product	M	H	Owner refers to it as “the website” or asks when it goes live	Five governance mechanisms (Section 19); spaced verbal disclaimers
R-08	Sample data reads as fake, undermining credibility	M	M	Outsider test flags data as unrealistic	Apply Section 43 rules; test with outsiders
R-09	Key team member unavailable at a critical point (exams, illness)	M	M	Any absence over two days	Handoff notes (Section 48); no single point of knowledge
R-10	Founder unavailable for a Tier 2/3 decision, blocking work	M	M	Decision Brief unanswered for 48h	Batch decisions; always propose an interim working assumption
R-11	Owner unavailable to answer blocking questions before demo	M	M	Owner Question List unanswered 5 days before demo	Escalate to founder; convert questions to Risky assumptions and name them in the demo
R-12	Figma file damaged or edited during the demo	L	H	Any edit after freeze	Lock all final screens; present from a locked, versioned copy

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: availability windows for founder and owner across the sprint calendar, so R-10 and R-11 can be planned around rather than reacted to.

22.5 Step-by-step: weekly risk review

1. Read every Open risk. Has its trigger fired?
2. Re-score likelihood and impact. Scores move; a register with static scores is not being used.
3. For any risk now High/High, escalate to founder the same day.
4. Add any new risks identified during the week.
5. Close risks that no longer apply — and record why.
6. Select the top three for the Friday update.

22.6 The top-three rule

Every weekly update names the top three risks and what is being done about each. Not the full register — three. A full register in an update is noise; three named risks with mitigations is management.

22.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Register written once and never revisited	Weekly review, scores updated
Risks with no trigger	You will not notice them arriving
Risks with no owner	Nothing happens
Hiding risk from the founder to appear in control	The opposite is true; surfaced risk reads as control
Alarmism	State risk with a mitigation. Never raise a risk without a proposed response.

22.8 Definition of success

No risk materialises in this project that was not already logged, owned, and mitigated in advance.

22.9 Checklist

- ☐ Register seeded with R-01 to R-12 in Week 1
- ☐ Every risk has trigger, mitigation, contingency, owner
- ☐ Reviewed and re-scored weekly

- ☐ High/High risks escalated same day
- ☐ Top three named in every Friday update
- ☐ Every risk raised comes with a proposed response

23. Dependency Register

23.1 Purpose

Dependencies are the things you need from other people. They are the most common cause of a schedule slipping and the easiest to manage — provided they are tracked from Day 1 rather than discovered in Week 4.

23.2 Why it matters

A premium prototype fails on assets before it fails on design. Missing photography, an unavailable logo file, an unanswered question about roster format — each of these can stall a screen indefinitely while everyone assumes someone else is handling it.

23.3 Register format

```
DEP-###
Dependency:   [What we need]
Needed for:   [Screens / journeys / documents]
Provider:     [Who must supply it]
Requested:    [DATE]
Due:          [DATE]
Fallback:     [What we do if it does not arrive]
Status:       Requested / Chased / Received / Fallback in use / Blocked
Risk if late: High / Medium / Low
Age:          [days since requested]
```

The Fallback field is mandatory. A dependency without a fallback is a single point of failure, and in a six-week project you cannot afford one.

23.4 The dependency set for this project

ID	Dependency	Provider	Needed for	Fallback
D-01	High-resolution product photography	VK7SPORTS / founder	Homepage, PDP, category, mock-ups	Licensed royalty-free sportswear imagery, consistent treatment
D-02	VK7SPORTS brand assets — logo, colours, fonts	VK7SPORTS / founder	Entire visual system	Design a restrained interim system; flag as illustrative; **FOUNDER TO CONFIRM**
D-03	Product and category list	VK7SPORTS / founder	IA, category page, PDP	Sample product set marked Sample
D-	Customisation	VK7SPORTS /	P2 brief capture	Logged assumption +

04	options actually offered	founder		illustrative option set
D-05	Size charts	VK7SPORTS / founder	PDP, roster capture	Standard Indian sizing marked Illustrative
D-06	Roster data format currently received	VK7SPORTS / founder	TEAM-04 roster upload	Assume photo/sheet; log ASM; design for both
D-07	Artwork file formats received from clients	VK7SPORTS / founder	TEAM-05 artwork upload	Assume image + PDF; log ASM
D-08	Turnaround time commitments	VK7SPORTS / founder	Timeline copy, confirmation copy	Marked Illustrative; **FOUNDER TO CONFIRM**
D-09	Sample pricing language and tier names	Founder	Quotation screens	Generic “Standard / Premium” marked Illustrative
D-10	Names of 2–3 VK7SPORTS team members	Owner via founder	Internal worklist realism	Generic Sample staff names
D-11	Owner’s own words about his pain	Pradnya, from discovery conversation	Demo opening (Section 37)	Founder-supplied paraphrase, clearly attributed
D-12	Discovery Phase scope, dates, investment figure	Founder	Exclusions doc, Phase 2 card, proposal	**BLOCKING — no fallback.** Cannot present without it.
D-13	Terminology decisions (what the business calls things)	Owner via founder	All copy, IA labels	Industry-standard terms; flag for owner confirmation in demo

WARNING on D-12: this is the only dependency in the list with no fallback. You cannot run the closing section of the demo without it. Request it in Week 1, chase it in Week 3, and escalate hard if it is not resolved by the start of Sprint 3.

23.5 Step-by-step: dependency management

1. **Day 1:** create the register with every dependency you can foresee, including the ones above. Send all requests the same day.

2. Assign a due date to each — a real date, not “ASAP”.
3. Define the fallback immediately, at the point of logging. Do not wait until the dependency is late.
4. **Every Wednesday:** age every dependency. Anything over five days without response gets chased in writing.
5. Anything over ten days, or any blocking dependency at any age, gets escalated to the founder.
6. When a fallback is invoked, log it as a decision (DEC-###) and mark the affected screens Illustrative.

23.6 How to chase well

Do	Do not
Chase in writing, with the original request quoted	Chase verbally only
State exactly what is blocked and by when you need it	Say “just following up”
Offer the fallback: *“If it’s easier, we’ll proceed with X and mark it illustrative — let me know by Friday”*	Wait passively
Escalate after two chases	Escalate after one, or after ten

FOUNDER TIP: Offering the fallback in the chase message is the single most effective technique here. It converts an open-ended request into a simple decision, and it removes the guilt that makes people avoid replying.

23.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Logging dependencies without fallbacks	Fallback at point of logging, always
“ASAP” instead of a date	Dates create action; ASAP creates nothing
Chasing verbally	No record, no urgency
Discovering dependencies in Sprint 2	Foresee them in Week 1
Letting a blocking dependency sit	D-12 in particular — escalate hard

23.8 Definition of success

No screen is delayed by a dependency that was not identified, chased, and fallback-planned in advance.

23.9 Checklist

- ☐ Register created Day 1 with D-01 to D-13
- ☐ Every dependency requested in writing on Day 1
- ☐ Every dependency has a real due date and a fallback
- ☐ Aged every Wednesday
- ☐ Chased in writing after five days
- ☐ Escalated after two chases
- ☐ D-12 resolved before Sprint 3 begins

24. Definition of Ready

24.1 Purpose

To prevent work from starting before it can be done well. Almost all rework in a project like this traces back to work that started before it was ready.

24.2 The principle

> **Nothing enters design until the design question is fully specified. If a designer has to guess, we have failed upstream.**

24.3 Definition of Ready — for a screen entering design

A screen may enter design when **all** of the following are true:

- ☐ It appears on the Screen Inventory with an assigned ID
- ☐ Its journey is mapped and documented (Section 16)
- ☐ Its position in the flow is defined: what precedes it, what follows it
- ☐ Its fidelity level is assigned (Must show / Can simulate)
- ☐ Its purpose is stated: which of D1–D8 it demonstrates
- ☐ Real copy exists in the content map — not lorem ipsum, not “TBD”
- ☐ All required assets are available, or a fallback is agreed and logged
- ☐ Any underlying assumption is logged with an ID
- ☐ Acceptance criteria are written (Section 26)
- ☐ Platform is specified (mobile / desktop / both)
- ☐ An owner is assigned

If any box is unticked, the screen is not ready. Do not start it.

24.4 Definition of Ready — for a sprint

A sprint may begin when:

- ☐ The previous sprint’s gate has been formally assessed and recorded
- ☐ The sprint’s objective is stated in one sentence
- ☐ Every planned item meets the screen-level DoR above, or is explicitly a definition task
- ☐ Capacity is known — actual available hours per person, not optimistic hours
- ☐ All blocking dependencies are either resolved or have agreed fallbacks
- ☐ The exit gate criteria are written down before the sprint starts

24.5 Definition of Ready — for a review

A review may be held when:

- ☐ The review objective is stated in advance
- ☐ The maturity level of the work is stated ("this is wireframe stage — do not comment on visual polish")
- ☐ The specific questions requiring answers are listed
- ☐ Participants have had access to the work beforehand
- ☐ The top three issues have been pre-identified

24.6 Definition of Ready — for owner contact

Contact with the owner is ready when:

- ☐ Questions are batched (5–7, priority ordered)
- ☐ Each question states what it unblocks
- ☐ The founder has seen the batch
- ☐ Nothing in the batch could have been answered internally

24.7 Step-by-step: enforcing DoR

1. Publish the DoR checklists in the source-of-truth document in Week 1.
2. Before assigning any screen, walk the checklist yourself. Takes ninety seconds.
3. If an item fails, the screen goes back to the backlog with a named blocker — not to the designer with a caveat.
4. If a designer starts something not ready, stop it the same day. Explain why. This is not pedantry; it is the difference between one hour of specification and eight hours of rework.
5. Review DoR compliance at each sprint gate — how many items entered design not ready?

WARNING: The pressure to skip DoR is highest in Sprint 3, exactly when rework is most expensive. Hold the line hardest at the end.

24.8 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Starting design "to save time"	It costs time. Every instance.
DoR as a suggestion	It is a gate. Binary.
Marking an item ready with copy "to be written"	Copy is a DoR item, not a follow-up

Skipping DoR under deadline pressure	Rework under deadline pressure is worse

24.9 Definition of success

Zero screens enter design without meeting DoR. Rework attributable to unclear briefs approaches zero.

25. Definition of Done

25.1 Purpose

Production Definition of Done is the wrong standard for this phase. Applying it wastes time; applying nothing produces a demo that falls apart under clicking. This section defines the correct standard.

25.2 The principle

> **Done means: it proves the concept, it survives being clicked, and it supports the approval decision. It does not mean production-ready.**

25.3 Definition of Done — for a screen

A screen is done when:

- ☐ All acceptance criteria for that screen are met (Section 26)
- ☐ Designed mobile-first; desktop present if the inventory requires it
- ☐ Real copy in place; zero lorem ipsum
- ☐ All illustrative or sample data marked correctly
- ☐ Watermark and footer disclaimer present
- ☐ Type scale respected — maximum 2–3 sizes per screen (Section 41)
- ☐ Icon set restricted to the approved set
- ☐ Tap targets minimum 44×44px equivalent
- ☐ Single-column forms on mobile
- ☐ Reviewed in Figma mobile view on a physical device
- ☐ Human-in-the-loop steps visually distinguished where applicable
- ☐ Named in the Screen Inventory with status updated
- ☐ Reviewed by someone other than the person who designed it

25.4 Definition of Done — for a journey

A journey is done when:

- ☐ Every screen in the journey is done per 25.3
- ☐ The full happy path is clickable end to end
- ☐ There are no dead ends — every screen offers a route onward or back
- ☐ Return to homepage is possible from every screen

- ☐ The “must be clickable” list from the journey spec is fully satisfied
- ☐ The journey has been walked by someone who did not design it
- ☐ The journey appears as a separate Figma Flow

25.5 Definition of Done — for the prototype

The prototype is done when:

- ☐ All three journeys plus the internal view are done per 25.4
- ☐ Figma Flows separate B2B, B2C, custom, and internal so they can be presented sequentially
- ☐ Mobile-first review passed on a physical phone, end to end
- ☐ Business narrative aligned — the demo script maps cleanly onto the screens
- ☐ Every assumption tagged and visible
- ☐ Demo script written and rehearsed
- ☐ Exclusions one-pager produced
- ☐ “Not Included Yet” screen and Phase 2 Gate frame built
- ☐ Approval record prepared for capture
- ☐ All final screens locked against editing
- ☐ Outsider comprehension test passed (Section 40.6)
- ☐ Recorded walkthrough produced

25.6 What “done” explicitly does not require

Saying this plainly saves your team from gold-plating:

Not required	Why
Every state of every component	Fidelity ladder governs; two good states beat six half-built
Pixel-perfect consistency across every screen	Improvement over perfection (Section 27.5)
Full responsive behaviour at every breakpoint	Mobile and, where specified, desktop. Nothing else.
Complete design system documentation	That is a Discovery / production artefact
Accessibility audit to WCAG AA	Good practice is expected; formal audit is not this

	phase
Real data, real logic, real anything	Explicitly excluded

25.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Applying production DoD	Wrong standard, wastes the schedule
Applying no DoD	Demo falls apart under clicking
Designer signs off own work	Separate maker from approver
“Done” declared without walking the journey	Walk it. Every time.

25.8 Definition of success

The owner clicks anywhere in the prototype during the walkthrough and nothing breaks, dead-ends, or reveals placeholder content.

26. Acceptance Criteria

26.1 Purpose

Acceptance criteria are what make “done” objective. They are written before work starts and are the basis of every acceptance judgement.

26.2 The rules for writing them

Rule	Bad	Good
Objectively verifiable	“Looks premium”	“Maximum 3 type sizes; minimum 24px vertical padding between sections; maximum 3 elements in hero”
Written before work begins	Written at review time	Written at DoR time
One criterion, one check	“Form works and looks good”	Two separate criteria
Stated in observable terms	“Feels frictionless”	“Bulk enquiry completable in 4 taps or fewer from homepage on mobile”

26.3 Prototype-wide acceptance criteria

These apply to the whole deliverable. They are the criteria I will judge against.

#	Criterion
AC-01	All primary CTAs in the defined happy paths are clickable
AC-02	The prototype has no dead ends; every screen offers a route onward or back
AC-03	Return to homepage is possible from every screen
AC-04	The visual hierarchy clearly separates B2C “Add to Cart” from B2B “Request Quote” on the PDP
AC-	Bulk enquiry entry point is visible above the fold on mobile from the homepage

05	
AC-06	Zero lorem ipsum on any screen
AC-07	Every illustrative or sample data point is labelled
AC-08	Watermark and footer disclaimer present on every screen
AC-09	Zero excluded features present (Section 6 list)
AC-10	Zero fake logos, testimonials, or client names
AC-11	Human-in-the-loop steps visually distinguished, with a legend
AC-12	All contact capture uses WhatsApp as primary field, email optional
AC-13	All tap targets minimum 44×44px equivalent
AC-14	All mobile forms single-column
AC-15	Maximum 2–3 type sizes per screen
AC-16	Icon usage restricted to the approved set (10–15 icons total)
AC-17	Indian currency formatting used throughout (₹1,24,500)
AC-18	All timestamps in IST with realistic business-hour gaps
AC-19	Three institutional scenarios represented in sample data
AC-	At least one edge-case enquiry visible in the internal worklist

20	
AC-21	“Not Included Yet” screen present
AC-22	Phase 2 Gate frame present with owner name and proposed date
AC-23	Figma Flows separated by journey
AC-24	All final screens locked
AC-25	Every screen on the inventory; no frame off the inventory

26.4 Screen-level acceptance criteria — template

```
SCREEN [ID] — ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA


Functional
  · [Element] is clickable and routes to [screen ID]
  · [Form] accepts input and advances to [screen ID]
  · Back / home route available


Content
  · All copy final, no placeholders
  · [Specific data points] labelled Illustrative / Sample
  · Helper text present on [fields]


Visual
  · Maximum [N] type sizes
  · Conforms to approved spacing scale
  · Icons from approved set only
  · Watermark and footer present


Mobile
  · Single-column layout
  · All tap targets ≥44px
  · All primary actions reachable with one thumb
  · Reviewed on physical device


Governance
  · Assumption cards placed for [ASM-###]
  · Human-in-the-loop badge present where applicable
```

26.5 Worked example

```
SCREEN BULK-04_M — Bulk requirement capture, step 2 (quantity & timeline)


Functional
  · Quantity input accepts a value and updates the indicative price band
  · "Continue" routes to BULK-05_M
```

```
  · "Back" routes to BULK-03_M
  · Home accessible from header

Content
  · Price bands labelled "Illustrative — indicative only"
  · Helper text under quantity: "Rough numbers are fine — we'll confirm on the call"
  · Timeline field offers relative options, not a date picker

Visual
  · 3 type sizes maximum
  · Price band block uses the single approved accent colour
  · Watermark and footer present

Mobile
  · Single column
  · Quantity stepper controls ≥44px
  · Continue button within thumb reach at bottom of viewport
  · Reviewed on physical device by [name]

Governance
  · Assumption card linked to ASM-003 (bulk discount tiers)
  · No human-in-the-loop badge required at this step
```

26.6 The three layers of acceptance

Do not confuse these. Each is separate and each has a different approver.

Layer	Question	Approver
Internal design acceptance	Does this meet its screen-level criteria?	Pradnya (never the designer of that screen)
Strategic acceptance	Does this serve the demonstration requirements and the vision?	Pradnya, with founder consultation
Demo readiness	Is this safe to present for commercial approval?	Founder, at the readiness gate (Section 44)

WARNING: “Looks strong enough for critique” is not “safe to present for commercial approval”. Teams conflate these constantly and present work that has passed layer one as though it has passed layer three.

26.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Subjective criteria	Every criterion observable and checkable
Written at review time	Written at DoR time
One combined “looks good” criterion	Split into separate, checkable items

Skipping the three-layer distinction	Each layer has its own approver and question

26.8 Definition of success

Every acceptance judgement in this project can be defended by pointing at a written criterion, not by expressing an opinion.

26.9 Checklist

- ☐ AC-01 to AC-25 published and understood by the team in Week 1
- ☐ Screen-level criteria written at DoR time for every screen
- ☐ Criteria objectively verifiable
- ☐ Three acceptance layers respected and separately recorded
- ☐ No screen accepted by its own designer

27. Design Review Process

27.1 Purpose

To make design feedback structured, business-anchored, and closed — rather than a stream of opinion that never resolves.

27.2 The governing shift

> **Structure critiques around business goals, not aesthetics.**

The question is never *"does this look good?"* It is *"does this layout make it simpler for a gym owner to get a quotation?"* Everyone has an opinion on the first question. Only useful people have an opinion on the second.

27.3 The Three Hats method

Every participant wears exactly one hat and speaks only from that perspective. This eliminates the generic "looks nice" response and produces feedback that can be acted on.

Hat	Asks
Brand	Does this communicate premium? Is it restrained? Does it look like a business that charges more than the import alternative?
User	Can the intended person complete their task? Where do they hesitate? What do they have to guess?
Business	Does this help VK7SPORTS make money or save time? Does it match how the business actually works?

Rotate hats between sessions so nobody becomes typecast.

27.4 Session structure — 45 minutes

Minutes	Activity
0–3	State the objective, the maturity level, and the exact questions needing answers
3–5	Pre-mortem: *"What is the most likely owner question about this screen?"*
5–30	Walk the work. Each participant speaks from their assigned hat. Comments pinned directly in Figma.
30–40	Identify the top three issues. Only three.

40–45	Confirm owners and deadlines for the three. Everything else parked.

27.5 The improvement standard

> **Approve when the work clearly improves demo clarity and decision confidence — not when it is perfect.**

This is deliberately borrowed from mature engineering review culture, and it applies precisely here. A pre-discovery prototype that becomes pseudo-production has failed at its actual job. If a screen is better than what preceded it and meets its acceptance criteria, approve it and move on.

27.6 The one-issue-at-a-time rule

Each critique addresses only the top three issues. Everything else is parked, in writing, visibly.

Why: trying to fix everything at once produces mediocre compromises and exhausts a small team. Three well-fixed issues per cycle compounds faster than fifteen half-fixed ones.

27.7 The Accept / Reject / Defer triage

Every critique note is triaged within 24 hours. No note is left floating.

Label	Meaning	Action
Accept	Will be fixed this sprint	Assign owner and date
Reject	Will not be done — with a reason	Reply in Figma with the reason. Never silently ignore.
Defer	Good, but not this phase	Move to Phase 2/3 backlog with a one-line rationale

WARNING: Rejecting without a stated reason is how you lose a team's engagement. People stop giving feedback when feedback disappears. Two sentences of reasoning preserves the contribution even when the answer is no.

27.8 Feedback separation by purpose

Do not let business feedback, UX feedback, content feedback, and operational feedback collapse into one stream. Use either separate review rounds or a labelling convention in Figma comments:

```
[BRAND] [UX] [CONTENT] [OPS] [SCOPE]
```

`[SCOPE]` is the most important label — it flags a comment that, if accepted, would expand the project. Those go straight to you, not to the designer.

27.9 The outsider critique

Once per sprint, bring in someone unfamiliar with the project for fifteen minutes. Ask them to review screens and note confusion. Internal teams normalise their own decisions within days; outsiders see what you have stopped seeing.

27.10 The pre-mortem question

Open every critique with: *"What is the most likely owner question about this screen?"*

This forces the team into the stakeholder's perspective before the feedback starts, and it consistently surfaces the real weaknesses faster than a general review.

27.11 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Unstructured critique	Three Hats; stated objective; specific questions
Discussing aesthetics without business anchoring	Reframe every comment as a business question
Trying to fix everything	Top three only
Notes left untriaged	24-hour triage rule
Silent rejection	Always give a reason
Reviewing without stating maturity	"This is wireframe stage" prevents useless polish feedback

27.12 Definition of success

Every critique produces exactly three actioned issues and zero untriaged notes, and no participant leaves unclear about what happens to their feedback.

27.13 Checklist

- ☐ Objective, maturity, and questions stated at the start
- ☐ Pre-mortem question asked
- ☐ Hats assigned and rotated

- ☐ Comments pinned in Figma with purpose labels
- ☐ Top three issues identified with owners and dates
- ☐ All notes triaged within 24 hours
- ☐ Rejections given reasons
- ☐ Outsider critique held once per sprint

28. Figma Review Workflow

28.1 Purpose

To make the Figma file a controlled artefact rather than a shared canvas where anything can happen.

28.2 File structure

One file. Pages as follows:

Page	Contents	Access
`00 — Cover`	Project name, version, owner, last updated, link to source-of-truth doc	Everyone
`01 — Foundations`	Type scale, colour, spacing, icon set, components	Everyone
`02 — Wireframes`	All wireframes, archived after Sprint 1	Everyone
`03 — Mobile`	All mobile screens per inventory	Everyone
`04 — Desktop`	All desktop screens per inventory	Everyone
`05 — Demo Frames`	Opening frame, boundary map, T-chart, Phase 2 gate	Everyone
`06 — Explorations`	Anything not on the inventory. Quarantine page.	Everyone
`07 — Archive`	Superseded versions, screenshot history	Everyone
`08 — PRESENT`	Locked, frozen copy used for the demo	Locked

The Explorations page is important. It gives designers somewhere legitimate to put an idea without it entering the prototype. Ideas are not the enemy; unauthorised ideas inside the deliverable are.

28.3 Figma Flows

Create separate Figma Flows for each journey so they can be presented sequentially without confusion:

Flow name	Starting frame
`FLOW — 01 Bulk Institutional`	Homepage (mobile)
`FLOW — 02 Custom Teamwear`	Homepage (mobile)

`FLOW — 03 Retail`	Homepage (mobile)
`FLOW — 04 Internal Handling`	Internal entry frame
`FLOW — 05 Demo Sequence`	Opening frame

Why it matters for the demo: you can move between journeys deliberately rather than hunting for a frame in front of the owner. Fumbling in a demo undermines everything else you have built.

28.4 Commenting conventions

Convention	Rule
Purpose label	Every comment starts with `[BRAND]` / `[UX]` / `[CONTENT]` / `[OPS]` / `[SCOPE]`
Anchored	Comments pinned to the specific element, not floating on the canvas
Actionable	State what should change, not only what is wrong
Resolved deliberately	Only the note's triager resolves it, after triage — not the designer, unilaterally

28.5 Locking and freezing

At demo freeze (Sprint 3, Day 10):

1. Duplicate the file. Name it `VK7_Prototype_v1.0_PRESENT_[DATE]`.
2. On the PRESENT copy, lock every final screen.
3. Verify all Flows still function from the locked copy.
4. Present only from the locked copy. Never from the working file.
5. Any change after freeze requires a new version number and a fresh QA pass. There is no such thing as a small change on demo day.

WARNING (R-12): presenting from a live working file is how a demo gets destroyed by an accidental drag. The locked copy is not bureaucracy; it is insurance.

28.6 Screenshot history

Archive a dated screenshot of every key screen at the end of each sprint on the Archive page. This gives you a visual record, catches regressions, and lets you show progress credibly.

28.7 Sharing and access

Audience	Access

Team	Edit on working file
Founder	View + comment
Owner (post-demo)	View only, on the locked PRESENT copy, via a single clean link
Anyone else	No access without founder approval

Send the owner one clean link with a short note. No clutter, no multiple links, no “here are five files”.

28.8 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Working directly in the presentation file	Duplicate and lock
No Explorations page	Ideas end up in the prototype
Unlabelled comments	Feedback streams collapse into noise
Designers resolving their own critique notes	Triager resolves, after triage
Sending the owner a raw working link	One clean link, locked copy, short note

28.9 Definition of success

The demo runs from a locked file, every journey plays as a separate Flow, and nothing in the file is unaccounted for.

28.10 Checklist

- ☐ File structured into the nine pages above
- ☐ Five Flows created and tested
- ☐ Comment labelling convention in use
- ☐ Explorations page in use
- ☐ Screenshot history archived per sprint
- ☐ PRESENT copy created and locked at freeze
- ☐ Access permissions set correctly
- ☐ Demo rehearsed from the locked copy

29. Version Control

29.1 Purpose

To make it unambiguous, at any moment, which version of anything is current, what changed, and what was approved.

29.2 Why it matters

Approval must map to a specific version. “The owner approved the prototype” is a weak position. “The owner approved v1.0 on [date], covering journeys P1, P2, P3 and internal handling, with the exclusions listed in the v1.0 exclusions one-pager” is a defensible one.

29.3 Versioning scheme

```
v[MAJOR].[MINOR]

MINOR (v0.1 → v0.2)  Incremental progress within a sprint
MAJOR (v0.9 → v1.0)  Sprint completion, or a version presented externally
```

Version	Milestone
v0.1	Wireframes complete
v0.2	PRD approved, IA frozen
v0.3	Visual system locked
v0.4	P1 high-fidelity complete
v0.5	P2 high-fidelity complete
v0.6	P3 complete; all sample content in
v0.7	Fully wired prototype
v0.8	QA passed
v0.9	Outsider tested; deck and script complete
v1.0	**Demo version — frozen, locked, presented**

29.4 The versioned handoff package

Figma links alone create confusion about what changed and what was approved. Every prototype drop is accompanied by a short package — not a bare link.

Template — Prototype Drop Note

```
VK7SPORTS PROTOTYPE — DROP v0.[X]
[DATE] · Pradnya Gaikwad

PURPOSE OF THIS DROP
[One sentence — what this version is for]

WHAT CHANGED SINCE v0.[X-1]
· [Screen ID] — [change]
· [Screen ID] — [change]

REVIEW FOCUS — what I need feedback on
· [Specific question]
· [Specific question]

WHAT I DO NOT NEED FEEDBACK ON YET
· [e.g. retail journey visual polish — still wireframe stage]

KNOWN GAPS
· [What is deliberately incomplete and when it will be done]

DEPENDENCIES OUTSTANDING
· DEP-### [what] — [status]

ACCEPTANCE STATUS
· Screens accepted: [N of M]
· Ready for stakeholder view: YES / NO

LINK: [single clean Figma link]
```

FOUNDER TIP: The “what I do not need feedback on yet” section is the most useful part of this template. It saves reviewers from wasting their attention and saves you from receiving feedback you cannot act on.

29.5 Document versioning

Applies to the PRD, exclusions doc, deck, and all registers.

```
VK7_[Artefact]_v[X.Y]_[YYYY-MM-DD]

VK7_DemoPRD_v1.2_2026-08-14
VK7_Exclusions_v1.0_2026-09-02
VK7_OwnerDeck_v0.3_2026-08-28
```

Rules: - Version number in the filename, always - ISO date format, always (`2026-08-14`, never `14-08-26`) - Never “final”, “final2”, “final_FINAL”. Version numbers exist for exactly this reason. - A change log at the bottom of every document

29.6 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction

Sending a bare Figma link	Always accompany with a drop note
“final_v2_updated.pdf”	Use version numbers
Approval not tied to a version	Approval records name the exact version
No change log	Reviewers cannot see what to look at
Inconsistent date formats	ISO only

29.7 Definition of success

For any artefact, at any point, you can state the current version, what changed in it, and which version was last approved by whom.

29.8 Checklist

- ☐ Versioning scheme published Week 1
- ☐ Every drop accompanied by a drop note
- ☐ All documents follow the naming convention
- ☐ Change logs maintained
- ☐ Approval captured against a named version

30. Documentation Standards

30.1 Purpose

To ensure the written record of this project is usable by someone other than you.

30.2 The test

> **Could a competent person, given only your documents, continue this project without speaking to you?**

If not, the documentation is incomplete. This is not a hypothetical standard — team availability in a student-led project is genuinely unpredictable, and Section 48 depends on it.

30.3 The single source of truth

One document. Everyone reads it. It contains, or links to, everything.

Structure:

```
VK7SPORTS PROTOTYPE — SOURCE OF TRUTH
Last updated: [DATE] by [NAME]


1. THIS WEEK'S FOCUS
   [Three to five items. Updated Monday.]


2. PROJECT VISION
   [The statement from Section 2. Never changes.]


3. LOCKED DECISIONS
   Journey priority: P1 bulk > P2 custom > P3 retail
   Exclusion list: [link]
   Fidelity ladder: [link]


4. CURRENT STATUS
   Sprint [N] · Prototype v0.[X] · [X]% of inventory accepted
   Progress: [simple visual bar]


5. OPEN QUESTIONS
   [Batched, prioritised, with what each blocks]


6. OPEN ASSUMPTIONS
   [Pending and Risky only — link to full register]


7. BLOCKERS
   [What, who, how many days old]


8. LINKS
   Demo PRD · Screen Inventory · Content Map ·
   Assumption Register · Decision Register ·
   Risk Register · Dependency Register ·
   Figma file · Phase 2/3 Backlog · Project Learnings
```

30.4 Writing standards

Standard	Rule
Dates	ISO format, always. Never relative (“last week”, “recently”).
Names	Full name on first use in a document
Decisions	Always with rationale
Assumptions	Always with status and owner
Numbers	Indian format for currency (₹1,24,500); IST for times
Ownership	Every document has one named owner
Length	Shorter is better. If a document exceeds six pages, split it or cut it.
Tone	Plain, professional, declarative. No hedging.

30.5 The Project Learnings document

A running document the whole team contributes to — one or two entries per person per week. What we learned, what surprised us, what we would do differently.

Why: tribal knowledge makes handoffs painful and makes the next project start from zero. Twenty minutes a week of capture is worth a great deal at the end of the phase.

30.6 Storage

Everything lives in one centralised location. **FOUNDER TO CONFIRM:** the specific tool (Notion / Google Drive / other) and access arrangements.

Nothing project-related lives on a personal device, in a personal account, or in a chat thread only.

30.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Information living only in chat	If it matters, it goes in the source of truth
Multiple competing “current” documents	One source of truth. Everything else links from it.
Documenting activity instead of decisions	Record what was decided and why
Relative dates	ISO, always

Documents with no owner	One named owner per document

30.8 Definition of success

A new person joining in Week 4 can be productive within half a day using documentation alone.

30.9 Checklist

- ☐ Source-of-truth document created Week 1 and linked from everywhere
- ☐ Updated at least daily
- ☐ All registers linked from it
- ☐ Every document has a named owner and a change log
- ☐ ISO dates, Indian currency format, IST throughout
- ☐ Project Learnings document in weekly use

31. Naming Conventions

31.1 Purpose

Consistent naming eliminates a category of small confusions that otherwise consume real time.

31.2 Documents

```
VK7_[Artefact]_v[X.Y]_[YYYY-MM-DD].[ext]


VK7_DemoPRD_v1.2_2026-08-14.docx
VK7_ScreenInventory_v2.0_2026-08-20.xlsx
VK7_Exclusions_v1.0_2026-09-02.pdf
VK7_OwnerDeck_v1.0_2026-09-05.pdf
VK7_AssumptionRegister_v1.4_2026-08-28.xlsx
VK7_Proposal_v1.0_2026-09-06.pdf
```

31.3 Figma frames

```
[JOURNEY]-[NN][state]_[PLATFORM]


BULK-01_M       TEAM-04b_M      PDP-02_D
BULK-04b_M      TEAM-06_M       CART-01_M
INT-01_D        GLB-NAV_M       DEMO-GATE_D
```

Journey prefixes:

Prefix	Journey
`HOME`	Homepage
`BULK`	P1 — Institutional bulk
`TEAM`	P2 — Custom teamwear
`CAT` / `PDP` / `CART`	P3 — Retail
`INT`	Internal handling (D8)
`GLB`	Global components
`DEMO`	Demo framing frames

31.4 Figma components

```
[Category]/[Component]/[Variant]


Button/Primary/Default
Button/Primary/Pressed
Form/Input/Default
Form/Input/Error
```

```
Card/Enquiry/Blocked
Badge/HumanInLoop
```

31.5 Registers and IDs

Register	Prefix	Example
Assumption	`ASM-`	ASM-014
Decision	`DEC-`	DEC-021
Risk	`RISK-` or `R-`	R-05
Dependency	`DEP-` or `D-`	D-12
Requirement	`REQ-`	REQ-007
Decision Brief	`DB-`	DB-003
Backlog item	`B-`	B-009
Defect	`BUG-`	BUG-018

Numbers are sequential and never reused. A deleted item is marked withdrawn, not deleted.

31.6 Meetings and files

```
VK7_[MeetingType]_[YYYY-MM-DD]

VK7_Critique_2026-08-19
VK7_SprintReview_2026-08-30
VK7_OwnerWalkthrough_2026-09-05
```

31.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Spaces in filenames	Underscores
`final`, `FINAL`, `final_v2`	Version numbers
Inconsistent date formats	ISO only
Single-digit screen numbers	Two digits: `04`, not `4`
Reusing register IDs	Never. Mark withdrawn.

31.8 Definition of success

Any file or reference in this project can be identified, dated, and located from its name alone.

32. Folder Structure

32.1 Purpose

A predictable structure means nobody searches, nobody duplicates, and the final handoff looks professional rather than improvised.

32.2 Working structure

```
VK7SPORTS_Prototype/
│
├── 00_Admin/
│   ├── Source_of_Truth.[doc]
│   ├── RACI.[doc]
│   └── Team_Availability.[sheet]
│
├── 01_Research/
│   ├── VK7_ReferenceAudit_v1.0_[date].[doc]
│   ├── VK7_BusinessBackground_v1.0_[date].[doc]
│   └── Owner_Conversation_Notes/
│
├── 02_Product/
│   ├── VK7_DemoPRD_v[x]_[date].[doc]
│   ├── VK7_Journeys_v[x]_[date].[doc]
│   ├── VK7_IA_Sitemap_v[x]_[date].[doc]
│   ├── VK7_ScreenInventory_v[x]_[date].[sheet]
│   └── VK7_ContentMap_v[x]_[date].[sheet]
│
├── 03_Registers/
│   ├── VK7_AssumptionRegister_v[x]_[date].[sheet]
│   ├── VK7_DecisionRegister_v[x]_[date].[sheet]
│   ├── VK7_RiskRegister_v[x]_[date].[sheet]
│   ├── VK7_DependencyRegister_v[x]_[date].[sheet]
│   └── VK7_OwnerQuestionList_v[x]_[date].[doc]
│
├── 04_Design/
│   ├── Figma_Links.[doc]
│   ├── Assets/
│   │   ├── Photography/
│   │   ├── Logos/
│   │   └── Icons/
│   └── Screenshot_History/
│       ├── Sprint1_[date]/
│       ├── Sprint2_[date]/
│       └── Sprint3_[date]/
│
├── 05_QA/
│   ├── VK7_DefectLog_v[x]_[date].[sheet]
│   ├── VK7_ConfusionLog_v[x]_[date].[sheet]
│   └── Outsider_Test_Notes/
│
├── 06_Demo/
│   ├── VK7_OwnerDeck_v[x]_[date].[file]
│   ├── VK7_DemoScript_v[x]_[date].[doc]
│   ├── VK7_Exclusions_v[x]_[date].[doc]
│   ├── VK7_Handout_A5_v[x]_[date].[file]
│   └── Rehearsal_Recordings/
│
├── 07_Backlog/
│   └── VK7_Phase23_Backlog_v[x]_[date].[sheet]
│
└── 08_Handoff/
    ├── Demo_Video/
```

```
├── Proposal/
├── Prototype_Link.[doc]
└── Summary_Notes/
```

32.3 The owner handoff folder

What the owner receives after the demo is a separate, clean, four-folder structure. Chaos here signals amateurism; order signals a company that takes its own work seriously.

```
VK7SPORTS_Website_Prototype_[DATE]/
├── 1_Demo_Recording/
├── 2_Prototype_Link/
├── 3_Proposal/
└── 4_Summary_Notes/
```

32.4 Rules

Rule	Detail
Numbered folders	Forces a consistent order in every file browser
One canonical location per artefact	No duplicates in multiple folders
No personal folders	Everything in the shared structure
Assets organised by type	Not by “stuff from the owner”
Archive, don’t delete	Superseded versions move to an archive subfolder

32.5 Definition of success

Any team member finds any artefact in under thirty seconds without asking.

33. Meeting Structure

33.1 Purpose

To spend the minimum time in meetings consistent with the team staying aligned.

33.2 The meeting set

Meeting	Frequency	Duration	Attendees	Purpose
Standup	Daily	15 min hard stop	All	Surface blockers
Design critique	Weekly (Tue)	45 min	Pradnya, UX, UI, Content	Structured feedback, top three issues
Dependency check	Weekly (Wed)	15 min	Pradnya (+ owner of any aged item)	Age, chase, escalate
Friday demo	Weekly (Fri)	30 min	All	Work-in-progress demo, natural deadline
Sprint review	Per sprint	60 min	All + founder	Gate assessment
Founder sync	Weekly or as needed	30 min	Pradnya + founder	Tier 2 decisions, escalations
Handoff pair session	At each handoff	30 min	Two parties	Transfer context properly

No agenda = no meeting. This applies to every item above except standup.

33.3 Standup format

Fifteen minutes. Async-friendly — if someone cannot attend, they post their three answers in the channel before the meeting.

Each person answers exactly three questions:

1. What moved yesterday?
2. What will move today?
3. What is blocking me?

Rules: - No problem-solving in standup. Blockers are named and taken offline immediately after. - Rotate the facilitator weekly. This builds the team and stops it becoming your meeting. - Hard stop at 15 minutes even mid-sentence.

33.4 Friday demo ritual

Thirty minutes, every Friday. The team demos work-in-progress — not finished work.

Why it works: short, public, recurring demos create natural deadlines and prevent end-of-phase cramming. They also normalise showing unfinished work, which is essential in a design team.

Format: each person takes five minutes, shows what they built, names what is not done.

33.5 Meeting hygiene

Rule	Reason
Agenda circulated before, or the meeting does not happen	Prevents the meeting becoming the thinking
Start on time regardless of attendance	Waiting punishes the punctual
One person takes notes	Decisions from meetings must reach the register the same day
Decisions recorded within the same working day	Section 21.6
End with explicit owners and dates	Meetings without owners produce nothing

33.6 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Standup becoming a status report to you	It is for the team, not for you
Problem-solving in standup	Name it, take it offline
Meetings without agendas	Cancel them
Decisions not recorded	Same-day rule
Too many meetings	The list above is complete. Do not add.

33.7 Definition of success

Total structured meeting time stays under four hours per week per person, and nobody is ever surprised by a decision.

34. Communication Rules

34.1 Purpose

To prevent misalignment, which in small teams grows almost entirely in side conversations.

34.2 The single channel rule

> **One project channel. All project discussion happens there.**

No side DMs about project decisions. No parallel WhatsApp group. If a conversation happens in a DM and produces a decision, that decision is posted to the channel immediately.

Why: side conversations are where two people develop a shared understanding that a third person never receives. That is how a team discovers in Week 5 that it has been building two different things.

34.3 Channel discipline

Rule	Detail
Decisions announced within 24 hours	Every Tier 1 decision, in the channel, with rationale
Blockers posted immediately	Not saved for standup
Daily two-line update	What moved, what is blocked
Links, not attachments	Attachments become stale copies
Threads for detail	Keep the main channel scannable

34.4 Written communication standards

Standard	Detail
Lead with the ask	First line states what you need and by when
One topic per message	Multiple topics produce partial replies
Specific dates	“By Thursday 14th”, never “soon”
Decision requests are answerable	Yes/no or A/B, not open-ended
Bad news goes early	Delayed bad news is a trust problem, not a schedule

problem

34.5 Response expectations

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: actual availability commitments. Proposed defaults:

From	To	Expectation
Team	Pradnya	Same working day
Pradnya	Team	Within four working hours
Pradnya	Founder	Same working day
Founder	Pradnya	Within 24 hours on Tier 2 briefs

If a response has not arrived by the expectation, chase once, then escalate. Do not wait silently and then report being blocked.

34.6 What never goes in the channel

- Personal or performance matters (handle privately, same day)
- Commercial terms and figures (founder channel only)
- Anything the owner should hear from the founder first
- Screenshots of client conversations without permission

34.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Side conversations about decisions	Post the decision to the channel
Burying the ask at the end of a long message	Lead with it
“Soon”, “ASAP”, “next week-ish”	Specific dates
Sitting on bad news	Report it the day it becomes true
Escalating without chasing first	Chase once, then escalate

34.8 Definition of success

No team member is ever surprised by a decision, and no decision exists only in a private conversation.

35. Founder Communication Rules

35.1 Purpose

To make our working relationship efficient. I want to be a fast unblocker for you, not a bottleneck — and that depends on how you bring things to me.

35.2 The three rules

Rule 1 — Batch. Never send questions one at a time. Collect five to seven, prioritise them, send once. A batch gets a considered answer in one sitting. Seven separate messages get seven rushed answers over three days.

Rule 2 — Bring decisions, not problems. Every escalation arrives as a Decision Brief (Section 9.4): options, recommendation, rationale, and a specific ask. A brief I can answer with one word is worth ten times a brief that requires a meeting.

Rule 3 — Own the unknown. When you do not know, say so, and commit to a date. *"I don't know yet — I'll confirm by Thursday"* is a complete, professional answer. Bluffing is not.

35.3 What to escalate immediately (do not batch)

Trigger	Why
Any Tier 3 matter arising	I need to handle it, not you
Any risk moving to High/High	Time-sensitive
Anything that will slip a milestone	Earlier is always better
Any integrity concern — fake data, unsubstantiated claim	Non-negotiable
Any owner communication outside the agreed artefacts	Relationship risk
Any team member unavailable for more than two days	Capacity risk
Blocking dependency D-12 unresolved entering Sprint 3	Demo-critical

35.4 What not to escalate

Do not escalate	Because
Tier 1 decisions	You have full authority. Decide, log, announce.
Design opinions	You are the design authority in this project

Anything you can answer by reading this handbook	Check first
Progress updates outside the Friday rhythm	The weekly update is sufficient unless something has changed

35.5 The question batch format

```
QUESTION BATCH [N] · [DATE]
Needed by: [DATE]

Q1. [Question]
    Blocks: [what work is waiting]
    My working assumption meanwhile: [what the team is proceeding on]

Q2. ...

(Maximum 7. Ordered by what is blocking the most work.)
```

FOUNDER TIP: Including “my working assumption meanwhile” is the detail that makes a batch excellent rather than merely organised. It tells me the project is moving, shows me your judgement, and lets me correct only where you have got it wrong.

35.6 Escalating well

```
ESCALATION · [DATE]
Urgency: Today / This week

WHAT HAS HAPPENED
[Two sentences. Facts only.]

WHY IT MATTERS
[What is at risk — schedule, scope, credibility, relationship]

WHAT I HAVE ALREADY DONE
[Do not escalate before attempting. Show the attempt.]

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU
[Specific. Answerable.]

IF I DON'T HEAR BACK BY [DATE], I WILL
[Your default action. This is important — it keeps the project moving
 and it demonstrates judgement.]
```

35.7 Handling founder feedback

When I push back on something:

1. Do not defend immediately. Ask what specifically is wrong.
2. Separate my direction (do this) from my opinion (consider this). Ask if unclear.

3. If you disagree, say so once, clearly, with reasoning. I would rather hear it than have you comply and be right.
4. If I still disagree, execute and log it as a decision with my name on it.
5. Never relay my feedback to the team as “the founder said so”. Own the direction and explain the reasoning.

WARNING: Point 5 matters more than it looks. A lead who hides behind the founder loses the team’s respect within a fortnight. Take the decision as yours, or push back on me before you take it to them.

35.8 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Question-at-a-time messaging	Batch
Bringing problems without options	Decision Brief format
Escalating Tier 1 matters	Decide them
Sitting on bad news	Same-day reporting
Relaying decisions as “founder said”	Own them
Bluffing when uncertain	“I don’t know yet, I’ll confirm by [date]”

35.9 Definition of success

I never learn something important about this project after the point at which I could have helped.

36. Owner Demo Preparation

36.1 Purpose

The walkthrough is the entire project compressed into roughly forty-five minutes. Everything before it is preparation for it.

36.2 The governing rule

> **Do not send the Figma link and wait. Drive the prototype yourself, over a screen-share or in person, narrating the journey.**

An unnarrated prototype is judged as a website. A narrated prototype is experienced as a solution to the owner's problem. The difference in outcome is enormous.

36.3 Preparation timeline

When	Activity
T-10 days	Confirm date, time, format (in person strongly preferred), attendees, and duration with the founder
T-7 days	Deck and script v0.1 complete
T-5 days	Outsider comprehension test; confusion log; fixes
T-4 days	Exclusions one-pager finalised; A5 handout designed
T-3 days	Full rehearsal with the team; timed
T-2 days	Second rehearsal; founder present; feedback incorporated
T-1 day	Prototype frozen and locked; PRESENT copy created; dry run on the actual device
T-0	Demo
T+1 day	Thank-you note, recorded walkthrough, summary document
T+2 days	Proposal PDF delivered

WARNING: Freeze the prototype the day before. Do not make changes on the morning of the demo. A change made at 9am and presented at 11am has not been QA'd, and the one thing worse than a rough screen is a broken one.

36.4 Logistics checklist

- ☐ Date, time, location confirmed in writing
- ☐ Attendees known — **FOUNDER TO CONFIRM** whether anyone beyond the owner will attend
- ☐ Duration agreed (target 45 minutes: 30 presenting, 15 discussion)
- ☐ Device tested — the actual laptop, the actual browser, the actual file
- ☐ Mobile device ready with the prototype loaded, for the mobile section
- ☐ Internet contingency: prototype cached or offline copy available
- ☐ Printed A5 handouts — four copies
- ☐ Printed exclusions one-pager
- ☐ Recording arrangement, with consent asked in advance
- ☐ Notebook for capturing corrections (visible note-taking matters — see 38.5)
- ☐ Approval record printed and ready

36.5 The rehearsal discipline

Two full rehearsals, minimum. Timed.

Rehearsal 1 (T-3): with the team. Focus on flow, transitions, and whether the narrative holds. Expect it to run long. Cut, do not speed up.

Rehearsal 2 (T-2): with the founder present, playing the owner — including asking hard questions and requesting excluded features. Practise the deflection script under pressure.

What to rehearse specifically:

Element	Why
The opening thirty seconds	Sets the frame for everything after
Every transition between journeys	Fumbling here destroys credibility
The three verbal disclaimers	They must sound natural, not defensive
The deflection script	Under pressure, unrehearsed, you will say yes
The pauses	Five seconds of silence is much longer than it feels
The closing question	Do not end on a monologue

36.6 The A5 handout

A four-page printed booklet accompanying the demo: **Today / Tomorrow / Phases / Investment.**

Why physical: the owner may want to discuss this with a partner, a family member, or an internal colleague. A physical document travels in a way a Figma link does not, and it signals that we prepared for him rather than for ourselves.

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: the Investment page content — this is Tier 3 and I will supply it.

36.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Sending the link instead of presenting	Always narrate
Making changes on demo day	Freeze T-1
Rehearsing once	Two minimum, one with founder as owner
No mobile device present	The owner runs his business on a phone; show him the phone
Presenting from the working file	Locked PRESENT copy only
No recording	You will forget half the feedback

36.8 Definition of success

You run the demo without notes, without fumbling a transition, and without a single moment where you have to say “sorry, that’s not quite working”.

37. Presentation Script

37.1 Purpose

To give you a structured, rehearsable narrative — not a feature tour.

37.2 The three-act structure

Act	Purpose	Duration
Act 1 — Diagnosis	Prove we understand his business before we show anything	8 min
Act 2 — Solution	Walk the journeys, in priority order, with "so what" translation	20 min
Act 3 — Path forward	Exclusions, assumptions, next phase, the ask	12 min
Discussion	His questions, his corrections	15 min

37.3 The script

ACT 1 — DIAGNOSIS (8 minutes)

Opening — pain first, not prototype.

> *"Before we show you anything, I want to go back to what you told us. You said [OWNER'S OWN WORDS — verbatim from the discovery conversation]. Everything we've built over the last six weeks starts from that sentence."*

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM / DEPENDENCY D-11: the owner's verbatim quote. This is the single most important line in the demo. Do not paraphrase it, and do not proceed without it.

The daily chaos map.

> *"This is how enquiries reach you today, as we understand it — WhatsApp, calls, walk-ins, referrals. Four channels, no single place they land. Have we got that right?"*

Pause. Let him correct you. Corrections here are gold — they mean he is engaged and you are learning.

The two doors frame.

Show the split screen: left, today's process with annotated pain points; right, the proposed system with solution icons.

"On the left is what happens today. On the right is what we're proposing. I want to be clear about one thing before we go further — we are not proposing to replace WhatsApp. WhatsApp works for you. We're proposing to give it structure."

Verbal disclaimer 1.

"What you're about to see is a clickable concept, not a working system. Nothing behind it is built. That's deliberate — we don't want to build the wrong thing."

ACT 2 — SOLUTION (20 minutes)

Order matters. Bulk first, because it is where his money is.

2.1 — Homepage (2 min) Premium impression, and the two doors made concrete.

"A coach from a school and a parent buying one jersey arrive at the same place. Notice they immediately go different ways. So what this means for you is that you stop getting bulk enquiries mixed into general questions."

2.2 — Bulk institutional journey (7 min) The core of the demo. Walk it on mobile.

Show: entry → requirement capture → role field → quantity with indicative bands → contact capture with WhatsApp primary → submission confirmation → two-tier quotation → status timeline → channel handoff.

Narrate the "so what" after every screen:

Screen	"So what this means for you is…"
Requirement capture	*"…the coach tells you quantity, timeline and sport before you pick up the phone."*
Role field	*"…you know immediately whether you're talking to the decision-maker or someone who has to go back to a committee."*
Two-tier quote	*"…you're showing them standard and premium together, which is how you upsell today, but written down."*
Status timeline	*"…you can see at a glance which enquiries are sitting waiting on you."*
Channel handoff	*"…and then it moves to WhatsApp, where you're comfortable."*

Verbal disclaimer 2 — at the quotation screen:

"These numbers are illustrative. Real pricing logic is one of the things Discovery would define, because it affects everything downstream."

Pause point 1. Five seconds of silence. Count them.

2.3 — Custom teamwear journey (6 min) Brief capture → roster upload → artwork upload with camera option → mock-up preview → approval with audit strip.

> *"So what this means for you is that when a coach approves a design, there's a record of who approved it and when. The 'I never said that' conversation goes away."*

Pause point 2.

2.4 — Internal enquiry handling (3 min) The worklist, the detail view, today's action items — including the blocked enquiry.

> *"This one's flagged because you're waiting on their logo. So what this means for you is that nothing sits forgotten because you were busy that week."*

2.5 — Retail (2 min) Brief. Establish credibility and move on.

2.6 — The process boundary map. The swimlane: Enquiry (digital) → Quote (hybrid) → Sample (manual) → Order (hybrid) → Delivery (manual).

> *"This is the honest picture. Some of this is a system, and some of it is still your team on the phone. We've designed it that way on purpose. A system that pretends to remove every phone call from your business is a system you'd stop using in a month."*

FOUNDER TIP: This is frequently the moment an owner decides to trust you. It costs nothing and it is the strongest credibility move in the demo.

ACT 3 — PATH FORWARD (12 minutes)

3.1 — The included / excluded T-chart (2 min) A clean two-column visual. Leave it on screen for a full sixty seconds. Do not talk over the whole time — let him read.

3.2 — Things we are still learning (2 min) Name the Risky assumptions directly.

> *"There are things we've assumed and haven't confirmed. Bulk discount tiers. How artwork reaches you today. Your turnaround commitments. We've marked all of these in the prototype rather than guessing quietly, because getting them wrong later is expensive."*

3.3 — What Discovery covers (3 min) Five to seven specific activities. Specificity reduces "what am I paying for?" anxiety.

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM / DEPENDENCY D-12: the Discovery activity list.

3.4 — The Phase 2 card (2 min) One card: scope, duration, three key activities, start date.

3.5 — Investment (1 min) One number, one line, one date. No itemisation. Itemised investment slides read as defensive.

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: figure and terms. This is my slide, not yours — I will supply the exact wording, and I will deliver it if I am present.

3.6 — The closing gate frame (1 min) The final prototype screen: *"Phase 1 ends here. Phase 2 — Discovery — begins on approval."* With his name and the proposed date.

Verbal disclaimer 3:

> *"Everything you've seen is design and flow. Nothing is engineered yet. Phase 2 is where we work out what it actually takes to build."*

3.7 — End with a question (1 min)

> *"What concerns you most about the next phase?"*

Then stop talking.

37.4 Why the closing question matters

A question converts a monologue into a dialogue and surfaces the objection that would otherwise be raised after you leave, in a room you are not in. Whatever he says next is the most valuable information you will get all day. Write it down in front of him.

37.5 The pause discipline

Three to four marked pause points, five seconds each, in silence.

Owners process slowly and think in outcomes. Filling silence with more talking destroys the reflection that leads to a decision. Five seconds feels like thirty when you are presenting. Count it deliberately.

37.6 Credit the team

At least twice, name a team member for their work:

> *"This roster screen was designed by [Name], based on the journey [Name] mapped."*

This costs nothing, it is true, and leaders who elevate others are read as more senior, not less.

37.7 Hand over for two minutes

Plan one two-minute segment where the UI designer or UX lead describes their own work. Distributed speaking signals confidence rather than insecurity.

37.8 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Opening with the prototype	Open with his words
Feature dumping	Three acts; "so what" after every screen

Filling every silence	Marked pauses, counted
Saving exclusions for the end	T-chart in Act 3, but disclaimer 1 in Act 1
Ending on a monologue	End with the question
Reading the script verbatim	Rehearse until it is yours
Presenting retail first	Bulk first. Always.

37.9 Definition of success

The owner talks more in the last fifteen minutes than you do, and at least one thing he says is a correction to a workflow assumption.

38. Stakeholder Handling

38.1 Purpose

To manage the room — including people who are not the owner and questions you cannot answer.

38.2 Know who is in the room

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: attendee list. Prepare differently for each type.

Attendee type	What they care about	How to handle
Owner / final approver	Cost, disruption, whether it solves his actual pain	The demo is written for him
Family member / partner in the business	Risk, whether this is a sensible spend	Address the risk-free reversal note explicitly
Operations or sales staff	Whether it makes their day harder	Show the human-in-the-loop badges; emphasise augmentation
A technically-minded friend or advisor	Feasibility, whether we know what we are doing	Be precise about what is and is not built. Do not overclaim.

38.3 The four question types and how to answer

Type	Example	Response
Answerable	"Can a coach upload a spreadsheet?"	Answer directly, show the screen
Founder decision	"What will the full build cost?"	*"That's a founder question — [FOUNDER NAME] will take that."* Or, if I am absent: *"I'll get you a precise answer by [date] rather than an estimate now."*
Unknown	"How would this handle a 500-piece order across three schools?"	*"I don't know yet. That's exactly the kind of thing Discovery would work out. Let me note it."* Write it down visibly.
Scope expansion	"Could it also do the Tally accounting side?"	The deflection script (Section 6.6)

38.4 The three phrases to have ready

Rehearse these until they are automatic.

> **Deflection:** *"That's a strong idea, and I want to make sure it gets done properly rather than sketched. Let me log it for Discovery with a clear priority — that way we cost it and scope it rather than assume it."*
>
> **Uncertainty:** *"I don't know yet. I'll confirm by [specific date]."*
>
> **Boundary:** *"That's a commercial question and I'd rather [FOUNDER NAME] answer it precisely than have me estimate."*

38.5 Visible note-taking

When someone raises something you are deferring, **write it down in front of them.** Physically, in a notebook, visibly.

This single behaviour converts a deferral from a refusal into an act of respect. The person sees their idea being captured rather than dismissed. It is the difference between "no" and "not yet, and I've got it".

38.6 The risk-free reversal note

Prepare this as both a verbal statement and a written line in the proposal:

> *"If Discovery reveals that this isn't the right fit for how you work, you can pause without penalty. We'd rather find that out in Discovery than after a build."*

Why: owners commit faster when the exit is dignified. This reduces the perceived risk of saying yes without reducing the value of the yes.

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: whether this is commercially acceptable in the terms I set. Do not say it until I confirm.

38.7 If the owner reacts negatively

Do not defend. Do not explain more. Do these four things:

1. **Ask what specifically is wrong.** "Which part doesn't match how it works?"
2. **Write it down visibly.**
3. **Thank them for the correction.** Mean it — a correction in the room is worth more than politeness.
4. **Do not redesign in the room.** *"Let me take that back and show you what it looks like corrected."*

FOUNDER TIP: An owner who corrects your workflow assumptions is engaged and is telling you how to win. An owner who says “very nice” and nothing else is usually not going to sign. Treat criticism as the better outcome.

38.8 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Answering commercial questions	Route to founder
Bluffing on unknowns	“I don’t know yet, by [date]”
Defending the design under criticism	Ask what specifically is wrong
Redesigning live in the room	Take it away, come back with it corrected
Deferring without visible capture	Write it down where they can see
Preparing only for the owner	Know the whole room

38.9 Definition of success

Every question in the room is either answered, cleanly routed to the founder, or explicitly captured — and nothing is bluffed.

39. Prototype Storytelling

39.1 Purpose

The prototype is evidence in a story. This section is about the story.

39.2 The narrative spine

> **He has a problem he lives with daily. Here is that problem, named precisely. Here is what it would look like solved. Here is honestly what is still manual. Here is what it takes to find out properly.**

Every element of the demo serves one of those five beats. Anything serving none of them is cut.

39.3 Mirroring language

Use the owner's own words. If he says "party" for a client, say party. If he says "set" for a kit, say set. If he says "chalta hai" about a current workaround, use his framing.

Mirroring language is the deepest available signal of "I understand you". Design vocabulary that he has to translate creates distance at exactly the moment you need proximity.

Build a terminology list from the discovery conversation and use it in both the copy and the narration. This is Dependency D-13.

39.4 Show transformation, not features

Weak	Strong
"This is the bulk enquiry form."	"This is what happens now instead of you asking the same five questions on every call."
"Here's the quotation screen."	"This is where you'd show standard and premium side by side — which is what you already do verbally."
"This is the internal dashboard."	"This is Monday morning. Three of these need a phone call today."

39.5 The hero screenshot

Identify the single most premium screen in the prototype — most likely the internal worklist or the mock-up approval screen — and polish it to a standard where it could be screenshotted and forwarded without embarrassment.

Why: owners share wins. A frame beautiful enough to send to a partner is the most effective internal marketing this project has, and it costs one designer-day.

Requirements for the hero screen: perfect spacing, real content, no lorem ipsum, correct Indian formatting, watermark present but discreet.

39.6 Personalisation

Use the owner's name and business story in the prototype hero, and on the closing gate frame. Personalisation converts a generic demo into "this is mine", and emotional ownership precedes financial commitment.

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM / DEPENDENCY D-11: owner's name and preferred form of address.

39.7 Save the best for last

Recency bias is strong. The single most visually striking screen — most likely the approved mock-up with the full status timeline — is shown near the end, not at the beginning.

Do not open with your best screen. Open with his problem.

39.8 Honest metrics only

If you show a metric card ("hours saved per enquiry"), it must be labelled **Illustrative** and it must be defensible as a plausible order of magnitude.

WARNING: A precise-looking fabricated metric ("4.2 hours saved") is more dangerous than a vague one, because precision implies measurement. If you cannot defend how the number was derived, either mark it clearly as an illustrative scenario or do not show it. When in doubt, cut it — the demo does not need it.

39.9 The future-state frame

A modest final frame: *"In Phase 3, the system could…"* with three or four believable next steps.

Owners buy futures, not features. But keep it modest and clearly forward-looking — this frame must never read as a promise. Label it accordingly.

39.10 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Feature narration	Transformation narration
Design vocabulary	His vocabulary

Opening with the best screen	Open with his problem; close with the best screen
Unmarked or fabricated metrics	Illustrative, defensible, or cut
Future-state frame that reads as a commitment	Label it clearly as a possibility

39.11 Definition of success

At the end of the demo the owner describes what he saw in terms of his business, not in terms of screens.

40. Demo Psychology

40.1 Purpose

To understand how the person in front of you actually forms a decision, and to design the demo around that.

40.2 Six things that are true about how owners decide

1. They think in outcomes, not interfaces. Every screen needs a "so what". Without translation, the owner sees a website; with translation, he sees his Tuesday getting easier.

2. They process slowly and out loud. Give them silence. The pause discipline in Section 37.5 exists because reflection is where the decision forms, and talking prevents reflection.

3. Emotional ownership precedes financial commitment. Personalisation, mirrored language, their own quote in the opening — these are not flourishes. They are the mechanism by which the thing becomes *his* before it becomes a purchase.

4. Trust is fragile and asymmetric. One discovered exaggeration undoes ten honest screens. This is the entire argument for the marking rules and the human-in-the-loop honesty. Honesty is not just ethical here; it is the most effective available tactic.

5. Recency dominates memory. The last thing they see is what they remember. Structure accordingly — best screen near the end, closing question last.

6. Risk aversion is the default. The instinct is not "will this work?" but "what if I spend money and it doesn't?". The risk-free reversal note, the phased structure, and the specificity of the Discovery activity list all exist to reduce perceived risk.

40.3 What builds trust

Behaviour	Why it works
Naming what you do not know	Consultants who admit gaps are believed about the rest
Showing manual steps deliberately	Proves diagnosis, not sales
Marking illustrative data	Signals you take accuracy seriously
Using their words	Proves listening
Visible note-taking	Proves their input has weight
Crediting your team	Signals a real organisation, not a solo act

A clean, organised handoff folder	Order signals competence

40.4 What destroys trust

Behaviour	Why it fails
Any fabricated element discovered later	Everything else becomes suspect
Overclaiming technical capability	The first technical question exposes it
Agreeing to things in the room	Creates obligations, and the walk-back is worse than the original no
Pretending everything is automated	He knows his business; you look naive
Bluffing an answer	Owners are experienced at detecting this
A messy or improvised handoff	Undoes the impression of the demo itself

40.5 The "so what" loop

Write a one-line "so what" for **every** screen in advance, in the demo script. Not improvised on the day.

```
Screen: BULK-04 (quantity & timeline)
So what: "So what this means for you is that you know the volume
          and the deadline before you pick up the phone."
```

Owners do not connect visuals to outcomes automatically. Translation is your job, and it is the part of presenting that most reliably separates a good demo from a forgettable one.

40.6 Testing comprehension before the demo

Two to three outsiders. Non-technical. Five to fifteen minutes each.

The protocol:

1. **Task completion.** Give three tasks: *"Find where you'd send a bulk enquiry"*, *"Request a quote"*, *"Upload a logo"*. Observe silently. Do not help. Note every hesitation.
2. **The one-sentence test.** Afterwards: *"What is this website for, in one sentence?"* If they cannot answer, neither will the owner.
3. **Read-aloud test.** Have them read every key headline aloud. Stumbling reveals jargon or unclear phrasing. Rewrite anything they stumble on.
4. **Confusion log.** Record every hesitation with timestamp and cause. This is your fix list.

5. **Memory test (optional).** One hour later: *"What do you remember most?"* Reveals what actually stuck.

Template — Confusion Log

```
CONFUSION LOG · Tester [N] · [DATE]

Time  Screen     What happened                    Cause              Fix
0:45  HOME-01    Hesitated 6s before clicking     Bulk CTA unclear   Reword to "Bulk / Institutional
Orders"
2:10  BULK-03    Asked "what's a roster?"         Jargon             Add helper text
3:30  TEAM-05    Tried to tap non-interactive     Looks clickable    Reduce affordance
```

FOUNDER TIP: Test with people who resemble the owner in digital comfort, not people who resemble your team. A designer friend will not find what a 50-year-old business owner will find.

40.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Improvising the "so what"	Write every one in advance
Testing with design-literate people only	Test with people like the owner
Helping during the task test	Observe silently; the hesitation is the data
Skipping testing under time pressure	Protect Sprint 3 Days 6–7 absolutely
Assuming clarity because the team understands	The team is the worst possible judge of clarity

40.8 Definition of success

Every outsider tested can state what the site is for in one sentence, and every hesitation in the confusion log has been addressed or consciously accepted.

41. Premium UX Principles

41.1 Purpose

To define what “premium” means concretely enough that it can be reviewed and enforced, rather than argued about.

41.2 The principle

> **Premium is felt through restraint, not through addition.**

Every instinct to add — another icon, another colour, another section — moves the design away from premium. The discipline is subtraction.

41.3 The visual system — locked rules

Whitespace

- Maximum **three elements** per hero section
- Generous vertical spacing between sections — a defined spacing scale, applied consistently
- Every screen reviewed specifically for breathing room before acceptance

Typography

- Maximum **two to three type sizes per screen**
- One type scale, established in Sprint 2 Day 1, applied everywhere
- Type as architecture: hierarchy created through size and weight, not through colour and decoration

Colour

- **Athletic Minimalism** palette: deep blacks, slate greys, stark whites
- **One accent colour**, used sparingly at moments of significance
- The accent appears at key moments, not as decoration

Iconography

- **Ten to fifteen icons total across the entire prototype**
- One icon set, approved upfront
- Ad-hoc icon additions rejected in review
- Icon spam is the single clearest signal of amateur work

Imagery

- **Real sportswear photography only.** No generic stock imagery of people in offices.

- Consistent treatment: same crop discipline, same tonal treatment
- If licensed photography is unavailable, use a smaller number of good images rather than a larger number of poor ones

41.4 Microinteractions — approved list

Exactly three. No more.

Interaction	Detail
Button hover	Slight elevation with a soft shadow
Form field focus	Clear, restrained focus state
One success state	Single tasteful confirmation on quote approval

WARNING: One tasteful moment beats five gimmicky ones. Confetti everywhere, sound effects, animated counters on every screen — each of these individually seems fun and collectively destroys the premium impression. Restraint is the product.

A single dashboard counter animation on demo open is permitted as an opening moment, if the designer proposes it and you approve it. That is the only exception.

41.5 The premium review test

Before accepting any screen, ask these five questions:

1. Could I remove an element and lose nothing? (If yes, remove it.)
2. How many type sizes are on this screen? (More than three: fail.)
3. How many colours? (More than the palette plus one accent: fail.)
4. Does the whitespace feel deliberate or accidental?
5. Would this screen embarrass us if the owner forwarded a screenshot of it?

41.6 Premium versus cheap — the positioning

VK7SPORTS competes against cheap imported alternatives. The visual system must communicate **Professional Grade** — that this is equipment, not merchandise.

Reads premium	Reads cheap
Restraint, whitespace	Density, everything visible at once
One accent colour	Multiple competing colours
Real product photography	Generic stock imagery

Confident, short copy	Superlatives and exclamation marks
Consistent type scale	Many sizes, inconsistent
10–15 icons	Icons everywhere
Considered empty states	Unstyled empty screens

41.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Adding to make a screen feel finished	Subtract instead
Ad-hoc icons	Approved set only
Multiple accent colours	One
Animation everywhere	Three microinteractions total
Stock photography of models in offices	Real sportswear imagery
Inconsistent spacing	One scale, applied everywhere

41.8 Definition of success

Every screen passes the five-question review test, and the prototype could be shown alongside a genuinely premium brand's site without looking out of place.

41.9 Checklist

- ☐ Type scale established Sprint 2 Day 1 and applied everywhere
- ☐ Palette locked: blacks, slate greys, whites, one accent
- ☐ Icon set approved and capped at 10–15
- ☐ Maximum three elements per hero section
- ☐ Three microinteractions only
- ☐ Real sportswear photography only
- ☐ Every screen reviewed against the five-question test
- ☐ Hero screenshot identified and polished to forwardable quality

42. Mobile First Principles

42.1 Purpose

The owner runs his business from a phone. Coaches check enquiries between sessions. Over eighty percent of Indian e-commerce traffic is mobile. If the prototype does not feel native on a phone, the entire pitch weakens.

42.2 The principle

> **Design mobile first. Review on a physical device. Desktop is derived, never the reverse.**

42.3 The hard rules

Rule	Detail	Acceptance criterion
Single-finger reach	Every interactive element reachable with one thumb	AC-13
Tap targets	Minimum 44×44px equivalent for every interactive element	AC-13
Form stacking	One field per row. No multi-column forms on mobile.	AC-14
WhatsApp primary	WhatsApp number is the primary contact field; email optional	AC-12
Camera-first upload	Prominent “Take photo of logo” option alongside file upload	Section 16.4
Physical device review	Every screen reviewed on an actual phone, not the Figma canvas	DoD 25.3

42.4 Why the WhatsApp-primary rule matters

Indian SMBs and institutional buyers communicate on WhatsApp first and email rarely. A form that demands an email address before a WhatsApp number is an anti-pattern in this market — it signals that the product was designed for a different country.

Making the WhatsApp field primary and email optional is a small design decision that reads, to this owner, as evidence that we understand his customers.

42.5 The quick bulk enquiry

Build a three-step “Quick Bulk Enquiry” mobile flow with minimal fields, alongside the full flow.

Why: coaches check phones between sessions, in a gym, standing up. A dedicated short flow signals genuine understanding of the context of use. This is high value for low effort.

42.6 Step-by-step: the mobile review

Do this for every screen before acceptance.

1. Open the screen in Figma mobile view.
2. Open it on a **physical phone**, not just the mirror.
3. Hold the phone one-handed. Can you reach every interactive element with your thumb?
4. Measure the smallest tap target. Under 44px: fail.
5. Check the form: single column? Field order logical? Keyboard type appropriate for each field?
6. Check the primary CTA: visible without scrolling, or clearly reachable?
7. Check text size: readable at arm’s length in daylight?
8. Record the result against the screen’s acceptance criteria.

42.7 Desktop treatment

Desktop is required only for: homepage, PDP, quotation view, internal worklist (per Section 5.5). Everything else is mobile-only.

When designing desktop, do not simply widen the mobile layout. Use the space for the things desktop is genuinely better at — the quotation comparison and the internal worklist both benefit from a wider view.

42.8 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Designing desktop and shrinking	Mobile first, always
Reviewing only in Figma	Physical device, every screen
Multi-column mobile forms	One field per row
Email as primary contact	WhatsApp primary
File-upload-only for artwork	Camera option, prominent
Small tap targets to fit more in	Fit less in

42.9 Definition of success

The owner picks up a phone during the demo, uses the prototype one-handed, and does not comment on anything being awkward.

42.10 Checklist

- ☐ Every screen designed mobile-first
- ☐ Every screen reviewed on a physical device
- ☐ All tap targets ≥44×44px
- ☐ All mobile forms single-column
- ☐ WhatsApp primary on all contact capture
- ☐ Camera option on artwork upload
- ☐ Quick Bulk Enquiry three-step flow built
- ☐ Desktop present only where the inventory requires it

43. Realistic Sample Data Guidelines

43.1 Purpose

Sample data is where a prototype either feels real or feels generated. This section makes it feel real without making it dishonest.

43.2 The two competing requirements

> **The data must feel authentic enough to be believable, and be marked clearly enough that nobody mistakes it for real.**

These are not in conflict. Realistic *format* with honest *labelling* achieves both.

43.3 The rules

Institution names

Use realistic Indian institutional names — school, college, academy, club, corporate. Marked **Sample**.

Rule	Reason
Indian naming conventions	"Springfield High" reads as generated; a plausible Indian school name reads as real
Varied types across the data set	Schools, colleges, academies, clubs, corporates — the business serves all of them
Marked **Sample**	Non-negotiable
Never a real institution's name without permission	Implying a client relationship is exclusion X13

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: whether any real institution names may be used, and under what permission. Until confirmed, use clearly generic-but-plausible constructions.

Quantities

Use believable, uneven numbers. Real orders are messy.

Use	Avoid
42, 85, 118, 137, 64	50, 100, 500, 1000

Round numbers read as placeholders. Uneven numbers read as a business.

Currency

Indian formatting, always: ₹1,24,500 — not ₹124,500.

This is a small detail that carries disproportionate weight with an Indian business owner. Getting it wrong signals that the work was not made for him.

Every monetary figure marked **Illustrative**.

Timestamps

- **IST always.** A UTC timestamp breaks immersion instantly.
- **Business-hour gaps.** One to four hours between events. Not 03:00.
- Consistent date format throughout.

People's names

- Sample staff names in the internal worklist — e.g. a sales person, a logistics person
- **Ask the owner for two or three real team member names** and use them (Dependency D-10). Seeing his own team in the prototype is a strong personalisation signal.
- Marked **Sample** where they are invented

The edge case

Include exactly one enquiry in the sample data with a visible problem — e.g. *"Awaiting logo from client"* — and show how the system flags it.

Why: a list of clean, resolved enquiries reads as theoretical. One visible blocker makes the whole system feel battle-tested rather than staged.

Metrics

Any metric card must be: 1. Labelled **Illustrative** 2. A plausible order of magnitude 3. Defensible if questioned

If you cannot defend how a number was derived, cut it. See the warning in Section 39.8.

43.4 The three institutional scenarios

Represent all three in the bulk journey and internal worklist, so the system does not appear to handle only one buyer type:

Type	Approximate quantity	Product
School	~120	Jerseys
Academy	~40	Training kits

Corporate	~60	Polos

Use uneven numbers in the actual data (118, 42, 64) rather than these round approximations.

43.5 The trust bar rule

Permitted	Forbidden
Client *categories*: "Schools · Academies · Corporate Teams · Sports Clubs", marked illustrative	Named clients
	Client logos
	Testimonials
	Any implication of a relationship that does not exist

This line is absolute. Section 6 exclusions X13 and X14.

43.6 Step-by-step: building the sample data set

1. List every screen that displays data.
2. For each, define what data types appear.
3. Build one consistent data set in a spreadsheet — the same institutions, quantities and dates used across every screen. Inconsistent data between screens is a visible defect.
4. Apply all format rules: Indian currency, IST, uneven quantities, varied institution types.
5. Insert the one edge case.
6. Apply marking labels.
7. Review the whole set as a body — does it read as one business's week, or as random values?

FOUNDER TIP: The consistency test is the one teams fail. If the internal worklist shows a 118-jersey order from one institution and the quotation screen shows a 100-jersey order from another, the owner notices — and it makes the whole thing feel assembled rather than designed.

43.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Round numbers	Uneven, realistic

Western currency formatting	₹1,24,500
UTC or unrealistic timestamps	IST, business hours
Foreign-sounding institution names	Indian, plausible, marked Sample
Only happy-path data	One visible edge case
Inconsistent data across screens	One master data set
Unmarked data	Every point labelled
Real client names or logos	Forbidden

43.8 Definition of success

An outsider looking at the prototype believes the data could be real, and reading any screen carefully makes it obvious that it is not.

43.9 Checklist

- ☐ One master sample data set built in a spreadsheet
- ☐ Indian currency formatting everywhere
- ☐ IST timestamps with realistic gaps
- ☐ Uneven quantities
- ☐ Three institutional scenarios represented
- ☐ One edge-case enquiry included
- ☐ Real team member names obtained (D-10) or Sample names used
- ☐ Every data point marked Illustrative or Sample
- ☐ Data consistent across every screen
- ☐ No named clients, logos, or testimonials

44. Quality Gates

44.1 Purpose

Gates are binary checkpoints. Work does not pass a gate partially. This section defines every gate in the project.

44.2 The gate list

Gate	When	Approver	Consequence of failure
G1 — Definition	End Sprint 1	Founder	High-fidelity design does not start
G2 — Design	End Sprint 2	Pradnya + founder	Sprint 3 scope reduced
G3 — Screen acceptance	Per screen, continuous	Pradnya	Screen returns to design
G4 — Journey acceptance	Per journey	Pradnya	Journey not wired into prototype
G5 — QA	Sprint 3 Day 5	QA + Pradnya	Defects fixed before testing
G6 — Comprehension	Sprint 3 Day 7	Pradnya	Confusion log addressed before rehearsal
G7 — Demo readiness	Sprint 3 Day 10	**Founder**	**Demo does not happen**

44.3 G1 — Definition gate

- ☐ Demo PRD written, reviewed, founder-approved
- ☐ Exclusion list communicated to whole team
- ☐ IA and sitemap frozen, logged as a decision
- ☐ All four journeys specified with “must be clickable” lists
- ☐ Screen inventory complete with IDs, fidelity, owners
- ☐ Content map started, no lorem ipsum planned
- ☐ All four registers created and populated
- ☐ All dependencies requested with due dates and fallbacks
- ☐ Wireframes complete for P1 and P2

- ☐ RACI published and confirmed

44.4 G2 — Design gate

- ☐ Visual system locked: type scale, palette, spacing, icons
- ☐ All P1 screens accepted
- ☐ P2 screens at least 80% accepted
- ☐ All sample data populated from the master data set
- ☐ Zero lorem ipsum anywhere in the file
- ☐ All illustrative and sample data marked
- ☐ Mobile review passed on physical device for all accepted screens
- ☐ Assets integrated or fallbacks in use and logged
- ☐ Screen inventory reconciled — zero unaccounted frames

44.5 G5 — QA gate

Full click-through of every journey by someone who did not design it.

- ☐ Every “must be clickable” element functions
- ☐ Zero dead ends
- ☐ Return-to-home available from every screen
- ☐ All Figma Flows function
- ☐ Watermark and footer on every screen
- ☐ All data marked
- ☐ All defects logged; all severity-1 and severity-2 defects fixed

Defect severity:

Severity	Definition	Must fix before
S1	Blocks a journey; visible break	G5
S2	Visible defect the owner would notice	G5
S3	Minor inconsistency	G7 if time allows
S4	Nice to have	Backlog

44.6 G6 — Comprehension gate

- ☐ Two to three outsiders tested

- ☐ Every tester could state the site's purpose in one sentence
- ☐ Confusion log complete
- ☐ Every S1/S2 confusion item addressed or consciously accepted with a logged decision
- ☐ Read-aloud test passed on every key headline

44.7 G7 — Demo readiness gate

This gate is approved by the founder, not by you. It is binary and not partially passable.

- ☐ All acceptance criteria AC-01 to AC-25 met
- ☐ Zero excluded features present
- ☐ Zero fake logos, testimonials, or client names
- ☐ All governance mechanisms in place (Section 19)
- ☐ "Not Included Yet" screen and Phase 2 Gate frame built
- ☐ Exclusions one-pager finalised
- ☐ Deck and script complete, with a "so what" line for every screen
- ☐ Two full rehearsals completed, one with founder as owner
- ☐ Three verbal disclaimers rehearsed
- ☐ Deflection script rehearsed under pressure
- ☐ PRESENT copy created, locked, and tested
- ☐ A5 handout printed
- ☐ Approval record printed
- ☐ Logistics checklist complete (Section 36.4)
- ☐ Dependency D-12 resolved — Discovery scope, dates, investment confirmed

WARNING: If G7 cannot be passed, the correct action is to move the demo, not to present anyway. A postponed demo costs a week. A bad demo costs the engagement.

44.8 Definition of success

Every gate assessed explicitly, in writing, with a recorded pass or fail per criterion. No gate passed "mostly".

45. Weekly Review Process

45.1 Purpose

The weekly review is where you check direction rather than progress. Progress is visible daily; direction drifts invisibly.

45.2 The five questions

Ask these every Friday, in this order, before writing the update.

1. Are we still building the right thing? Re-read the vision statement and the demonstration requirements D1–D8. Does this week's output serve them? If a week's work cannot be mapped to a D-requirement, that is a finding.

2. Are we building it in the right order? Check effort spent per journey against the P1 > P2 > P3 priority. If P3 or the homepage is consuming disproportionate time, the Polish Trap has arrived (R-05). Correct it visibly at the next standup.

3. What did we learn that changes something? New information from the owner, from testing, from the team. What decision or assumption does it affect? Update the registers.

4. What is at risk? Re-score the risk register. Anything now High/High goes to the founder today.

5. What did I get wrong this week? This is the reflection note. It is the question that makes the other four honest.

45.3 The review sequence

Step	Activity	Time
1	Reconcile screen inventory; produce accepted/in-progress/not-started counts by journey	15 min
2	Update all four registers	20 min
3	Age and action every dependency	10 min
4	Ask the five questions above	15 min
5	Hold the Friday internal demo	30

		min
6	Write and send the weekly update	20 min
7	Record the three-minute walkthrough	10 min
8	Write the reflection note	5 min

Roughly two hours. Protect it. It is the most leveraged block in your week.

45.4 The progress measure

Use inventory acceptance, not percentage feeling.

```
PROGRESS · Week [N]
                    Accepted   In progress   Not started
P1 — Bulk              12           3             2
P2 — Custom             6           5             4
P3 — Retail             2           2             8
Internal                3           1             2
Global                  5           1             0
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────
TOTAL                  28          12            16   (50% accepted)
```

This is honest in a way that "we're about 70% done" never is, and it makes the priority skew immediately visible.

45.5 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Reviewing progress but not direction	Ask the five questions
Percentage estimates	Inventory counts
Skipping the review when busy	The busy weeks are when direction drifts
Reflection notes that are only positive	Nobody believes them

45.6 Definition of success

No week passes in which the project drifted from the priority order without you noticing and correcting it.

46. Internal Approval Process

46.1 Purpose

To define how work moves from “made” to “accepted” inside the team, before anything reaches the founder or the owner.

46.2 The separation principle

> **The person who made a thing does not approve it.**

This holds even in a small team where one person wears several hats. If the UI designer designed BULK-04, the UI designer does not accept BULK-04. You do, or a designated reviewer does.

46.3 The three layers, restated

Layer	Question	Approver	Output
1. Internal design acceptance	Does this meet its screen-level acceptance criteria?	Pradnya (or designated reviewer ≠ maker)	Screen status → Accepted in inventory
2. Strategic acceptance	Does this serve D1–D8 and the vision?	Pradnya, consulting founder	Journey status → Accepted
3. Demo readiness	Is this safe to present for commercial approval?	Founder	G7 gate pass

WARNING: Do not conflate layer 1 with layer 3. Work can be internally excellent and strategically wrong. Work can be strategically right and not yet safe to present.

46.4 Step-by-step: accepting a screen

1. Open the screen’s acceptance criteria (written at DoR time).
2. Check each criterion individually. Do not scan.
3. Open the screen on a physical phone. Run the mobile checks (42.6).
4. Check governance: watermark, footer, data marking, assumption cards.
5. Check content: real copy, no placeholders, marking labels applied.
6. Mark each criterion met or not met.
7. If all met → status Accepted in the inventory, with your name and the date.
8. If not → return with the specific unmet criteria listed. Never return work with vague feedback.

46.5 Step-by-step: accepting a journey

1. Confirm every screen in the journey is Accepted.
2. Walk the full happy path yourself, on a phone, as a user.
3. Verify the “must be clickable” list from the journey spec, item by item.
4. Check for dead ends. Click everything, including things you think are not wired.
5. Have someone who did not design it walk it.
6. Verify the Figma Flow plays correctly from start to finish.
7. Mark the journey Accepted with date.

46.6 Returning work well

Do	Do not
List the specific unmet criteria	Say “not quite there yet”
Distinguish must-fix from nice-to-fix	Bundle everything as equal
Give a date for re-review	Leave it open
Acknowledge what worked	Return only the negatives

46.7 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Maker approves own work	Always separate
Accepting against impression rather than criteria	Check criterion by criterion
Accepting a journey without walking it	Walk it, on a phone
Vague rejection feedback	Named, specific unmet criteria
Conflating internal acceptance with demo readiness	Three separate layers

46.8 Definition of success

Every accepted screen and journey can be shown to the founder at any moment without you needing to caveat it.

47. Owner Approval Process

47.1 Purpose

To convert a positive meeting into a documented commercial commitment.

47.2 The principle

> **Approval must be captured in writing, against a specific version, listing what was reviewed and what was excluded.**

Verbal enthusiasm is not approval. Enthusiasm fades, memories diverge, and disputes about what was agreed are avoidable with one page.

47.3 The approval record

Prepare this in advance. Print it. Have it with you.

Template — Approval Record

```
VK7SPORTS — WEBSITE DEMO PROTOTYPE
APPROVAL RECORD

Prototype version reviewed:  v[X.Y]
Date of walkthrough:         [DATE]
Presented by:                Pradnya Gaikwad, Project Lead, AASIOM Pvt Ltd
Attendees:                   [names and roles]

JOURNEYS REVIEWED
  [ ] Institutional bulk enquiry
  [ ] Custom teamwear brief and approval
  [ ] Retail
  [ ] Internal enquiry handling

EXCLUSIONS ACKNOWLEDGED
  The reviewer confirms the prototype does not include, and does not
  represent a commitment to build:
  [full exclusion list — verbatim from Section 6]
  All data shown is illustrative and does not represent
  actual pricing, timelines, or client relationships.

CORRECTIONS AND FEEDBACK CAPTURED
  1. [item]                                  → [action / phase]
  2. [item]                                  → [action / phase]
  3. [item]                                  → [action / phase]

UNRESOLVED ITEMS
  [Open questions and risky assumptions named during the walkthrough]

DECISION
  [ ] Approved to proceed to Phase 2 — Discovery
  [ ] Approved with conditions:  [state them]
  [ ] Not approved — reason:     [state it]
  [ ] Decision deferred to:      [DATE]

PHASE 2 — DISCOVERY
```

```
  Scope:       [summary]
  Duration:    [X weeks]
  Start date:  [DATE]
  Investment:  [as per proposal v[X]]

Signed:  _____________________     Date: _________
         [OWNER NAME], VK7SPORTS

Signed:  _____________________     Date: _________
         [FOUNDER NAME], AASIOM Pvt Ltd
```

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: whether a signed record is appropriate for this relationship, or whether a confirming email is the right register. I will decide this — do not present a signature page without my instruction.

47.4 The three possible outcomes and what to do

Outcome A — Approved

1. Capture the record.
2. Thank-you note within 24 hours.
3. Recorded walkthrough and summary document within 24 hours.
4. Proposal PDF within 48 hours.
5. Handoff folder shared.
6. Confirm the Discovery start date in writing.

Outcome B — Approved with conditions

1. Write down every condition precisely, in his words.
2. Do not agree to conditions on the spot — *"Let me make sure we can meet each of those properly and come back to you by [date]."*
3. Escalate to founder same day.
4. Founder responds to the conditions.

Outcome C — Not approved, or deferred

1. Do not argue and do not discount. Both damage position.
2. Ask the diagnostic question: *"What would need to be different for this to be a yes?"*
3. Write the answer down verbatim.
4. Thank him for the time genuinely.
5. Send the recorded walkthrough and summary anyway — it costs nothing and keeps the door open.
6. Debrief with the founder within 24 hours.

FOUNDER TIP: A deferral is usually about risk, not about the work. The most common unspoken objection is "I'm not sure this is the right time to spend money." Naming that possibility gently — *"Is it the direction, or the timing?"* — often gets you the real answer.

47.5 The 24-hour follow-up

Item	Deadline
Thank-you note — warm, short, no asks	24 hours
Recorded walkthrough (5 min)	24 hours
Plain-language summary document (1 page)	24 hours
Contact card with best times to reach	With the thank-you
Proposal PDF (5–7 pages)	48 hours
Organised handoff folder	48 hours

Why the summary document: the owner may need to brief a partner or a family member. A one-page, conversational summary supports that conversation happening accurately when you are not there.

47.6 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Treating verbal enthusiasm as approval	Capture in writing against a version
Agreeing to conditions in the room	Take them away; founder responds
Arguing or discounting on a no	Ask what would need to be different
Slow follow-up	24 hours, always
Approval not tied to a version	Name v[X.Y] explicitly

47.7 Definition of success

A written record exists naming the version reviewed, the journeys covered, the exclusions acknowledged, the corrections captured, and the decision made.

48. Handoff Procedure

48.1 Purpose

Handoffs are where context is lost. In a six-week project with a part-time team, every lost context costs days you do not have.

48.2 The principle

> **Every deliverable that changes hands gets a written note and a live conversation. Neither alone is sufficient.**

48.3 The handoff points in this project

Handoff	From → To	When
Journey → wireframe	UX → UI	Sprint 1
Wireframe → high fidelity	UX → UI	Sprint 2
Content → design	Content → UI	Sprint 2
Design → prototype wiring	UI → UI/QA	Sprint 3
Prototype → QA	UI → QA	Sprint 3
QA → demo preparation	QA → Pradnya	Sprint 3
Everything → owner	AASIOM → VK7SPORTS	Post-demo
Everything → Discovery team	Pradnya → next phase	Post-approval

48.4 The handoff note template

```
HANDOFF NOTE
From: [name]  →  To: [name]
Date: [DATE]
Deliverable: [what is being handed over]


CONTEXT
[Why this exists, what problem it solves, what decisions shaped it]


WHAT IS DONE
· [item]
· [item]


WHAT IS OPEN
· [item] — [why, and what is needed to close it]
```

```
DECISIONS THAT AFFECT THIS
· DEC-### [decision and its relevance]

ASSUMPTIONS THIS RESTS ON
· ASM-### [assumption and its status]

DEPENDENCIES OUTSTANDING
· DEP-### [what, and current status]

KNOWN RISKS
· [anything the receiver should watch for]

LINKS
· [everything the receiver needs]

NEXT OWNER'S FIRST THREE ACTIONS
1. [specific]
2. [specific]
3. [specific]
```

48.5 The pair session

Thirty minutes at every major handoff. The person handing over walks the receiver through the work.

Then — the teach-back. The receiver explains it back in their own words for fifteen minutes. This is where the gaps appear. A receiver who nods through a walkthrough and then discovers three days later that they misunderstood the flow has cost the project three days.

48.6 The handoff sign-off

Both parties confirm a short checklist. Stored in the shared folder.

```
HANDOFF SIGN-OFF
Deliverable: [x]      From: [x]      To: [x]      Date: [x]

  [ ] Handoff note written and read
  [ ] Pair session held
  [ ] Teach-back completed
  [ ] Receiver has all access and links
  [ ] Open items and assumptions understood
  [ ] First three actions agreed

Handed over by: _____________   Received by: _____________
```

48.7 The owner handoff

The most visible handoff of the project. Order signals competence; chaos undoes the demo.

Four folders, clearly named, correctly dated (Section 32.3):

```
VK7SPORTS_Website_Prototype_[DATE]/
├── 1_Demo_Recording/          Clean recording of the walkthrough
├── 2_Prototype_Link/          One clean link + access note
├── 3_Proposal/                Branded 5–7 page PDF
└── 4_Summary_Notes/           1-page plain-language summary + contact card
```

The proposal PDF structure: Context · Process · Deliverables · Timeline · Investment. Five to seven pages. Branded. Delivered within 48 hours.

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: proposal content, particularly the Investment section. Tier 3.

48.8 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Handoff by message only	Note plus live session
No teach-back	Gaps stay hidden
Assuming the receiver will ask	They will not; make them explain it back
Informal owner handoff	Structured folder, correctly named
Sending a bare Figma link	One clean link with a short note

48.9 Definition of success

No work is redone because context was lost at a handoff, and the owner’s handoff folder looks like it came from an established company.

49. Team Collaboration Rules

49.1 Purpose

To set the working norms of this team explicitly, rather than letting them emerge.

49.2 The rules

1. One channel. All project discussion in one place (Section 34.2).

2. One source of truth. If it is not in the document, it is not agreed.

3. Decisions are announced, not discovered. Every Tier 1 decision posted within 24 hours with rationale.

4. Blockers are surfaced immediately, not saved for standup. A blocker held privately for a day is a day lost.

5. Feedback is triaged within 24 hours. Accept, reject, or defer — with a reason (Section 27.7).

6. Nobody approves their own work. (Section 46.2)

7. Work-in-progress is shown, not hidden. The Friday demo is for unfinished work. A culture where people only show finished work is a culture where problems arrive late.

8. Disagreement is expected and is stated once, clearly. Then the decision is made and everyone executes it. Disagreeing repeatedly after a decision is made is not rigour, it is friction.

9. Credit is public, correction is private. Name people for good work in front of others. Correct in private, same day.

10. The Explorations page exists for ideas. Ideas are welcome. Unauthorised work inside the deliverable is not.

49.3 Working with a student team

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: team availability, exam periods, and any known absences.

Realities to plan around rather than complain about:

Reality	Response
Availability is uneven and academically constrained	Know actual hours per person per week; plan capacity honestly
Exams will collide with the schedule	Find out now, plan around them
Experience levels vary widely	Pair less experienced people with more experienced

	ones on handoffs
Motivation is high but process discipline is low	Process must be lightweight enough to actually be followed
Nobody has been managed before	Explain the *why* behind every process, once, properly

FOUNDER TIP: With a team like this, the most effective thing you can do is make the process light enough that following it is easier than not following it. A heavy process that gets abandoned in Week 3 is worse than a light one that survives.

49.4 The Blocker Board

A simple shared visual list. Three columns.

```
BLOCKED ON          OWNER        AGE
Product photos      Founder      4 days
Roster format Q     Owner        6 days
Icon set approval   Pradnya      1 day
```

Blockers hide by default. A visible board makes them impossible to ignore, and the age column creates the pressure that resolves them.

49.5 Handling underperformance

Directly, privately, and early.

1. Name the specific gap — a missed deadline, unmet criteria, not a character judgement.
2. Ask what is causing it. Frequently it is capacity or unclear briefing, both of which are your problem to fix.
3. Agree a specific correction with a date.
4. Follow up on that date.
5. If it recurs, escalate to the founder with facts, not impressions.

WARNING: Do not let underperformance go unaddressed because the team is small and the atmosphere is friendly. Unaddressed underperformance in a six-week project is not kindness — it lands on whoever is most conscientious, usually you.

49.6 Common mistakes

Mistake	Correction
Absorbing others' work silently	Escalate, do not absorb
Correcting publicly	Private, same day
Process too heavy for a student team	Light enough to be followed

Not knowing actual availability	Ask in Week 1, plan around it
Letting disagreement continue after a decision	State once, then execute

49.7 Definition of success

The team runs for a full week without you being the bottleneck for anything.

50. Leadership Expectations

50.1 Purpose

To state plainly what leadership looks like in this role, so it can be practised rather than guessed at.

50.2 The seven behaviours

1. Frame the constraints. Open every meeting by stating what is fixed and what is open. *"Here's what's locked, here's where we have room to decide together."* This is the single clearest signal that you are in command of the situation rather than reacting to it.

2. Decide and announce. Low-risk decisions made within 24 hours and communicated with rationale. Slow decision-making reads as passivity regardless of how thoughtfully you were deliberating.

3. Defend the scope calmly. When scope creep appears, name it without drama and reroute it. *"That's a strong idea for Phase 3 — let's get it into the backlog with a clear priority."* Scope defence is the most visible act of leadership in this project.

4. Surface risks before you are asked. Every weekly update and every demo names the top risk and its mitigation. Anticipating risk signals competence; being caught by it signals the opposite.

5. Credit the team visibly. Name people for their work in demos and updates. Leaders elevate others. This makes you look more senior, not less.

6. Own the unknown. *"I don't know yet, but I'll find out by [date]."* Never bluff. Confident uncertainty is a leadership signal; fabricated certainty is a liability that gets tested.

7. Reflect publicly. The Friday reflection note. What went well, what did not, what to remember. This builds trust and demonstrates self-awareness, and it makes the team safer to be honest with you.

50.3 The pre-decision briefing habit

Before any significant choice, send a one-page brief: options, recommendation, rationale (Section 9.4).

Leaders present decisions, not problems. The brief format forces you to think clearly before you ask anyone else to think — which is, in practice, most of what leadership is.

50.4 The post-demo debrief

Within 24 hours of the owner walkthrough, write a personal self-reflection:

- What worked
- What did not
- What I would do differently
- What I learned about this owner, this business, and myself

Share selectively with the team. Send it to me in full.

This is the highest-return thirty minutes in the entire project. Most people skip it, which is exactly why it is a differentiator.

50.5 What leadership is not, in this role

Not	Instead
Being the best designer	Being the person who makes the design decisions clear
Doing the most work	Making everyone else's work possible
Having every answer	Knowing which answers you owe and by when
Being liked	Being trusted
Avoiding conflict	Resolving it early and privately
Working the longest hours	Deciding well

50.6 The visible tests

You will be tested on leadership in three specific, predictable moments. Prepare for them.

Moment	The test	Passing behaviour
A team member proposes an out-of-scope feature enthusiastically	Will you defend scope without deflating them?	Name it, reroute to backlog, thank them, move on
The owner asks for an excluded feature in the demo	Will you defer under social pressure?	Deflection script, visible capture, no commitment
Something slips and it is your fault	Will you report it or hope it resolves?	Report the day it becomes true, with a proposed correction

50.7 Definition of success

By the end of this project, the team looks to you for decisions rather than to the founder, and I hear about problems from you before I hear about them from anywhere else.

51. KPIs

51.1 Purpose

To define, in advance, what will be measured — so that performance is assessed against agreed criteria rather than impressions.

51.2 Primary KPI

KPI	Target
Owner approves and funds the Discovery Phase	**Achieved**

Binary. Everything else is secondary.

51.3 Delivery KPIs

KPI	Target	Measurement
Sprints delivered on schedule	3 of 3	Sprint gate records
Prohibited scope in final prototype	Zero	G7 gate audit
Fake trust elements in final prototype	Zero	G7 gate audit
Unmarked illustrative data	Zero	G7 gate audit
Screens accepted vs. inventory	100% of Must-show	Screen inventory
Dead ends in prototype	Zero	G5 QA gate
Severity-1 and 2 defects at demo	Zero	Defect log

51.4 Governance KPIs

KPI	Target	Measurement
Decisions logged with rationale	100%	Decision register
Assumptions logged before being designed against	100%	Assumption register audit
Critique notes triaged within 24 hours	100%	Figma comment audit
Dependencies with fallbacks defined at logging	100%	Dependency register

Risks that materialised without being pre-logged	Zero	Risk register review
Weekly updates sent on time	100%	Sent record
Tier 3 decisions made without founder	Zero	Decision register

51.5 Quality KPIs

KPI	Target	Measurement
Outsiders who could state the site's purpose in one sentence	100% of testers	Comprehension test
Screens passing the premium five-question test	100%	Acceptance records
Screens reviewed on a physical device	100%	Acceptance records
Lorem ipsum instances at any gate	Zero	Gate audits

51.6 Stakeholder KPIs

KPI	Target	Measurement
Workflow corrections identified by the owner during walkthrough	3–8	Approval record
Owner questions bluffed or answered incorrectly	Zero	Post-demo debrief
Commitments made in the room outside authority	Zero	Post-demo debrief
Follow-up delivered within 24 hours	100%	Sent record

Note on the corrections KPI: the target is a range, not zero. Zero corrections means the owner disengaged. More than eight suggests our understanding of the business was materially wrong, which is a research failure. Three to eight is the signal of a well-run, engaged walkthrough.

51.7 What is deliberately not measured

Not measured	Why
Hours worked	Output and decisions matter; time does not
Number of screens produced	More screens is usually worse
Design quality by subjective opinion	Acceptance criteria replace opinion

Speed of individual tasks	Throughput of the whole team is what matters

51.8 Definition of success

Every KPI above is measurable from artefacts that already exist. None requires additional reporting effort.

52. Performance Evaluation

52.1 Purpose

To tell you in advance exactly how your performance in this role will be assessed.

52.2 The four evaluation dimensions

Dimension 1 — Judgement (weight: highest)

Assessed on	Evidence
Quality of decisions at Tier 1	Decision register; whether decisions held
Correct identification of decision tier	Zero Tier 3 decisions made independently
Prioritisation under pressure	Whether P1 stayed protected when time ran short
Knowing what to escalate and when	Escalation record; whether I was ever surprised

Dimension 2 — Scope discipline

Assessed on	Evidence
Excluded features kept out	G7 audit
Scope creep identified and rerouted	Backlog quality; unauthorised frame incidents
Behaviour under stakeholder pressure	Post-demo debrief; any commitments made

Dimension 3 — Documentation and governance

Assessed on	Evidence
Registers maintained and current	Register audit at each gate
Decisions logged with rationale	Decision register completeness
Whether another person could continue your work	Handoff test
Communication cadence held	Weekly update record

Dimension 4 — Stakeholder outcome

Assessed on	Evidence

Demo execution	Founder observation; recording
Owner engagement level	Corrections captured; questions asked
Approval secured	Approval record
Follow-through quality	24/48-hour delivery record

52.3 What excellent looks like

- Dozens of Tier 1 decisions made quickly; none surprised the founder
- Zero excluded scope in the file at any gate
- Every risk that materialised was already logged with a mitigation
- The owner corrected four workflow assumptions and funded Discovery
- A new person could pick up the source-of-truth document and continue
- The team stopped asking the founder questions because they asked you

52.4 What adequate looks like

- Decisions made, mostly logged; some rationale missing
- Scope held, with one or two incidents caught and corrected
- Registers maintained but occasionally stale
- Demo delivered competently; approval secured
- Documentation usable but requires explanation

52.5 What is not acceptable

Behaviour	Why
Any fabricated element in the prototype	Non-negotiable integrity failure
A Tier 3 commitment made without founder	Creates uncosted obligation
Bad news reported late	Removes my ability to help
Bluffing an answer to the owner	Damages the relationship and the firm
Registers not maintained	The whole governance model collapses
Absorbing the team’s work silently instead of escalating	Hides a capacity problem until it is a crisis

52.6 The self-assessment

Before our end-of-phase review, complete this honestly. It will carry more weight than anything I observe.

```
SELF-ASSESSMENT · [DATE]

1. The best decision I made in this project, and why:

2. The decision I got wrong, and what I would do differently:

3. Where I was a bottleneck for the team:

4. Something I did not escalate that I should have:

5. What I learned about running a project that I did not know before:

6. What I want to be responsible for in the next phase:
```

FOUNDER TIP: Question 4 is the one I will read most carefully. A person who can identify their own unescalated issues can be trusted with more responsibility. A person who claims there were none is either not paying attention or not being honest.

52.7 Definition of success

You can complete the self-assessment honestly and it broadly matches my assessment.

53. Growth Roadmap

53.1 Purpose

To make clear what this project is preparing you for, and what to deliberately practise while you are in it.

53.2 Short term — the Demo Phase (now)

Master these three:

Skill	How to practise it here	How you will know you have it
Scope containment	Every deflection, every backlog entry, every unauthorised frame conversation	You can say no without damaging the relationship
Stakeholder storytelling	The demo script, the "so what" loop, the three-act structure	You can make a business owner see his own business in a screen
Figma prototyping logic	Flows, wiring, states, locked files	You can build a demo that cannot break under clicking

Also develop: - Written decision-making (Decision Briefs) - Running structured critique - Managing a team of peers without formal authority

53.3 Mid term — the Discovery Phase (next)

If Discovery is approved, these become the skills that matter:

Skill	Why
Technical architecture translation	Understanding how UX decisions become database schemas and integration requirements
Pricing and business logic mapping	Bulk discount structures, GST implications, tiered quotations — the logic under the screens
Requirements elicitation from a non-technical stakeholder	Discovery is largely structured interviewing
Estimation and scoping	Turning requirements into effort and cost
Working with engineers	Different constraints, different vocabulary, different failure modes

How to prepare now: in every Discovery-deferred decision you log, write one line on *why* it needs Discovery. That habit builds the instinct for what is technically consequential.

53.4 Long term — production and beyond

Skill	Context
Agile sprint management with engineers	Real delivery cadence, real dependencies
API-first product strategy	Understanding systems as interfaces, not screens
Risk mitigation for live commerce	Payments, data, uptime, compliance
Team building and hiring	Growing beyond a project team
Commercial ownership	P&L, pricing, client relationships

53.5 The compounding skill

The single skill that compounds fastest across all three horizons:

> **The ability to write a clear decision document.**

Every level of seniority in product work is, functionally, the ability to make a well-reasoned decision and communicate it so that others can act on it without you. The Decision Briefs, the PRD, the registers — these are not administrative overhead. They are the practice of the skill that determines how far you go.

53.6 What I will invest in

If this phase goes well:

- Increasing decision authority — items moving from Tier 2 to Tier 1
- Direct exposure to client relationships rather than through me
- Responsibility for scoping and estimating, not only executing
- **FOUNDER TO CONFIRM:** specific commitments on role, scope, and compensation for the next phase

53.7 Definition of success

At the end of this phase you can name three things you can do now that you could not do six weeks ago, and I agree with all three.

54. AI Workflow

54.1 Purpose

AI tools can compress the administrative and drafting load of this project substantially. They can also introduce fabricated facts into a project whose entire credibility rests on not fabricating anything. This section defines how to use them safely.

54.2 The governing rules

Rule 1 — AI drafts. You decide. Never ship AI output unreviewed. Every AI-generated word that reaches the prototype or a document has been read and approved by you.

Rule 2 — Never generate business facts. AI must never be used to produce a statement about VK7SPORTS' business, pricing, turnaround times, or clients. Those come from the founder or the owner. An AI-generated plausible-sounding business fact is exactly the kind of thing that ends an engagement.

Rule 3 — Never generate client-facing trust content. No AI-written testimonials, no invented client examples, no generated statistics. Exclusions X12–X14.

Rule 4 — Mark AI-drafted content as draft until reviewed. In the content map, mark AI-assisted drafts as such until they have passed your review.

Rule 5 — Do not paste confidential business information into public AI tools. FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: which tools are approved for handling any VK7SPORTS-specific information. Until confirmed, assume none, and use AI only for generic drafting and structuring.

54.3 Where AI genuinely helps in this project

Task	Value
Drafting register and document structures	High — saves setup time
Drafting standard policy text (returns, terms) clearly marked as draft	High
Generating wireframe structure options for standard e-commerce patterns	Medium
Rewriting copy for clarity and brevity	High
Transcribing critiques and the owner walkthrough	Very high — captures feedback accurately

Summarising research and notes	High
Generating checklists from a written process	Medium
Producing meeting notes from a transcript	High
Stress-testing your own thinking (arguing the opposite case)	High

54.4 Where AI must not be used

Task	Why
Any statement about VK7SPORTS' business	Fabrication risk
Pricing, discount tiers, turnaround times	Founder/owner facts only
Testimonials, client names, client logos	Exclusions X13, X14
Metrics and statistics presented as fact	Exclusion X12
Deciding scope	Your judgement, my authority
Deciding what to escalate	Your judgement
Writing the demo script wholesale	The narrative must be yours or it will not survive a question

54.5 The review protocol for AI output

1. Read every line. Do not skim.
2. For each factual claim, ask: where did this come from? If it did not come from a source you can name, cut it.
3. Check for invented specifics — plausible-sounding numbers, names, timeframes. These are the most dangerous output because they read as researched.
4. Check tone: does it sound like our documents, or like generic content?
5. Rewrite anything that sounds generated. Generated prose is detectable and undermines the premium impression.
6. Mark the item Reviewed in the content map.

WARNING: The failure mode is not obviously wrong output. It is confidently phrased, plausible, entirely invented detail — "typical turnaround is 10–14 days", "bulk discounts usually start at

50 units”. These read as researched and are not. Treat every specific number in AI output as suspect until sourced.

55. AI Tools

55.1 Purpose

A practical mapping of tool to task. **FOUNDER TO CONFIRM:** which of these are approved and licensed, and which may handle VK7SPORTS-specific information.

55.2 The tool set

Category	Tools	Use for	Do not use for
General LLM assistants	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini	Drafting document structures, rewriting copy, summarising research, stress-testing arguments, generating checklists	Business facts, pricing, client content
Wireframe and structure generation	Relume, Webflow AI	Rapidly generating standard e-commerce wireframe structures as a starting point	Final IA — that comes from tasks, not from a generator
Transcription	Otter.ai, Fireflies, Granola	Transcribing critiques, sprint reviews, and the owner walkthrough	Recording anyone without consent
Design assistance	Figma AI features	Generating variants, tidying layers, naming	Design decisions
Image handling	Background removal, upscaling tools	Preparing sourced photography consistently	Generating fake product imagery

55.3 Specific guidance per tool category

General LLM assistants

Best used for structure and clarity, worst used for content that must be true. Excellent for: “restructure this register so it is easier to scan”, “rewrite this paragraph in fifty words”, “what have I not considered about this decision?”

Wireframe generators

Useful for the retail journey (P3), which is a conventional pattern. Nearly useless for the bulk and custom teamwear journeys, which are specific to this business. Do not let a generator define P1 or P2 structure.

Transcription

The highest-value AI use in this project. Transcribe the owner walkthrough (with consent) and you will capture feedback accurately rather than from memory. Transcribe design critiques and you will never lose a note.

Consent is required. Ask before recording, every time, and note the consent in the meeting record.

Image tools

Permitted for preparing legitimately sourced photography — consistent cropping, background treatment, upscaling. **Not permitted for generating fake product images that imply VK7SPORTS makes something it does not.**

55.4 Tool discipline

Rule	Reason
Do not introduce a new tool mid-project without a Tier 2 decision	Tool churn costs more than it saves in six weeks
One tool per job	Two transcription tools means notes in two places
Everything ends up in the source of truth	Tool outputs are inputs, not records

55.5 Definition of success

AI reduces your administrative load meaningfully, and not a single fact in any project artefact originated from a model.

56. Prompt Library

56.1 Purpose

Reusable prompts for the recurring tasks in this project. Adapt them; do not use them blindly. Every output is reviewed per Section 54.5.

56.2 Planning and structure

Journey specification review

```
I am reviewing a user journey for a B2B sportswear website prototype.
Here is the journey specification: [PASTE]


Identify: (1) any step where the user is asked for information before
they need to provide it, (2) any point where the journey could dead-end,
(3) any step whose purpose is unclear.
Do not suggest new features. Do not add steps.
List findings only, with the step number.
```

Screen inventory generation

```
Here is a user journey specification: [PASTE]
Generate a screen inventory: one row per screen and per screen state.
Columns: Screen ID, Screen name, State, Platform, Flow position,
Clickable elements.
Use the naming convention [JOURNEY]-[NN][state]_[PLATFORM].
Do not invent screens not implied by the journey.
```

Information architecture check

```
Here is a proposed sitemap: [PASTE]
Here are the top user tasks: [PASTE]
For each task, state whether it can be completed from the homepage,
and in how many steps. Flag any task that requires more than
[N] steps or requires backtracking.
Do not propose new pages.
```

56.3 Content drafting

On-screen copy

```
Write UI copy for a screen in a premium Indian sportswear B2B website
prototype.


Screen: [purpose]
Audience: [persona]
Register: professional Indian business English, confident, no superlatives,
no marketing inflation.


Provide: headline (max 8 words), supporting line (max 20 words),
CTA label (verb-first, specific), helper text for [fields].


Constraints:
- Make no claims about the company's clients, scale, or history
- Use no superlatives that would require substantiation
- Do not invent numbers, timeframes, or prices
```

Empty, error, and loading states

```
Write copy for these states in a premium sportswear B2B prototype:
- Empty: no enquiries yet
- Empty: no quotes yet
- Empty: no mockups yet
- Error: invalid phone number
- Error: file too large on artwork upload
- Loading: quote being prepared


Tone: warm but restrained. No apology. No exclamation marks.
Error messages must say what happened and what to do.
Maximum 15 words each.
```

Copy compression

```
Rewrite this to be 40% shorter without losing meaning.
Keep the same register. Do not add anything.
[PASTE]
```

56.4 Review and critique

Pre-critique preparation

```
I am about to run a design critique on this screen: [DESCRIBE / PASTE].
The business context: premium Indian sportswear company, B2B bulk
enquiries from schools, academies, clubs and corporates.
The screen's purpose: [state it].


Generate the five questions a business owner most likely to ask about
this screen. Do not evaluate the design. Questions only.
```

Scope check

```
Here is our project exclusion list: [PASTE]
Here is a proposed piece of work: [PASTE]
State whether the proposal violates any exclusion, and which one.
If it is adjacent to but not inside an exclusion, say so and explain
where the line is. Give a one-sentence verdict first.
```

Decision stress test

```
I am about to make this decision: [PASTE]
My rationale: [PASTE]


Argue the strongest case against my decision. Then state what evidence
would change my mind. Be direct; do not soften.
```

56.5 Documentation

Meeting notes from a transcript

```
Here is a transcript of a design critique: [PASTE]
Extract:
1. DECISIONS MADE — with the rationale stated in the meeting
2. ACTION ITEMS — with owner and any date mentioned
3. OPEN QUESTIONS — anything raised and not resolved
4. SCOPE FLAGS — anything discussed that would expand the project


Use only what is in the transcript. Do not infer or add.
```

Register hygiene check

```
Here is my assumption register: [PASTE]
Identify: (1) assumptions with no validation method,
(2) assumptions with no owner, (3) assumptions marked Pending
for more than [N] days, (4) any two entries that are duplicates.
List only. Do not add assumptions.
```

Weekly update draft

```
Draft a weekly project update using exactly this structure:
Done / In Progress / Blocked / Next Week / Decisions / Top 3 Risks /
Open Question.


Source material: [PASTE your notes]


Rules: "Done" items must describe outcomes, not activity.
Do not add anything not in the source material.
Maximum 250 words.
```

56.6 Demo preparation

“So what” generation

```
Here is a description of a prototype screen: [PASTE]
The audience is the owner of a premium sportswear business in India
who currently runs enquiries through WhatsApp and phone calls.


Write one sentence beginning "So what this means for you is..."
that translates this screen into an outcome for his business.
Do not overclaim. Do not mention time saved or money unless
I have given you a figure.
```

Objection preparation

```
I am presenting a clickable prototype to a business owner to secure
funding for a discovery phase. The prototype excludes: [PASTE exclusions].


List the ten most likely objections or difficult questions, ordered
by likelihood. For each, note whether it is answerable by the project
lead, is a commercial question for the founder, or is a scope-expansion
request. Do not draft answers.
```

Comprehension test script

```
Write a 10-minute usability test script for a non-technical Indian
business owner testing a B2B sportswear website prototype.
Include: three task prompts, the exact wording of the one-sentence
comprehension question, and instructions for the facilitator on
what to observe and what not to say.
Keep it simple. The facilitator is not a trained researcher.
```

56.7 Prompt discipline

Rule	Reason
Always include “do not invent numbers, names, or timeframes”	This is where fabrication enters

Always include “do not propose new features”	This is where scope creep enters
Always state the audience and register	Generic output is detectable
Ask for findings, not solutions, when reviewing	You decide the solution
Never paste confidential business information into an unapproved tool	Section 54.2 Rule 5

57. Templates

All templates from this handbook, collected for reference. Copy them into the working folder in Week 1.

57.1 Index of templates

#	Template	Section
T-01	Demo PRD	13.4
T-02	Requirement (REQ)	14.4
T-03	Owner Question List	14.6
T-04	Journey Specification	16.3
T-05	Screen Inventory columns	17.3
T-06	Content Map columns	18.3
T-07	Assumption Register entry	20.3
T-08	Decision Register entry	21.4
T-09	Risk Register entry	22.3
T-10	Dependency Register entry	23.3
T-11	Decision Brief	9.4
T-12	Screen Acceptance Criteria	26.4
T-13	Exclusions One-Pager	6.5
T-14	Prototype Drop Note	29.4
T-15	Friday Update	11.3
T-16	Source of Truth structure	30.3
T-17	Confusion Log	40.6
T-18	Approval Record	47.3
T-19	Handoff Note	48.4

T-20	Handoff Sign-off	48.6
T-21	Escalation	35.6
T-22	Question Batch	35.5
T-23	Self-Assessment	52.6
T-24	Progress Measure	45.4

57.2 Additional templates

T-25 — Defect Log

```
BUG-###
Screen:      [ID]
Severity:    S1 / S2 / S3 / S4
Found by:    [name]     Date: [DATE]
What happens:[description]
Expected:    [what should happen]
Steps:       [how to reproduce]
Owner:       [name]
Status:      Open / Fixed / Verified / Won't fix
Fixed date:  [DATE]      Verified by: [name]
```

T-26 — Phase 2/3 Backlog entry

```
B-###
Item:        [what was requested]
Requested by:[who]         Date: [DATE]
Source:      Owner walkthrough / team proposal / critique note
Phase:       2 (Discovery) / 3 (Production) / Not planned
Rationale:   [why it is not in this phase — one line]
Effort:      Rough T-shirt size, if known
Value:       [what it would achieve]
```

T-27 — Meeting Record

```
VK7_[MeetingType]_[YYYY-MM-DD]
Attendees:   [names]
Objective:   [one sentence]
Recorded:    Yes (consent given by [who]) / No


DECISIONS
  DEC-### [decision] — [rationale] — [decided by]


ACTIONS
  [action] — [owner] — [due date]


OPEN
  [question] — [who will resolve] — [by when]


SCOPE FLAGS
  [anything raised that would expand scope] → B-###
```

T-28 — Weekly Reflection Note

```
REFLECTION · Week [N] · [DATE]

What went well:
What did not:
What I got wrong:
What we should do differently from Monday:
```

T-29 — Interim Working Assumption Notice

Use this when a question is blocking the team and cannot be answered today.

```
INTERIM WORKING ASSUMPTION · [DATE]

We do not yet have: [the missing information]
It is logged as: ASM-###, status Pending, owner [name]
Until it is answered, the team will proceed on the basis that:
  [the specific working assumption]

Affected screens: [IDs]
These screens will carry an "Illustrative" label and an assumption card.
If the answer differs, the rework required is approximately: [scope]
```

T-30 — Post-Demo Debrief

```
POST-DEMO DEBRIEF · [DATE]     (within 24 hours)

WHAT HAPPENED
Outcome: [approved / conditional / deferred / declined]
Duration: [actual]   Attendees: [who came, vs. who was expected]

WHAT WORKED
WHAT DID NOT
WHAT I WOULD DO DIFFERENTLY

WHAT I LEARNED ABOUT
  The owner:
  The business:
  Myself:

CORRECTIONS CAPTURED
  [list, with phase assignment]

IMMEDIATE ACTIONS
  1. [within 24h]
  2. [within 48h]
```

58. Checklists

Every checklist in this handbook, collected. Print the ones you will use daily.

58.1 Daily checklist

- ☐ Board reviewed
- ☐ Blockers aged and owned
- ☐ Standup held, 15 minutes, ended on time
- ☐ Figma reconciled against Screen Inventory
- ☐ Decisions logged
- ☐ Assumption statuses updated
- ☐ Two-line channel update posted

58.2 Weekly checklist

- ☐ Scope reviewed against PRD
- ☐ Design critique held with stated objective and three priority issues
- ☐ Every dependency aged and actioned
- ☐ All four registers updated
- ☐ Internal Friday demo held
- ☐ Weekly update sent in the fixed format
- ☐ Three-minute walkthrough recorded and linked
- ☐ Reflection note sent to the team
- ☐ Five direction questions asked (Section 45.2)
- ☐ Progress measured by inventory acceptance, not feeling

58.3 Before design starts on any screen (DoR)

- ☐ On the Screen Inventory with an ID
- ☐ Journey mapped and documented
- ☐ Flow position defined
- ☐ Fidelity level assigned
- ☐ D1–D8 purpose stated
- ☐ Real copy exists in the content map
- ☐ Assets available or fallback agreed and logged

- ☐ Underlying assumptions logged with IDs
- ☐ Acceptance criteria written
- ☐ Platform specified
- ☐ Owner assigned

58.4 Before accepting any screen (DoD)

- ☐ All acceptance criteria met
- ☐ Mobile-first; desktop if required
- ☐ Real copy; zero lorem ipsum
- ☐ All illustrative and sample data marked
- ☐ Watermark and footer present
- ☐ Maximum 2–3 type sizes
- ☐ Approved icon set only
- ☐ Tap targets ≥44×44px
- ☐ Single-column mobile forms
- ☐ Reviewed on a physical device
- ☐ Human-in-the-loop steps distinguished where applicable
- ☐ Inventory status updated
- ☐ Reviewed by someone other than the designer

58.5 Before accepting any journey

- ☐ Every screen accepted
- ☐ Full happy path clickable
- ☐ Zero dead ends
- ☐ Return to home from every screen
- ☐ “Must be clickable” list fully satisfied
- ☐ Walked by someone who did not design it
- ☐ Appears as a separate Figma Flow

58.6 Sprint gate checklist

- ☐ Gate criteria read aloud and assessed individually
- ☐ Screen inventory reconciled
- ☐ All registers current

- ☐ Written pass/fail outcome published within two hours
- ☐ Next sprint's criteria stated
- ☐ Any slippage reported to founder same day

58.7 Demo readiness checklist (G7 — founder-approved)

- ☐ AC-01 to AC-25 all met
- ☐ Zero excluded features present
- ☐ Zero fake logos, testimonials, or client names
- ☐ All five governance mechanisms in place
- ☐ "Not Included Yet" screen built
- ☐ Phase 2 Gate frame built with owner name and date
- ☐ Exclusions one-pager finalised
- ☐ Deck and script complete with a "so what" per screen
- ☐ Two full rehearsals completed, one with founder as owner
- ☐ Three verbal disclaimers rehearsed
- ☐ Deflection script rehearsed under pressure
- ☐ PRESENT copy created, locked, tested
- ☐ A5 handout printed (4 copies)
- ☐ Approval record printed
- ☐ Device, mobile device, and internet contingency tested
- ☐ Recording consent arranged
- ☐ Dependency D-12 resolved

58.8 Post-demo checklist

- ☐ Approval record completed and signed or confirmed
- ☐ Corrections captured with phase assignment
- ☐ Thank-you note sent (24h)
- ☐ Recorded walkthrough sent (24h)
- ☐ Plain-language summary sent (24h)
- ☐ Contact card included
- ☐ Proposal PDF delivered (48h)
- ☐ Handoff folder organised and shared (48h)
- ☐ Post-demo debrief written and sent to founder (24h)

- ☐ Phase 2/3 backlog updated with everything captured

58.9 Integrity checklist — run before every external artefact

- ☐ No client names
- ☐ No client logos
- ☐ No testimonials
- ☐ No unsubstantiated claims or superlatives
- ☐ No unmarked illustrative or sample data
- ☐ No metric presented without an Illustrative label
- ☐ No statement about VK7SPORTS' business that the founder has not confirmed
- ☐ Watermark and footer present
- ☐ Every number checked: where did this come from?

59. Common Mistakes

59.1 Purpose

The failure modes of this specific project, in one place. Read this section at the start of each sprint.

59.2 The three named traps

The Feature Trap. Allowing the team to design something excluded — a dealer portal, an admin panel, a 3D configurator — because it looks impressive or because a flow "felt incomplete". It enters the file, then a review, then the owner's expectations, and by then it is an obligation. *Countermeasure:* daily Figma reconciliation; the Explorations page; addressing the cause not the frame.

The Polish Trap. Spending eighty percent of the available effort perfecting the homepage while the bulk quotation workflow — the screen that actually determines whether the owner sees value — stays rough. *Countermeasure:* track effort per journey; correct visibly at sprint review; P1 fidelity is never compromised for P3.

The "Yes" Trap. Agreeing to a feature during the owner walkthrough because refusing felt socially awkward. This creates an uncosted obligation and the walk-back is far more damaging than the original deferral would have been. *Countermeasure:* rehearse the deflection script under pressure; visible note-taking; zero Tier 3 authority.

59.3 The full mistake register

Scope

Mistake	Consequence
Designing an excluded feature "just to see"	It ends up in expectations
Adding screens ad hoc	Inventory drift, invisible scope growth
Agreeing to scope in a meeting	Uncosted obligation
Treating the exclusion list as a negotiating position	It is a boundary, set by the founder

Planning

Mistake	Consequence
Starting high-fidelity design before the PRD is	Rework in Sprint 2

approved	
Journeys mapped after screens are drawn	Dead ends and unnecessary steps
Designing all journeys to equal depth	P1 under-built where it matters most
Lorem ipsum in wireframes	Layouts sized for text that does not exist

Governance

Mistake	Consequence
Decisions logged without rationale	Re-litigation in Week 5
Verbal decisions never recorded	“We agreed, but I thought it meant…”
Assumptions logged but never reviewed	Silent risk
Dependencies with no fallback	Single points of failure
Risks with no trigger	Not noticed until they are problems
Critique notes untriaged	The team stops giving feedback

Craft

Mistake	Consequence
Desktop-first design	Fails on the device the owner actually uses
Reviewing only in Figma, not on a phone	Tap targets and reach problems go undetected
Round numbers in sample data	Reads as generated
Western currency formatting	Reads as not made for him
Icon spam	The clearest signal of amateur work
More than three type sizes	Cluttered, unpremium
Inconsistent data across screens	The whole prototype feels assembled

Integrity

Mistake	Consequence

Fake client logos or testimonials	Engagement-ending
Unmarked illustrative data	Misrepresentation, however unintended
Precise fabricated metrics	More dangerous than vague ones
Repeating unverified business figures back to the client	Credibility damage with no upside
Marking data only in the deck, not the pixels	Screenshots travel alone

Leadership

Mistake	Consequence
Doing the team's work instead of leading it	Capacity problem stays hidden until it is a crisis
Escalating Tier 1 decisions	You become the bottleneck
Bluffing an answer	Tested and exposed, usually immediately
Sitting on bad news	Removes the founder's ability to help
Relaying decisions as "the founder said so"	Team stops respecting your authority
Correcting publicly	Damages the team
Not addressing underperformance	Work lands on the most conscientious person

Demo

Mistake	Consequence
Sending the Figma link instead of presenting	Judged as a website, not as a solution
Opening with the prototype instead of his words	No emotional anchor
Feature narration without "so what"	The owner sees screens, not outcomes
Filling silences	Prevents the reflection where the decision forms
Exclusions presented at the end	Expectations already formed

Making changes on demo day	Untested, and untested breaks
Presenting from the working file	One accidental drag destroys the demo
Ending on a monologue	The real objection is never surfaced

59.3 The single question that prevents most of these

Before any action, ask:

> **“Does this serve the objective of securing approval for Discovery, within the locked scope, honestly?”**

Almost every mistake in this section fails one of those three clauses.

60. Founder Final Expectations

60.1 What I expect from you

Pradnya — six statements. These are the things I will judge this phase by, and they are the things I want you to hold yourself to.

1. Nothing in this prototype is false. Not a logo, not a testimonial, not a number, not a claim, not a client name. Where something is illustrative, it says so on the screen. This is the one expectation with no flexibility in it at all. If you are ever uncertain whether something crosses the line, the answer is that it does — cut it and tell me.

2. Nothing excluded appears. The list in Section 6 is a boundary I have set, not a starting position. You have my full backing every time you enforce it, including in front of the owner, including when it is uncomfortable.

3. I am never surprised. Bad news reaches me the day it becomes true. A slipped milestone, a risk that has escalated, a team member who has gone quiet, a dependency that will not arrive. Early bad news is a manageable problem. Late bad news is a crisis plus a trust problem.

4. You decide, at your tier, quickly. I have given you real authority in Section 9. Use it. A steady stream of well-reasoned Tier 1 decisions, logged and announced, is exactly what I want to see. Escalating things you have the authority to decide is not caution — it is a failure to lead.

5. You do not bluff. Not to me, not to the team, not to the owner. “I don’t know yet, I’ll confirm by Thursday” is a complete professional answer and I will never think less of you for it. I will think less of you for a confident answer that turns out to be invented.

6. The documentation outlives the project. At the end of this phase, someone who has never spoken to you should be able to open the source-of-truth document and understand what was built, what was decided, why, what was assumed, and what remains open.

60.2 What you can expect from me

Fast answers. Batched questions get a considered response quickly. Decision Briefs get an answer within 24 hours.

Backing on scope. Every time you enforce the exclusion list, I will support you — publicly if necessary.

Business facts, promptly. Anything marked FOUNDER TO CONFIRM in this handbook is my obligation. If I am slow, chase me.

Honest feedback. I will tell you directly when something is not good enough, and directly when it is. You will not have to guess where you stand.

Increasing authority if this goes well. Items move from Tier 2 to Tier 1. Client exposure increases. Scope of responsibility grows.

60.3 The three things that would make this phase a genuine success

Beyond the approval itself:

1. **The owner corrects three or four of our workflow assumptions during the walkthrough** — because that means he engaged seriously, and because every correction makes Discovery better.
2. **The team stops asking me questions and starts asking you** — because that means the authority is real, not nominal.
3. **You can name three capabilities you have now that you did not have six weeks ago** — and I agree with all three.

60.4 The last word

The prototype is not the product of this phase. **The decision is.**

Everything in this handbook — the registers, the gates, the marking rules, the script, the pauses, the deflections — exists to produce one outcome: a business owner who trusts us enough to fund the next step, and who is not surprised by anything he finds out later.

Build honestly. Decide quickly. Say no clearly. Write it all down.

Good luck.

— **[FOUNDER NAME]** AASIOM Pvt Ltd

Appendix A — Quick Reference Card

Print this. Keep it visible.

THE OBJECTIVE Secure owner approval and funding for the Discovery Phase.

THE PRIORITY ORDER P1 Institutional bulk · P2 Custom teamwear · P3 Retail

THE DEFLECTION SCRIPT *"That's a strong idea, and I want to make sure it gets done properly rather than sketched. Let me log it for Discovery with a clear priority — that way we cost it and scope it rather than assume it."*

THE UNCERTAINTY SCRIPT *"I don't know yet. I'll confirm by [date]."*

THE BOUNDARY SCRIPT *"That's a commercial question and I'd rather [FOUNDER] answer it precisely than have me estimate."*

DECIDE ALONE IF it does not change promises, cost, commitments, scope, priority, fidelity, schedule, tooling, or state a business fact.

ESCALATE IMMEDIATELY IF it is Tier 3, a High/High risk, a milestone slip, an integrity concern, or a dependency blocking the demo.

NEVER invent a business fact · use a client name or logo · show unmarked data · agree to scope in a room · bluff an answer · present from the working file.

ALWAYS mark illustrative data in the pixels · log the rationale · write it down in front of them · review on a physical phone · pause for five seconds.

Appendix B — The Marking Rules, One Page

Content type	Label	Where
Any price, band, or discount	**Illustrative**	On screen, adjacent
Any metric	**Illustrative**	On screen, adjacent
Any institution name	**Sample**	On screen
Any person's name (invented)	**Sample**	On screen
Any quantity, date, timestamp	**Sample**	Screen footer acceptable
Functionality shown but not built	**Prototype Only**	On screen
Every screen, always	**"Prototype — Not Yet Live"**	Persistent footer
Every screen, always	PROTOTYPE watermark	Diagonal, low opacity
Data-heavy screens	*"Illustrative sample data for prototype demonstration."*	Screen footer

Forbidden entirely: named clients · client logos · testimonials · unsubstantiated superlatives · any implied relationship that does not exist.

Appendix C — The Registers, One Page

Register	Prefix	Reviewed	Key field people forget
Assumption	ASM-	Weekly (Thu)	Validation method
Decision	DEC-	Continuous; 2 highlighted weekly	Rationale
Risk	RISK- / R-	Weekly (Thu)	Trigger
Dependency	DEP- / D-	Weekly (Wed)	Fallback
Requirement	REQ-	At DoR	Source
Backlog	B-	At each critique and post-demo	Phase + rationale
Defect	BUG-	Sprint 3 daily	Severity

The rule for all of them: an entry with no owner does not get resolved.

Appendix D — Sprint Calendar Template

FOUNDER TO CONFIRM: actual dates.

Sprint	Days	Key deliverables	Gate
1 — Definition	1–2	Reference audit, kickoff, RACI, registers, tooling	
	3–5	Journeys mapped, IA drafted	
	6–8	Screen inventory, Demo PRD, content map	
	9–10	Wireframes P1 + P2, review, founder sign-off	**G1**
2 — Design	1–3	Visual system locked	
	4–7	P1 high-fidelity, mobile-first	
	8–10	P2 high-fidelity, sample data, assets	**G2**
3 — Prototype	1–3	Wiring, Flows, no dead ends	
	4–5	QA pass, defect fixes	**G5**
	6–7	Outsider testing, confusion log, fixes	**G6**
	8–9	Deck, script, exclusions, handout, rehearsals	
	10	Freeze, lock, dry run	**G7**
Demo	T-0	Owner walkthrough	
Follow-up	T+1	Thank-you, walkthrough, summary, debrief	
	T+2	Proposal, handoff folder	

Appendix E — Terminology

Term	Meaning in this project
Demo Phase	The current phase. Produces a prototype and a proposal.
Discovery Phase	Phase 2. Paid. Defines what would actually be built.
P1 / P2 / P3	Journey priority: bulk, custom teamwear, retail
D1–D8	The eight demonstration requirements (Section 4.3)
X1–X14	The exclusion list (Section 6.2)
AC-01 to AC-25	Prototype-wide acceptance criteria (Section 26.3)
G1–G7	Quality gates (Section 44.2)
Tier 1 / 2 / 3	Decision authority levels (Section 9)
DoR / DoD	Definition of Ready / Definition of Done
Must show / Can simulate	Fidelity levels (Section 5.4)
Human-in-the-loop	A step where a VK7SPORTS person intervenes; shown visually
Hero screenshot	The single most polished, forwardable screen
PRESENT copy	The locked, frozen Figma file used for the demo
Illustrative / Sample / Prototype Only	The three approved marking labels

Appendix F — Open Items for Founder

Every item marked **FOUNDER TO CONFIRM** in this handbook, consolidated. Bring this to the first working session.

#	Item	Section	Blocks	Priority
F-01	Signature name and title for the issued handbook	1	Handbook issue	Low
F-02	VK7SPORTS current digital presence	3.2	Reference audit, IA	Medium
F-03	Verified revenue scale, order volume, average bulk order size, peak season	3.3	Sample data realism	Medium
F-04	Which of the five operational frictions the owner feels most acutely	3.4	Demo narrative centre	**High**
F-05	Discovery Phase duration, start date, activity list, investment figure	6.5, 37, 48.7	Exclusions doc, Phase 2 card, proposal, closing of demo	**BLOCKING**
F-06	Final team composition, names, availability per week	8.2, 49.3	RACI, capacity planning	**High**
F-07	Sprint length, start date, demo date	12.2	Entire schedule	**High**
F-08	Response-time commitment after a bulk enquiry	18.4	Confirmation copy	Medium
F-09	Storage tool for documentation and access arrangements	30.6	Week 1 setup	**High**
F-10	VK7SPORTS brand assets — logo, colours, fonts	23.4 (D-02)	Entire visual system	**High**
F-11	High-resolution product photography availability	23.4 (D-01)	Homepage, PDP, mockups	**High**
F-	Product and category list	23.4 (D-	IA, category, PDP	**High**

12		03)		
F-13	Customisation options actually offered	23.4 (D-04)	P2 brief capture	Medium
F-14	Size charts	23.4 (D-05)	PDP, roster	Medium
F-15	Roster data format currently received	23.4 (D-06)	TEAM-04	Medium
F-16	Artwork file formats received	23.4 (D-07)	TEAM-05	Medium
F-17	Turnaround time commitments	23.4 (D-08)	Timeline copy	Medium
F-18	Sample pricing language and tier names	23.4 (D-09)	Quotation screens	Medium
F-19	Names of 2–3 VK7SPORTS team members	23.4 (D-10)	Internal worklist realism	Low
F-20	Owner’s verbatim quote about his pain	23.4 (D-11), 37	**Demo opening**	**High**
F-21	Terminology the business uses	23.4 (D-13)	All copy and labels	Medium
F-22	Founder and owner availability windows across the sprint calendar	22.4	Risk planning R-10, R-11	Medium
F-23	Whether real institution names may be used, and under what permission	43.3	Sample data	Medium
F-24	Demo attendee list	36.4, 38.2	Demo preparation	**High**
F-25	Whether a signed approval record is appropriate, or a confirming email	47.3	Approval capture	Medium

F-26	Whether the risk-free reversal note is commercially acceptable	38.6	Demo script	Medium
F-27	Response-time expectations between founder, Pradnya, and team	34.5	Communication norms	Low
F-28	Approved AI tools, and which may handle VK7SPORTS information	54.2, 55.1	AI workflow	Medium
F-29	Proposal content, particularly the Investment section	48.7	Post-demo handoff	**High**
F-30	Role, scope, and compensation commitments for the next phase	53.6	Growth conversation	Low

Priority key: BLOCKING = the demo cannot be completed without it · High = needed in Week 1–2 · Medium = needed before Sprint 2 · Low = needed before phase close.

END OF HANDBOOK

VK7SPORTS — Website Demo Prototype · Project Lead Operating Handbook v1.0 AASIOM Pvt Ltd · Internal · Issued to Pradnya Gaikwad